“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 20

The Truth of the Svarūpa: A Discourse on the Distinctions among the Forms of Śrī Bhagavān

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. Sanātana Gosvāmī was held in prison in Gauḍa when Rūpa Gosvāmī wrote to him: “Mahāprabhu has gone to Mathurā.” With sweet words and a gift of seven thousand coins Sanātana won over the jailer, crossed the Gaṅgā and fled. His companion Īśāna carried eight gold coins, and the *bhaumika* (landholder) of the Pātaḍā hills received Sanātana as a guest, hoping to kill them and take the coins. By questioning Īśāna, Sanātana learned that he had gold coins with him. Knowing those coins to be a source of calamity (*anartha*), he gave them to the *bhūñā* and crossed the hill country. Once over the hills, he sent Īśāna back home. When Sanātana reached Hājipura, his sister’s husband Śrīkānta, a royal official, saw him, heard the whole story and took him across the Gaṅgā. Walking on and on, Sanātana came to Kāśī and arrived at Candraśekhara’s door. Mahāprabhu called him in and, showing him mercy, told him to change his dress and shave (*bhadra*). When Sanātana came back shaven, he put on an old cloth given by Tapana Miśra, making of it a *kaupīna* and an outer garment. He exchanged the woollen Bhoṭa blanket he carried for a torn quilt (*kāṅthā*) from the bank of the Gaṅgā, and so gave the Lord joy. Staying there, Sanātana asked Mahāprabhu about the truth. First the Lord explained to him the “true nature (*svarūpa*) of the *jīva*” and “Kṛṣṇa’s potency.” Then He taught him knowledge of *sambandha* (relationship with the Lord) and explained devotion, which is the *abhidheya* (the means). In considering Kṛṣṇa’s

svarūpa, He explained Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān; He spoke of the *svayaṁ-rūpa*, the *tad-ekātma-rūpa* and the *āveśa*, and within them, in the order of *vaibhava-* and *prābhava-vilāsa* and the rest, of the different forms of Bhagavān. After that He explained the manifestation of māyā (*māyā-vaibhava*) of the *puruṣa-avatāras*, the *manvantara-avatāras*, the *guṇa-avatāras*, the *śaktyāveśa-avatāras*, the pastimes that differ by age — childhood (*bālya*) and boyhood (*pauganḍa*) — and the eternity of the pastimes of youth (*kaiśora*).

বন্দেঽনন্তাদ্ভুতৈশ্বর্য্যং শ্রীচৈতন্যমহাপ্রভুম্ ।
নীচোঽপি যৎপ্রসাদাৎ স্যাদ্ভক্তিশাস্ত্রপ্রবর্ত্তকঃ ॥ ১ ॥

vande 'nantādbhutaiśvaryaṁ
I bow down to Him whose opulence is boundless and wondrous
śrī-caitanya-mahāprabhum
to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu
nīco 'pi yat-prasādāt syād
a lowly one even by whose mercy may become
bhakti-śāstra-pravartakaḥ
of the scriptures of devotion a promulgator

1 I bow down to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, whose opulence is boundless and wondrous. By His mercy even the lowly may bring forth the scriptures of devotion.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who possesses unlimited and wondrous opulence: by His mercy even a lowly person can become a propagator of the scriptures of devotion.

Anubhāṣya.
yat (*yasya*) **prasādāt** (by whose mercy) **nīcaḥ** (one absorbed in worldly things) **api bhakti-śāstra-pravartakaḥ** (an author of the scriptures of devotion) **syāt**, **taṁ anantādbhutaiśvaryaṁ** (full of unlimited opulence never seen before) **śrī-caitanya-mahāprabhuṁ ahaṁ vande**.

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌর ভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory of Gaura the devotees to the multitude

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![1]

Sanātana in prison receives from Śrī Rūpa the letter mentioned before —

এথা গৌড়ে সনাতন আছে বন্দিশালে ।
শ্রীরূপ-গোসাঞির পত্রী আইল হেনকালে ॥ ৩ ॥

ethā gauḍe sanātana āche bandi-śāle
here in Gauḍa Sanātana was in prison
śrī-rūpa-gosāñira patrī āila hena-kāle
of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī a letter came at that time

3 Meanwhile, in Gauḍa, Sanātana was still in prison when a letter from Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī reached him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Patrī (letter). The commentator on the book *Udbhaṭa-candrikā* writes that Śrī Rūpa wrote the following *śloka* in Bākalā and sent it to Sanātana in the prison of Gauḍa. Since the *śloka* hints that Mahāprabhu had gone to Mathurā, it can be trusted as Rūpa Gosvāmī's letter: "Where now is Mathurā, the city of the Lord of the Yadus? Where is Uttara-Kośalā of the Lord of the Raghus? Reflecting on this, make your mind steady and know for certain that this world is not lasting."

Sanātana's joy; he flatters the jailer —

পত্রী পাঞা সনাতন আনন্দিত হৈলা ।
যবন-রক্ষক-পাশ কহিতে লাগিলা ॥ ৪ ॥

patrī pāñā sanātana ānandita hailā
the letter receiving Sanātana delighted became
yavana-rakṣaka-pāśa kahite lāgilā
to the yavana jailer to speak he began

4 Sanātana was delighted to receive the letter, and he began to speak to the yavana who guarded him:

তুমি এক জিন্দাপীর মহাভাগ্যবান্ ।
কেতাব-কোরাণ শাস্ত্রে আছে তোমার জ্ঞান ॥ ৫ ॥

tumi eka jindā-pīra mahā-bhāgyavān
you are a living saint (jindā-pīr) greatly fortunate
ketāba-korāṇa śāstre āche tomāra jñāna
in the books and the Koran the scriptures is your knowledge

5 "You are a *jindā-pīr*, a living saint, and greatly fortunate. You are learned in the Koran and the other scriptures.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Jindā-pīr — a living *pīr* (saint).

এক বন্দী ছাড়ে যদি নিজ-ধর্ম্ম দেখিয়া ।
সংসার হইতে তারে মুক্ত করেন গোসাঞা ॥ ৬ ॥

eka bandī chāḍe yadi nija-dharma dekhiyā
one prisoner releases if one's own religion regarding
saṁsāra haite tāre mukta karena gosāñā
from worldly existence him liberated makes the Lord

6 If someone, true to his own religion, releases a prisoner, the Lord frees him from worldly existence.

Anubhāṣya.
Gosāñā — Khodā, Bhagavān.

The request for a favour in return —

পূর্ব্বে আমি তোমার কৈরাছি উপকার ।
তুমি আমা ছাড়ি' কর প্রত্যুপকার ॥ ৭ ॥

pūrve āmi tomāra kairāchi upakāra
before I for you have done favours
tumi āmā chāḍi' kara pratyupakāra
you me releasing do a favour in return

7 I have done you favours in the past. Now release me and return the favour.

For the sake of pure service to Hari, Sanātana turns even an act condemned by worldly morality to favourable use — this is the true dharma —

পাঁচ সহস্র মুদ্রা তুমি কর অঙ্গীকার ।
পুণ্য, অর্থ, — দুই লাভ হইবে তোমার ॥ ৮ ॥

pāṁca sahasra mudrā tumi kara aṅgīkāra
five thousand coins you make acceptance
puṇya, artha, — dui lābha haibe tomāra
merit wealth two gains will be yours

8 Please accept five thousand coins. You will gain twice over — merit and wealth."

The jailer fears the king —

তবে সেই যবন কহে, — শুন, মহাশয় ।
তোমারে ছাড়িব, কিন্তু করি রাজভয় ॥ ৯ ॥

tabe sei yavana kahe, — śuna, mahāśaya
then that yavana says listen sir (mahāśaya)
tomāre chāḍiba, kintu kari rāja-bhaya
you I would release but I have fear of the king

9 The yavana replied, "Listen, sir. I would release you, but I fear the king."

Sanātana gives advice —

সনাতন কহে, — তুমি না কর রাজ-ভয় ।
দক্ষিণ গিয়াছে যদি লেউটি' আওয়য় ॥ ১০ ॥

তাঁহারে কহিও — সেই বাহ্যকৃত্যে গেল ।
গঙ্গার নিকট গঙ্গা দেখি' ঝাঁপ দিল ॥ ১১ ॥

sanātana kahe, — tumi nā kara rāja-bhaya
Sanātana says you do not have fear of the king
dakṣiṇa giyāche yadi leuṭi' āoyaya
to the south he has gone if coming back he returns
tāṁhāre kahio — sei bāhya-kṛtye gela
to him say he to relieve himself went
gaṅgāra nikaṭa gaṅgā dekhi' jhāṁpa dila
of the Gaṅgā near the Gaṅgā seeing a leap he made

10–11 Sanātana said, "Do not fear the king. He has gone south. If he comes back, tell him that I went out to relieve myself and, coming near the Gaṅgā and seeing it, jumped in.

Anubhāṣya.
Leuṭi āoyaya — comes back. *Lauṭ āwaye* — the Hindi of the western regions.

অনেক দেখিল, তার লাগ্ না পাইল ।
দাড়ুকা-সহিত ডুবি কাঁহা বহি' গেল ॥ ১২ ॥

aneka dekhila, tāra lāg nā pāila
much you looked his trace not you found
dāḍukā-sahita ḍubi kāṁhā vahi' gela
with the fetters drowning somewhere carried away he went

12 Tell him that you searched long but found no trace of me — that I drowned with my fetters on and was carried away somewhere.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Dāḍukā — fetters.

কিছু ভয় নাহি, আমি এ-দেশে না রব ।
দরবেশ হঞা আমি মক্কাকে যাইব ॥ ১৩ ॥

kichu bhaya nāhi, āmi e-deśe nā raba
any fear there is not I in this land will not stay
daraveśa hañā āmi makkāke yāiba
a dervish becoming I to Mecca will go

13 There is nothing to fear: I shall not stay in this land. I shall become a dervish and go to Mecca."

The jailer is dissatisfied; Sanātana tries to give him a larger bribe —

তথাপি যবন-মন প্রসন্ন না দেখিলা ।
সাত-হাজার মুদ্রা তার আগে রাশি কৈলা ॥ ১৪ ॥

tathāpi yavana-mana prasanna nā dekhilā
still of the yavana the mind pleased not he saw
sāta-hājāra mudrā tāra āge rāśi kailā
seven thousand coins before him in a heap he made

14 Still Sanātana saw that the yavana was not satisfied, so he heaped seven thousand coins before him.

Sanātana is released from prison —

লোভ হইল যবনের মুদ্রা দেখিয়া ।
রাত্রে গঙ্গাপার কৈল দাড়ুকা কাটিয়া ॥ ১৫ ॥

lobha haila yavanera mudrā dekhiyā
greed arose of the yavana the coins seeing
rātre gaṅgā-pāra kaila dāḍukā kāṭiyā
at night the crossing of the Gaṅgā he made the fetters cutting

15 At the sight of the coins the yavana grew greedy. That night he cut off Sanātana's fetters and took him across the Gaṅgā.

Sanātana comes with Īśāna to the Pātaḍā hills —

গড়দ্বার-পথ ছাড়িলা, নারে তাঁহা যাইতে ।
রাত্রি-দিন চলি' আইলা পাতড়া-পর্ব্বতে ॥ ১৬ ॥

gaḍa-dvāra-patha chāḍilā, nāre tāṁhā yāite
the road by the fort gate he gave up he could not there go
rātri-dina cali' āilā pātaḍā-parvate
night and day walking he came to the Pātaḍā hills

16 Sanātana avoided the road through the fort gate, for he could not go that way. Walking night and day, he came to the Pātaḍā hills.

Meeting with the chief of the robbers —

তথা এক ভৌমিক হয়, তার ঠাঞি গেলা ।
'পর্ব্বত পার কর আমায় — বিনতি করিলা ॥ ১৭ ॥

tathā eka bhaumika haya, tāra ṭhāñi gelā
there a landholder (bhaumika) was to him he went
'parvata pāra kara āmāya — vinati karilā
the hills across take me a request he made

17 There lived a landholder (*bhaumika*). Sanātana went to him and humbly asked, "Please take me across the hills."

From the mouth of a palmist (sāmudrika) the bhūñā learns that Sanātana has money, and resolves to kill him —

সেই ভূঞার সঙ্গে হয় হাতগণিতা ।
ভূঞার কাণে কহে সেই জানি' এই কথা ॥ ১৮ ॥

sei bhūñāra saṅge haya hāta-gaṇitā
of that landholder with him was a palmist
bhūñāra kāṇe kahe sei jāni' ei kathā
in the landholder's ear says he knowing this matter

18 With that landholder was a palmist. Perceiving the matter, he whispered into the landholder's ear,

ইঁহার ঠাঞি সুবর্ণের অষ্ট মোহর হয় ।
শুনি' আনন্দিত ভূঞা সনাতনে কয় ॥ ১৯ ॥

iṁhāra ṭhāñi suvarṇera aṣṭa mohara haya
with this man of gold eight mohurs there are
śuni' ānandita bhūñā sanātane kaya
hearing delighted the landholder to Sanātana says

19 "This man has eight gold mohurs." Hearing this, the landholder was delighted and said to Sanātana,

The robber receives Sanātana warmly; Sanātana bathes and eats —

রাত্রে পর্ব্বত পার করিব নিজ-লোক দিয়া ।
ভোজন করহ তুমি রন্ধন করিয়া ॥ ২০ ॥

rātre parvata pāra kariba nija-loka diyā
tonight the hills crossing I will make my own men giving
bhojana karaha tumi randhana kariyā
a meal take you cooking having done

20 "Tonight I will have my own men take you across the hills. Meanwhile, cook and have your meal."

এত বলি' অন্ন দিল করিয়া সম্মান ।
সনাতন আসি' তবে কৈল নদীস্নান ॥ ২১ ॥

eta bali' anna dila kariyā sammāna
so saying grain he gave showing respect
sanātana āsi' tabe kaila nadī-snāna
Sanātana going then made a bath in the river

21 With these words he respectfully gave him food grains, and Sanātana went and bathed in the river.

দুই উপবাসে কৈলা রন্ধন-ভোজনে ।
রাজমন্ত্রী সনাতন বিচারিলা মনে ॥ ২২ ॥

dui upavāse kailā randhana-bhojane
after a fast of two days he did cooking and eating
rāja-mantrī sanātana vicārilā mane
the royal minister Sanātana reflected in his mind

22 Having fasted for two days, he cooked and ate. But Sanātana, once a royal minister, began to reflect:

Anubhāṣya.
Dui upavāse — having fasted for two days.

Sanātana's doubt and alarm; from Īśāna he learns of the money —

এই ভূঞা কেনে মোরে সম্মান করিল ?
এত চিন্তি' সনাতন ঈশানে পুছিল ॥ ২৩ ॥

ei bhūñā kene more sammāna karila?
this landholder why to me respect has shown
eta cinti' sanātana īśāne puchila
thus thinking Sanātana Īśāna asked

23 "Why has this landholder shown me such respect?" Thinking this, Sanātana asked Īśāna,

তোমার ঠাঞি জানি কিছু দ্রব্য আছয় ।
ঈশান কহে, — মোর ঠাঞি সাত মোহর হয় ॥ ২৪ ॥

tomāra ṭhāñi jāni kichu dravya āchaya
with you I know some valuables there are
īśāna kahe, — mora ṭhāñi sāta mohara haya
Īśāna says with me seven mohurs there are

24 "I know you have some valuables with you." Īśāna replied, "I have seven mohurs."

Anubhāṣya.
Haya — is: in the Hindi of the western regions, *hai*.

Rebuke to Īśāna —

শুনি' সনাতন তারে করিলা ভর্ৎসন ।
সঙ্গে কেনে আনিয়াছ এই কাল-যম ? ॥ ২৫ ॥

śuni' sanātana tāre karilā bhartsana
hearing Sanātana him made rebuke
saṅge kene āniyācha ei kāla-yama?
with you why have you brought this death (kāla-yama)

25 Hearing this, Sanātana rebuked him: "Why have you brought this death along with you?"

Sanātana gives the robber the money and asks for help —

তবে সেই সাত মোহর হস্তেতে করিয়া ।
ভূঞার কাছে যাঞা কহে মোহর ধরিয়া ॥ ২৬ ॥

tabe sei sāta mohara hastete kariyā
then those seven mohurs in his hand taking
bhūñāra kāche yāñā kahe mohara dhariyā
the landholder near going says the mohurs holding out

26 Then he took the seven mohurs in his hand, went to the landholder and, holding out the coins, said,

এই সাত সুবর্ণ মোহর আছিল আমার ।
ইহা লঞা ধর্ম্ম দেখি' পর্ব্বত কর পার ॥ ২৭ ॥

ei sāta suvarṇa mohara āchila āmāra
these seven gold mohurs were mine
ihā lañā dharma dekhi' parvata kara pāra
this taking religion regarding the hills make crossing

27 "I had these seven gold mohurs. Take them, and as a matter of religious duty take me across the hills.

রাজবন্দী আমি, গড়দ্বার যাইতে না পারি ৷
পুণ্য হবে, পর্ব্বত আমা দেহ' পার করি ॥ ২৮ ॥

rāja-bandī āmi, gaḍa-dvāra yāite nā pāri
a royal prisoner I am by the fort gate to go not I can
puṇya habe, parvata āmā deha' pāra kari
merit there will be the hills me give crossing having made

28 I am the king's prisoner and cannot go by the fort gate. You will earn merit — take me across the hills."

The robber gives up his plan to kill, refuses the money and agrees to help —

ভূঞা হাসি' কহে, — আমি জানিয়াছি পহিলে ৷
অষ্ট মোহর হয় তোমার সেবক-আঁচলে ॥ ২৯ ॥

bhūñā hāsi' kahe, — āmi jāniyāchi pahile
the landholder smiling says I had known before
aṣṭa mohara haya tomāra sevaka-āṁcale
eight mohurs there are of your servant in the hem of the cloth

29 The landholder smiled and said, "I knew it already: your servant has eight mohurs tied in the hem of his cloth.

তোমা মারি' মোহর লইতাম আজিকার রাত্রে ৷
ভাল হৈল, কহিলা তুমি, ছুটিলাঙ পাপ হৈতে ॥ ৩০ ॥

tomā māri' mohara laitāma ājikāra rātre
you killing the mohurs I would have taken of today night
bhāla haila, kahilā tumi, chuṭilāṅa pāpa haite
good it was told you I was freed from sin

30 Tonight I would have killed you and taken the mohurs. It is good that you told me — I have been spared that sin.

সন্তুষ্ট হইলাঙ আমি, মোহর না লইব ৷
পুণ্য লাগি' পর্ব্বত তোমা পার করি' দিব ॥ ৩১ ॥

santuṣṭa hailāṅa āmi, mohara nā laiba
satisfied have become I the mohurs not I will take
puṇya lāgi' parvata tomā pāra kari' diba
of merit for the sake the hills you across taking I will give

31 I am pleased. I will not take the mohurs. For the sake of merit alone I will take you across the hills."

গোসাঞি কহে, — কেহ দ্রব্য লইবে আমা মারি' ।
আমার প্রাণ রক্ষা কর দ্রব্য অঙ্গীকরি' ॥ ৩২ ॥

gosāñi kahe, — keha dravya laibe āmā māri'
the Gosvāmī says someone the valuables will take me killing
āmāra prāṇa rakṣā kara dravya aṅgīkari'
my life protection do the valuables accepting

32 Sanātana Gosvāmī said, "Someone else will kill me for these valuables. Accept them and save my life."

The robber helps Sanātana cross the hills —

তবে ভূঞা গোসাঞির সঙ্গে চারি পাইক দিল ।
রাত্রে রাত্রে বনপথে পর্ব্বত পার কৈল ॥ ৩৩ ॥

tabe bhūñā gosāñira saṅge cāri pāika dila
then the landholder with the Gosvāmī four armed men gave
rātre rātre vana-pathe parvata pāra kaila
night after night by forest paths the hills across took

33 Then the landholder sent four armed men with him, and night after night they led him across the hills along forest paths.

Sanātana asks Īśāna what he still has, and sends him home —

পার হঞা গোসাঞি তবে পুছিলা ঈশানে ।
জানি — শেষ দ্রব্য কিছু আছে তোমা-স্থানে ॥ ৩৪ ॥

pāra hañā gosāñi tabe puchilā īśāne
across having come the Gosvāmī then asked Īśāna
jāni — śeṣa dravya kichu āche tomā-sthāne
I know remaining valuables some are with you

34 Having crossed, Sanātana Gosvāmī asked Īśāna, "I know you still have something left with you."

ঈশান কহে, — এক মোহর আছে অবশেষ ।
গোসাঞি কহে, — মোহর লঞা যাহ' তুমি দেশ ॥ ৩৫ ॥

īśāna kahe, — eka mohara āche avaśeṣa
Īśāna says one mohur is remaining
gosāñi kahe, — mohara lañā yāha' tumi deśa
the Gosvāmī says the mohur taking go you home

35 Īśāna replied, "One mohur is left." Sanātana Gosvāmī said, "Take the mohur and go home."

Sanātana, possessing nothing (akiñcana), without any provisions, goes on alone —

তারে বিদায় দিয়া গোসাঞি চলিলা একলা ।
হাতে করোঁয়া, ছিঁড়া কান্থা, নির্ভয় হইলা ॥ ৩৬ ॥

tāre vidāya diyā gosāñi calilā ekalā
him leave giving the Gosvāmī went on alone
hāte karoṁyā, chiṁḍā kānthā, nirbhaya hailā
in his hand a water pot a torn quilt free from fear he became

36 Sending him away, Sanātana Gosvāmī went on alone. With nothing but a water pot in his hand and a torn quilt, he was now free from fear.

Sanātana arrives in Hājipura —

চলি' চলি' গোসাঞি তবে আইলা হাজিপুরে ।
সন্ধ্যাকালে বসিলা এক উদ্যান-ভিতরে ॥ ৩৭ ॥

cali' cali' gosāñi tabe āilā hājipure
walking walking the Gosvāmī then came to Hājipura
sandhyā-kāle vasilā eka udyāna-bhitare
in the evening he sat down a garden within

37 Walking on and on, Sanātana Gosvāmī came to Hājipura, and in the evening he sat down in a garden.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Hājipura lies opposite Patna, across the river, where the river Gaṅgā meets the river Gaṇḍaka.

There he meets his sister's husband, the royal servant Śrīkānta —

সেই হাজিপুরে রহে, শ্রীকান্ত তার নাম ।
গোসাঞির ভগিনীপতি, করে রাজকাম ॥ ৩৮ ॥

sei hājipure rahe, śrīkānta tāra nāma
in that Hājipura lived Śrīkānta his name
gosāñira bhaginī-pati, kare rāja-kāma
of the Gosvāmī the sister's husband he does the king's work

38 In Hājipura lived Śrīkānta, the husband of Sanātana's sister, who was in the king's service.

তিন লক্ষ মুদ্রা রাজা দিয়াছে তার স্থানে ।
ঘোড়া মূল্য লঞা পাঠায় পাৎসার স্থানে ॥ ৩৯ ॥

tina lakṣa mudrā rājā diyāche tāra sthāne
three lakhs of coins the king had given to him
ghoḍā mūlya lañā pāṭhāya pātsāra sthāne
horses the price taking he sends to the emperor

39 The king had given him three hundred thousand coins; with this money he bought horses and sent them to the emperor.

Conversation with Sanātana —

টুঙ্গির উপর বসি' সেই গোসাঞিরে দেখিল ।
রাত্রে একজন-সঙ্গে গোসাঞি-পাশ আইল ॥ ৪০ ॥

ṭuṅgira upara vasi' sei gosāñire dekhila
a tower on sitting he the Gosvāmī saw
rātre eka-jana-saṅge gosāñi-pāśa āila
at night with one man to the Gosvāmī he came

40 Sitting on a tower, Śrīkānta saw Sanātana Gosvāmī, and at night he came to him with one attendant.

দুইজন মিলি' তথা ইষ্টগোষ্ঠী কৈল ।
বন্ধন-মোক্ষণ-কথা গোসাঞি সকলি কহিল ॥ ৪১ ॥

dui-jana mili' tathā iṣṭa-goṣṭhī kaila
the two meeting there an intimate talk had
bandhana-mokṣaṇa-kathā gosāñi sakali kahila
of the imprisonment and release the story the Gosvāmī all told

41 The two met there and talked intimately, and Sanātana Gosvāmī told him the whole story of his imprisonment and release.

Śrīkānta asks Sanātana to stay —

তিঁহো কহে, — দিন-দুই রহ এই স্থানে ।
ভদ্র হও, ছাড়' এই মলিন বসনে ॥ ৪২ ॥

tiṁho kahe, — dina-dui raha ei sthāne
he says a couple of days stay in this place
bhadra hao, chāḍa' ei malina vasane
become presentable give up these dirty clothes

42 Śrīkānta said, "Stay here a couple of days. Make yourself presentable and give up these dirty clothes."

Sanātana declines and asks to be taken across the Gaṅgā —

গোসাঞি কহে, — একক্ষণ ইহা না রহিব ।
গঙ্গা পার করি' দেহ' এক্ষণে চলিব ॥ ৪৩ ॥

gosāñi kahe, — eka-kṣaṇa ihā nā rahiba
the Gosvāmī says even a moment here not I will stay
gaṅgā pāra kari' deha' e-kṣaṇe caliba
the Gaṅgā across take me at once I will go

43 Sanātana Gosvāmī said, "I will not stay here even a moment. Take me across the Gaṅgā; I must go at once."

Śrīkānta takes Sanātana across the Gaṅgā and gives him a woollen Bhoṭa blanket —

যত্ন করি' তিঁহো এক ভোটকম্বল দিল ।
গঙ্গা পার করি' দিল — গোসাঞি চলিল ॥ ৪৪ ॥

yatna kari' tiṁho eka bhoṭa-kambala dila
with care he a woollen Bhoṭa blanket gave
gaṅgā pāra kari' dila — gosāñi calila
the Gaṅgā across he took the Gosvāmī went on

44 Śrīkānta lovingly gave him a woollen Bhoṭa blanket and took him across the Gaṅgā, and Sanātana Gosvāmī went on his way.

Sanātana arrives in Kāśī —

তবে বারাণসী গোসাঞি আইলা কতদিনে ।
শুনি' আনন্দিত হইলা প্রভুর আগমনে ॥ ৪৫ ॥

tabe vārāṇasī gosāñi āilā kata-dine
then to Vārāṇasī the Gosvāmī came in some days
śuni' ānandita hailā prabhura āgamane
hearing delighted he became of the Lord's arrival

45 After some days Sanātana Gosvāmī reached Vārāṇasī, and he was overjoyed to hear that the Lord had arrived there.

Sanātana at Candraśekhara's house —

চন্দ্রশেখরের ঘরে আসি' দ্বারেতে বসিলা ।
মহাপ্রভু জানি' চন্দ্রশেখরে কহিলা ॥ ৪৬ ॥

candraśekharera ghare āsi' dvārete vasilā
to Candraśekhara's house coming at the door he sat
mahāprabhu jāni' candraśekhare kahilā
Mahāprabhu knowing to Candraśekhara said

46 He came to Candraśekhara's house and sat down at the door. Mahāprabhu knew this and said to Candraśekhara,

The Lord tells Śekhara to bring in Sanātana, a true Vaiṣṇava who has no need of outward dress —

দ্বারে এক 'বৈষ্ণব' হয়, বোলাহ তাঁহারে ।
চন্দ্রশেখর দেখে — 'বৈষ্ণব' নাহিক দ্বারে ॥ ৪৭ ॥

dvāre eka 'vaiṣṇava' haya, bolāha tāṁhāre
at the door a Vaiṣṇava there is call him
candraśekhara dekhe — 'vaiṣṇava' nāhika dvāre
Candraśekhara sees a Vaiṣṇava there is not at the door

47 "There is a Vaiṣṇava at the door. Call him in." Candraśekhara looked, but saw no Vaiṣṇava at the door.

Not seeing the outward dress of a Vaiṣṇava on Sanātana, Candraśekhara comes back —

দ্বারেতে বৈষ্ণব নাহি' — প্রভুরে কহিল ।
কেহ হয় করি' প্রভু তাহারে পুছিল ॥ ৪৮ ॥

dvārete vaiṣṇava nāhi' — prabhure kahila
at the door a Vaiṣṇava there is not to the Lord he said
keha haya kari' prabhu tāhāre puchila
anyone is there saying the Lord him asked

48 He told the Lord, “There is no Vaiṣṇava at the door.” The Lord asked him, “Is anyone there at all?”

The Lord orders him to bring in Sanātana, who is dressed as a dervish —

তিঁহো কহে, — এক ‘দরবেশ’ আছে দ্বারে ।
তাঁরে আন’ প্রভুর বাক্যে কহিল আসি’ তাঁরে ॥ ৪৯ ॥

tiṁho kahe, — eka ‘daraveśa’ āche dvāre
he says a dervish is at the door
tāṁre āna’ prabhura vākye kahila āsi’ tāṁre
him bring at the Lord’s word he said coming to him

49 He replied, “There is a dervish at the door.” “Bring him in,” said the Lord, and at His word Candraśekhara came out and said to him,

Candraśekhara addresses Sanātana as “dervish” —

প্রভু তোমায় বোলায়, আইস, দরবেশ! ।
শুনি’ আনন্দে সনাতন করিলা প্রবেশ ॥ ৫০ ॥

prabhu tomāya bolāya, āisa, daraveśa!
the Lord you is calling come dervish
śuni’ ānande sanātana karilā praveśa
hearing in joy Sanātana made entrance

50 “The Lord is calling you. Come in, dervish!” Hearing this, Sanātana joyfully went in.

Seeing Sanātana, the Lord comes swiftly to him and embraces him —

তাঁহারে অঙ্গনে দেখি’ প্রভু ধাঞা আইলা ।
তাঁরে আলিঙ্গন করি’ প্রেমাবিষ্ট হৈলা ॥ ৫১ ॥

tāṁhāre aṅgane dekhi’ prabhu dhāñā āilā
him in the courtyard seeing the Lord running came
tāṁre āliṅgana kari’ premāviṣṭa hailā
him an embrace making overwhelmed with love He became

51 Seeing him in the courtyard, the Lord came running, embraced him and was overwhelmed with love.

The embrace fills Sanātana with prema, and he speaks humbly —

প্রভুস্পর্শে প্রেমাবিষ্ট হইলা সনাতন ।
মোরে না ছুঁইহ — কহে গদগদ-বচন ॥ ৫২ ॥

prabhu-sparśe premāviṣṭa hailā sanātana
at the Lord's touch overwhelmed with love became Sanātana
more nā chuṁiha — kahe gadgada-vacana
me do not touch he says in a choked voice

52 At the Lord's touch Sanātana too was overwhelmed with love. In a voice choked with emotion he said, "Do not touch me!"

The Lord and Sanātana both weep with love; Candraśekhara is amazed —

দুইজনে গলাগলি রোদন অপার ।
দেখি' চন্দ্রশেখরের হইল চমৎকার ॥ ৫৩ ॥

dui-jane galāgali rodana apāra
the two embracing each other weeping boundless
dekhi' candraśekharera haila camatkāra
seeing of Candraśekhara there was amazement

53 Embracing each other, the two wept without end, and Candraśekhara was amazed to see it.

Lovingly the Lord seats Sanātana beside Him —

তবে প্রভু তাঁর হাত ধরি' লঞা গেলা ।
পিণ্ডার উপরে তাঁরে আপন-পাশ বসাইলা ॥ ৫৪ ॥

tabe prabhu tāṁra hāta dhari' lañā gelā
then the Lord his hand taking led him in
piṇḍāra upare tāṁre āpana-pāśa vasāilā
a raised platform upon him at His own side seated

54 Then the Lord took him by the hand, led him in and seated him beside Himself on a raised platform.

The Lord cleans Sanātana's body with His own hands; Sanātana speaks humbly —

শ্রীহস্তে করেন তাঁর অঙ্গ সম্মার্জ্জন ।
তিঁহো কহে, — মোরে, প্রভু, না কর স্পর্শন ॥ ৫৫ ॥

śrī-haste karena tāṁra aṅga sammārjana
with His holy hand He does his body cleansing
tiṁho kahe, — more, prabhu, nā kara sparśana
he says me O Lord do not make touching

55 With His own hand the Lord wiped Sanātana's body clean. Sanātana said, "O Lord, do not touch me!"

The Lord honours him as befits a mahā-bhāgavata —

প্রভু কহে, — তোমা স্পর্শি আত্ম পবিত্রিতে ।
ভক্তি-বলে পার তুমি ব্রহ্মাণ্ড শোধিতে ॥ ৫৬ ॥

prabhu kahe, — tomā sparśi ātma pavitrite
the Lord says you I touch Myself to purify
bhakti-bale pāra tumi brahmāṇḍa śodhite
by the power of devotion can you the universe purify

56 The Lord said, "I touch you to purify Myself, for by the power of your devotion you can purify the entire universe."

ভবদ্বিধা ভাগবতাস্তীর্থভূতাঃ স্বয়ং প্রভো ।
তীর্থীকুর্ব্বন্তি তীর্থানি স্বান্তঃস্থেন গদাভৃতা ॥ ৫৭ ॥

bhavad-vidhā bhāgavatās
like you devotees
tīrtha-bhūtāḥ svayaṁ prabho
holy places being yourselves, O lord
tīrthī-kurvanti tīrthāni
make holy the holy places
svāntaḥ-sthena gadā-bhṛtā
by Him within who bears the club

57 "Devotees such as you are themselves holy places, my lord. By the Lord who dwells within your hearts, you make even the holy places holy." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.13.10)[2]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.63.

ন মেঽভক্তশ্চতুর্ব্বেদী মদ্ভক্তঃ শ্বপচঃ প্রিয়ঃ ।
তস্মৈ দেয়ং ততো গ্রাহ্যং স চ পূজ্যো যথা হ্যহম্ ॥ ৫৮ ॥

na me 'bhaktaś catur-vedī
not to Me a nondevotee a knower of the four Vedas
mad-bhaktaḥ śva-pacaḥ priyaḥ
My devotee a dog-eater dear
tasmai deyaṁ tato grāhyaṁ
to him should be given from him should be accepted
sa ca pūjyo yathā hy aham
he and is to be worshipped as indeed I

58 "Even a knower of the four Vedas is not dear to Me if he is not devoted to Me, but My devotee is dear to Me even if he was born a dog-eater. One should give to him and accept from him; he is to be worshipped just as I am." (Itihāsa-samuccaya, quoted in Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, 10.91)[3]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 19.50.

বিপ্রাদ্দ্বিষড্গুণযুতাদরবিন্দনাভ-
পাদারবিন্দবিমুখাৎ শ্বপচং বরিষ্ঠম্ ।
মন্যে তদর্পিত-মনোবচনেহিতার্থ-
প্রাণং পুনাতি স কুলং ন তু ভূরিমানঃ ॥ ৫৯ ॥

viprād dvi-ṣaḍ-guṇa-yutād aravinda-nābha-
than a brāhmaṇa twelve qualities endowed with of the lotus-naveled Lord
pādāravinda-vimukhāt śva-pacaṁ variṣṭham
from the lotus feet averse a dog-eater better
manye tad-arpita-mano-vacanehitārtha-
I consider to Him offered mind words deeds wealth
prāṇaṁ punāti sa kulaṁ na tu bhūri-mānaḥ
and life purifies he his family not but one full of pride

59 "I consider a dog-eater whose mind, words, deeds, wealth and very life are offered to the Lord of the lotus navel better than a brāhmaṇa endowed with the twelve qualities who has turned away from His lotus feet. Such a devotee purifies his whole family; the brāhmaṇa swollen with pride cannot." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 7.9.10)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I consider even a *śva-paca* (dog-eater) whose mind, words, endeavours, wealth and life are offered to Kṛṣṇa to be better than a brāhmaṇa who has twelve qualities but is averse to Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet. For he — the devotee born in a family of *śva-pacas* — purifies his own family, whereas the brāhmaṇa swollen with pride cannot do so.

Anubhāṣya.

Devarṣi Nārada is telling Dharmarāja Yudhiṣṭhira how Bhagavān Śrī Nṛsiṁha slew Hiraṇyakaśipu, and in that account he recites the prayer that the devotee Prahlāda offered to Bhagavān Nṛsiṁha after the slaying.

aravinda-nābha-pāda-aravinda-vimukhāt (averse to the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa, whose navel is like a lotus) **dviṣaḍ-guṇa-yutāt** (possessed of twelve qualities — those named in the previous *śloka*: wealth, noble birth, beauty, austerity, learning, sensory vigour (*ojas*), lustre (*tejas*), influence, bodily strength, diligence, intelligence and yoga; or else the twelve qualities named by Sanatsujāta in the *Mahābhārata*: "Righteousness, truthfulness, self-control, austerity, freedom from

envy, modesty, forbearance, freedom from malice, sacrifice, charity, steadfastness and learning — these are the twelve vows of a *brāhmaṇa*"; or else the twelve qualities named in the commentary on the *Muktā-phala*: "Tranquillity, self-control, austerity, purity, forbearance, straightforwardness, detachment, knowledge, realisation (*vijñāna*), contentment, truthfulness and faith in God — the twelve qualities" — possessed of these) **viprāt api tad-arpita-mano-vacanehitārtha-prāṇaṁ** (one who has given to Him — to Kṛṣṇa, whose navel is like a lotus — his mind, words, deeds, wealth and life) **śva-pacaṁ variṣṭhaṁ** (the best) **ahaṁ manye**; for **saḥ** (such a *śva-paca*) **kulaṁ** (his whole family) **punāti**, **bhūri-mānaḥ** (one whose pride is great) a brāhmaṇa **tu** (even himself) **na** (does not purify — what to speak of his family?). For in one who lacks devotion these qualities serve only pride, not purification; the sense, then, is that he is lower.

All the senses find their purpose only in serving devotees —

তোমা দেখি, তোমা স্পর্শি, গাই তোমার গুণ।
সর্ব্বেন্দ্রিয়-ফল, — এই শাস্ত্রের নিরূপণ ॥ ৬০ ॥

tomā dekhi, tomā sparśi, gāi tomāra guṇa
you I see you I touch I sing your qualities
sarvendriya-phala, — ei śāstrera nirūpaṇa
of all the senses the fruit this of the scriptures the conclusion

60 "To see you, to touch you and to sing your qualities is the fruit of all the senses; such is the verdict of the scriptures."

Pure devotees of Bhagavān are very rare in this world —

অক্ষ্ণোঃ ফলং ত্বাদৃশ-দর্শনং হি
তনোঃ ফলং ত্বাদৃশ-গাত্রসঙ্গঃ।
জিহ্বা-ফলং ত্বাদৃশ-কীর্ত্তনং হি
সুদুর্ল্লভা ভাগবতা হি লোকে ॥ ৬১ ॥

akṣṇoḥ phalaṁ tvādṛśa-darśanaṁ hi
of the eyes the fruit of one like you the sight indeed
tanoḥ phalaṁ tvādṛśa-gātra-saṅgaḥ
of the body the fruit of one like you bodily contact
jihvā-phalaṁ tvādṛśa-kīrtanaṁ hi
of the tongue the fruit of one like you the glorification indeed
su-durlabhā bhāgavatā hi loke
very rare devotees of the Lord indeed in the world

61 "The fruit of the eyes is to see one like you; the fruit of the body is to touch the body of one like you; the fruit of the tongue is to glorify one like you. Pure devotees of the Lord are very rare in this world." (Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya, 13.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Vaiṣṇava, the fruit of the eyes is to see a person like you; the fruit of the body is to touch the body of a person like you; the fruit of the tongue is to glorify the qualities of a person like you. For in this world *bhāgavatas* are very rare.

Anubhāṣya.
tvādṛśa-darśanaṁ (seeing with faith *bhāgavatas* like you) **akṣoḥ** (of the eyes — of their work of seeing) **phalam** (the purpose); **tvādṛśa-gātra-saṅgaḥ** (touching the bodies of devotees like you) **tanoḥ** (of the body — of the work of maintaining it) **phalam**; **tvādṛśa-kīrtanaṁ** (glorifying the qualities of devotees like you) **hi** (indeed) **jihvā-phalaṁ** (the purpose of uttering words); (therefore) **loke** (in the world) **bhāgavatāḥ** (pure devotees) **sudurlabhāḥ** (very hard to attain) **hi** (indeed).

The glory of Kṛṣṇa's causeless mercy; the Lord Himself is the chief sūtradhāra (stage-director) of the play in which Sanātana is freed from bondage —

এত কহি কহে প্রভু, — শুন, সনাতন ।
কৃষ্ণ — বড় দয়াময়, পতিত পাবন ॥ ৬২ ॥

eta kahi kahe prabhu, — śuna, sanātana
so saying says the Lord listen Sanātana
kṛṣṇa — baḍa dayāmaya, patita pāvana
Kṛṣṇa very merciful of the fallen the purifier

62 Having said this, the Lord continued, “Listen, Sanātana. Kṛṣṇa is most merciful; He is the purifier of the fallen.

মহা-রৌরব হৈতে তোমা করিলা উদ্ধার ।
কৃপার সমুদ্র কৃষ্ণ গম্ভীর অপার ॥ ৬৩ ॥

mahā-raurava haite tomā karilā uddhāra
from the hell Mahā-raurava you He made deliverance
kṛpāra samudra kṛṣṇa gambhīra apāra
of mercy the ocean Kṛṣṇa deep boundless

63 He has delivered you from the hell called Mahā-raurava. Kṛṣṇa is an ocean of mercy, deep and boundless.”

Anubhāṣya.
Mahā-raurava: one who kills animals for a living goes to the hell called *mahā-raurava* (see *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.26.10–12).

Sanātana knows the Lord to be nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa —

সনাতন কহে, — কৃষ্ণ আমি নাহি জানি ।
আমার উদ্ধার-হেতু তোমার কৃপা মানি ॥ ৬৪ ॥

sanātana kahe, — kṛṣṇa āmi nāhi jāni
Sanātana says Kṛṣṇa I do not know
āmāra uddhāra-hetu tomāra kṛpā māni
of my deliverance the cause Your mercy I consider

64 Sanātana replied, “I do not know Kṛṣṇa. I consider Your mercy alone the cause of my deliverance.”

Answering the Lord’s question, Sanātana tells his story —

কেমনে ছুটিলা বলি’ প্রভু প্রশ্ন কৈলা ।
আদ্যোপান্ত সব কথা তিঁহো শুনাইলা ॥ ৬৫ ॥

kemane chuṭilā bali' prabhu praśna kailā
how you escaped saying the Lord a question asked
ādyopānta saba kathā tiṁho śunāilā
from beginning to end the whole story he told

65 The Lord asked, "How did you escape?" and Sanātana told Him the whole story from beginning to end.

The Lord gives news of Rūpa and Anupama —

প্রভু কহে, — তোমার দুই ভাই প্রয়াগে মিলিলা ।
রূপ, অনুপম, — দুঁহে বৃন্দাবন গেলা ॥ ৬৬ ॥

prabhu kahe, — tomāra dui bhāi prayāge mililā
the Lord says your two brothers in Prayāga met Me
rūpa, anupama, — duṁhe vṛndāvana gelā
Rūpa Anupama both to Vṛndāvana have gone

66 The Lord said, "I met your two brothers, Rūpa and Anupama, in Prayāga. Both have gone on to Vṛndāvana."

Sanātana meets Tapana Miśra and Candraśekhara —

তপনমিশ্রেরে আর চন্দ্রশেখরেরে ।
প্রভু-আজ্ঞায় সনাতন মিলিলা দোঁহারে ॥ ৬৭ ॥

tapana-miśrere āra candraśekharere
Tapana Miśra and Candraśekhara
prabhu-ājñāya sanātana mililā doṁhāre
at the Lord's order Sanātana met both

67 At the Lord's bidding Sanātana met both Tapana Miśra and Candraśekhara.

Tapana Miśra invites Sanātana; the Lord tells Sanātana to have himself shaved

—

তপনমিশ্র তবে তাঁরে কৈলা নিমন্ত্রণ ।
প্রভু কহে, — ক্ষৌর করাহ, যাহ, সনাতন ॥ ৬৮ ॥

tapana-miśra tabe tāṁre kailā nimantraṇa
Tapana Miśra then him made invitation
prabhu kahe, — kṣaura karāha, yāha, sanātana
the Lord says a shave have go Sanātana

68 Tapana Miśra then invited him for his meals, and the Lord said, "Go and have a shave, Sanātana."

The Lord tells Candraśekhara to have Sanātana give up dress unfit for a Vaiṣṇava and put on a Vaiṣṇava's dress —

চন্দ্রশেখরেরে প্রভু কহে বোলাঞা ।
এই বেশ দূর কর, যাহ ইঁহারে লঞা ॥ ৬৯ ॥

candraśekharere prabhu kahe bolāñā
Candraśekhara the Lord says calling
ei veśa dūra kara, yāha iṁhāre lañā
this garb away put go him taking

69 Calling Candraśekhara, the Lord said, "Take him with you and remove this garb."

ভদ্র করাঞা তাঁরে গঙ্গাস্নান করাইল ।
শেখর আনিয়া তাঁরে নূতন বস্ত্র দিল ॥ ৭০ ॥

bhadra karāñā tāṁre gaṅgā-snāna karāila
shaved having made him a bath in the Gaṅgā had him take
śekhara āniyā tāṁre nūtana vastra dila
Śekhara bringing him new cloth gave

70 Candraśekhara had him shaved and bathed in the Gaṅgā, and then brought him new cloth.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhadra karāñā — having had him shaved: that is, having had his dervish beard and hair shaved off and making him dressed as a true Vaiṣṇava.

Sanātana declines to wear the new cloth that Candraśekhara gave —

সেই বস্ত্র সনাতন না কৈলা অঙ্গীকার ।
শুনিয়া প্রভুর মনে আনন্দ অপার ॥ ৭১ ॥

sei vastra sanātana nā kailā aṅgīkāra
that cloth Sanātana did not make acceptance
śuniyā prabhura mane ānanda apāra
hearing of the Lord in the mind joy boundless

71 Sanātana did not accept that cloth, and when the Lord heard this, His joy knew no bounds.

At midday the Lord takes His meal at Tapana Miśra's house; Sanātana receives the Lord's remnants —

মধ্যাহ্ন করিয়া প্রভু গেলা ভিক্ষা করিবারে ।
সনাতনে লঞা গেলা তপনমিশ্রের ঘরে ॥ ৭২ ॥

madhyāhna kariyā prabhu gelā bhikṣā karibāre
the midday duties having done the Lord went a meal to take
sanātane lañā gelā tapana-miśrera ghare
Sanātana taking He went of Tapana Miśra to the house

72 Having finished His midday duties, the Lord went to take His meal, and He took Sanātana with Him to Tapana Miśra's house.

পাদপ্রক্ষালন করি' ভিক্ষাতে বসিলা ।
সনাতনে ভিক্ষা দেহ — মিশ্রেরে কহিলা ॥ ৭৩ ॥

pāda-prakṣālana kari' bhikṣāte vasilā
the washing of the feet having done for the meal He sat
sanātane bhikṣā deha — miśrere kahilā
to Sanātana food give to Miśra He said

73 After washing His feet He sat down for the meal and said to Miśra, “Serve Sanātana too.”

মিশ্র কহে, — সনাতনের কিছু কৃত্য আছে ।
তুমি ভিক্ষা কর, প্রসাদ তাঁরে দিব পাছে ॥ ৭৪ ॥

miśra kahe, — sanātanera kichu kṛtya āche
Miśra says of Sanātana some duty there is
tumi bhikṣā kara, prasāda tāṁre diba pāche
You the meal take prasāda to him I will give afterwards

74 Miśra said, “Sanātana has something to attend to. Please take Your meal; I will give him prasāda afterwards.”

ভিক্ষা করি’ মহাপ্রভু বিশ্রাম করিলা ।
মিশ্র প্রভুর শেষপাত্র সনাতনে দিলা ॥ ৭৫ ॥

bhikṣā kari’ mahāprabhu viśrāma karilā
the meal having taken Mahāprabhu rest took
miśra prabhura śeṣa-pātra sanātane dilā
Miśra of the Lord the plate of remnants to Sanātana gave

75 After the meal Mahāprabhu lay down to rest, and Miśra gave Sanātana the plate with the Lord’s remnants.

Sanātana objects to wearing the new cloth that Miśra gave —

মিশ্র সনাতনে দিলা নূতন বসন ।
বস্ত্র নাহি নিলা, তিঁহো করে নিবেদন ॥ ৭৬ ॥

miśra sanātane dilā nūtana vasana
Miśra to Sanātana gave new cloth
vastra nāhi nilā, tiṁho kare nivedana
the cloth not he took he makes a request

76 Miśra offered Sanātana new cloth, but he would not take it. Instead he made a request:

Sanātana wishes to receive an old cloth worn by a Vaiṣṇava —

মোরে বস্ত্র দিতে যদি তোমার হয় মন ।
নিজ-পরিধান এক দেহ' 'পুরাতন' ॥ ৭৭ ॥

more vastra dite yadi tomāra haya mana
to me cloth to give if your is wish
nija-paridhāna eka deha' 'purātana'
of your own wear one give old

77 "If you wish to give me cloth, give me one of your own that is old."

He divides one piece of cloth into two outer garments and the waist-string and kaupīna that go with them —

তবে মিশ্র পুরাতন এক ধুতি দিলা ।
তিঁহো দুই বহির্ব্বাস-কৌপীন করিলা ॥ ৭৮ ॥

tabe miśra purātana eka dhuti dilā
then Miśra old one dhoti gave
tiṁho dui bahirvāsa-kaupīna karilā
he two outer cloths and loincloths made

78 Then Miśra gave him an old dhoti, and Sanātana made it into two sets of outer cloth (*bahirvāsa*) and loincloth (*kaupīna*).

Sanātana meets the brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra —

মহারাষ্ট্রীয় দ্বিজে প্রভু মিলাইলা সনাতনে ।
সেই বিপ্র তাঁরে কৈল মহা-নিমন্ত্রণে ॥ ৭৯ ॥

mahārāṣṭrīya dvije prabhu milāilā sanātane
to a Mahārāṣṭrian brāhmaṇa the Lord introduced Sanātana
sei vipra tāṁre kaila mahā-nimantraṇe
that brāhmaṇa him made a standing invitation

79 The Lord introduced Sanātana to a brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra, and that brāhmaṇa gave him a standing invitation:

The brāhmaṇa invites Sanātana to his home every day for as long as he lives in Kāśī —

'সনাতন' তুমি যাবৎ কাশীতে রহিবা ।
তাবৎ আমার ঘরে ভিক্ষা যে করিবা ॥ ৮০ ॥

'sanātana' tumi yāvat kāśīte rahibā
Sanātana you as long as in Kāśī you will stay
tāvat āmāra ghare bhikṣā ye karibā
so long in my house your meals do take

80 "Sanātana, as long as you stay in Kāśī, please take your meals at my house."

Sanātana declines lavish alms and wishes to beg mādhukarī —

সনাতন কহে, — আমি মাধুকরী করিব ।
ব্রাহ্মণের ঘরে কেনে একত্র ভিক্ষা লব ? ॥ ৮১ ॥

sanātana kahe, — āmi mādhukarī kariba
Sanātana says I mādhukarī will do
brāhmaṇera ghare kene ekatra bhikṣā laba?
of a brāhmaṇa in the house why in one place food should I take

81 Sanātana said, "I shall live by *mādhukarī*, begging a little from house to house. Why should I take all my meals at one brāhmaṇa's house?"

Sanātana's yukta-vairāgya delights the Lord —

সনাতনের বৈরাগ্যে প্রভুর আনন্দ অপার ।
ভোটকম্বল পানে প্রভু চাহে বারে বার ॥ ৮২ ॥

sanātanera vairāgye prabhura ānanda apāra
at Sanātana's renunciation of the Lord joy boundless
bhoṭa-kambala pāne prabhu cāhe bāre bāra
the Bhoṭa blanket towards the Lord looks again and again

82 The Lord was boundlessly pleased by Sanātana's renunciation, yet again and again He glanced at the woollen Bhoṭa blanket.

Seeing that the Lord does not approve of the Bhoṭa blanket, Sanātana takes a torn quilt —

সনাতন জানিল এই প্রভুরে না ভায় ।
ভোট ত্যাগ করিবারে চিন্তিলা উপায় ॥ ৮৩ ॥

sanātana jānila ei prabhure nā bhāya
Sanātana understood this to the Lord is not pleasing
bhoṭa tyāga karibāre cintilā upāya
the blanket giving up to do he thought of a means

83 Sanātana understood that the Lord did not like it, and he thought of a way to give the blanket up.

এত চিন্তি' গেলা গঙ্গায় মধ্যাহ্ন করিতে ।
এক গৌড়িয়া কান্থা ধুঞা দিয়াছে শুকাইতে ॥ ৮৪ ॥

eta cinti' gelā gaṅgāya madhyāhna karite
so thinking he went to the Gaṅgā the midday bath to take
eka gauḍiyā kānthā dhuñā diyāche śukāite
a Bengali quilt having washed had put to dry

84 With this in mind he went to the Gaṅgā for his midday bath. There a Bengali had washed his quilt and spread it out to dry.

তারে কহে, — ওরে ভাই, কর উপকারে ।
এই ভোট লঞা এই কাঁথা দেহ' মোরে ॥ ৮৫ ॥

tāre kahe, — ore bhāi, kara upakāre
to him he says O brother do a favour
ei bhoṭa lañā ei kāṁthā deha' more
this blanket taking this quilt give me

85 Sanātana said to him, "Brother, do me a favour: take this blanket and give me this quilt."

সেই কহে, — রহস্য কর প্রামাণিক হঞা ?
বহুমূল্য ভোট দিবা কেনে কাঁথা লঞা ? ॥ ৮৬ ॥

sei kahe, — rahasya kara prāmāṇika hañā?
he says a joke you make a respectable man being
bahu-mūlya bhoṭa dibā kene kāṁthā lañā?
a costly blanket you will give why a quilt taking

86 The man said, "Are you, a respectable gentleman, joking with me? Why would you give a costly blanket in exchange for a quilt?"

Anubhāṣya.
Prāmāṇika — one whose conduct is a model of sound judgement; a learned man.

তিঁহো কহে, — রহস্য নহে, কহি সত্যবাণী ।
ভোট লহ, তুমি দেহ' মোরে কাঁথাখানি ॥ ৮৭ ॥

tiṁho kahe, — rahasya nahe, kahi satya-vāṇī
he says a joke it is not I speak the truth
bhoṭa laha, tumi deha' more kāṁthā-khāni
the blanket take you give me this quilt

87 Sanātana said, "I am not joking; I am telling the truth. Take the blanket and give me your quilt."

এত বলি' কাঁথা লইল, ভোট তাঁরে দিয়া ।
গোসাঞির ঠাঁই আইলা কাঁথা গলায় দিয়া ॥ ৮৮ ॥

eta bali' kāṁthā la-ila, bhoṭa tāṁre diyā
so saying the quilt he took the blanket to him giving
gosāñira ṭhāṁi āilā kāṁthā galāya diyā
to the Lord he came the quilt over his shoulders putting

88 With these words he took the quilt in exchange for the blanket and, throwing it over his shoulders, came back to the Lord.

The Lord asks about the Bhoṭa blanket; Sanātana tells Him everything that happened —

প্রভু কহে, — তোমার ভোটকম্বল কোথা গেল ?
প্রভুপদে সব কথা গোসাঞি কহিল ॥ ৮৯ ॥

prabhu kahe, — tomāra bhoṭa-kambala kothā gela?
the Lord says your Bhoṭa blanket where has gone
prabhu-pade saba kathā gosāñi kahila
at the Lord's feet the whole story the Gosvāmī told

89 The Lord asked, "Where has your Bhoṭa blanket gone?" and at the Lord's feet Sanātana Gosvāmī told Him the whole story.

The Lord describes the glory of Kṛṣṇa's mercy —

প্রভু কহে, — ইহা আমি করিয়াছি বিচার ।
বিষয়-রোগ খণ্ডাইল কৃষ্ণ যে তোমার ॥ ৯০ ॥

সে কেনে রাখিবে তোমার শেষ বিষয়-ভোগ ?
রোগ খণ্ডি' সদ্বৈদ্য না রাখে শেষ রোগ ॥ ৯১ ॥

prabhu kahe, — ihā āmi kariyāchi vicāra
the Lord says this I have done consideration
viṣaya-roga khaṇḍāila kṛṣṇa ye tomāra
the disease of worldliness destroyed Kṛṣṇa since your
se kene rākhibe tomāra śeṣa viṣaya-bhoga?
He why would keep your last worldly enjoyment
roga khaṇḍi' sad-vaidya nā rākhe śeṣa roga
the disease destroying a good physician does not keep a remnant of the disease

90–91 The Lord said, "I have thought about this. Kṛṣṇa has destroyed your disease of worldliness — why would He leave you this last bit of worldly enjoyment? Once a good physician has cured a disease, he leaves no trace of it behind.

Instruction: conduct and preaching must agree with each other —

তিন মুদ্রার ভোট গায়, মাধুকরী গ্রাস ।
ধর্ম্মহানি হয়, লোকে করে উপহাস ॥ ৯২ ॥

tina mudrāra bhoṭa gāya, mādhukarī grāsa
of three coins a blanket on the body by mādhukarī one's food
dharma-hāni haya, loke kare upahāsa
to religion harm there is people make ridicule

92 To wear a blanket worth three gold coins while living on *mādhukarī* is a breach of religious principle, and people laugh at it."

Sanātana praises the glory of the Lord's mercy —

গোসাঞি কহে, — যে খণ্ডিল কুবিষয়-ভোগ ।
তাঁর ইচ্ছায় গেল মোর শেষ বিষয় রোগ ॥ ৯৩ ॥

gosāñi kahe, — ye khaṇḍila kuviṣaya-bhoga
the Gosvāmī says He who destroyed sinful worldly enjoyment
tāṁra icchāya gela mora śeṣa viṣaya roga
by His will has gone my last worldly disease

93 Sanātana Gosvāmī said, "By the will of Him who destroyed my sinful worldly enjoyment, the last of my worldly disease is gone."

Anubhāṣya.
Kuviṣaya-bhoga — serving sinful objects of the senses.

The Lord invests Sanātana with power —

প্রসন্ন হঞা প্রভু তাঁরে কৃপা কৈল ।
তাঁর কৃপায় প্রশ্ন করিতে তাঁর শক্তি হৈল ॥ ৯৪ ॥

prasanna hañā prabhu tāṁre kṛpā kaila
pleased becoming the Lord on him mercy bestowed
tāṁra kṛpāya praśna karite tāṁra śakti haila
by His mercy questions to ask his power arose

94 The Lord was pleased and bestowed His mercy on him, and by that mercy Sanātana gained the power to ask questions.

Earlier, by the Lord's power, Rāya was able to answer the Lord's questions —

পূর্ব্বে যৈছে রায়-পাশে প্রভু প্রশ্ন কৈলা ।
তাঁর শক্ত্যে রামানন্দ তাঁর উত্তর দিলা ॥ ৯৫ ॥

pūrve yaiche rāya-pāśe prabhu praśna kailā
before as of Rāya the Lord questions asked
tāṁra śaktye rāmānanda tāṁra uttara dilā
by His power Rāmānanda to them answers gave

95 Just as earlier the Lord had put questions to Rāya Rāmānanda, and Rāmānanda had answered them by the Lord's own power,

In the same way, by the power the Lord invested in him, Sanātana asks questions, and the Lord Himself answers —

ইঁহা প্রভুর শক্ত্যে প্রশ্ন করে সনাতন ।
আপনে মহাপ্রভু করে 'তত্ত্ব'-নিরূপণ ॥ ৯৬ ॥

iṁhā prabhura śaktye praśna kare sanātana
here by the Lord's power questions asks Sanātana
āpane mahāprabhu kare 'tattva'-nirūpaṇa
Himself Mahāprabhu makes of the truth exposition

96 so now Sanātana asked questions by the Lord's power, and Mahāprabhu Himself explained the truth.

The Lord Himself expounds to Sanātana the truth of sambandha, abhidheya and prayojana (the author's words) —

কৃষ্ণস্বরূপমাধুর্য্যৈশ্বর্য্যভক্তিরসাশ্রয়ম্ ।
তত্ত্বং সনাতনায়েশঃ কৃপয়োপদিদেশ সঃ ॥ ৯৭ ॥

kṛṣṇa-svarūpa-mādhuryaiś-
of Kṛṣṇa of the true nature of the sweetness of the majesty
varya-bhakti-rasāśrayam
and of the rasa of devotion the shelter
tattvaṁ sanātanāyeśaḥ
the truth to Sanātana the Lord
kṛpayopadideśa saḥ
mercifully taught He

97 Out of His mercy the Lord taught Sanātana the truth of Kṛṣṇa's own nature, His sweetness and majesty, and the rasa of devotion.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhagavān mercifully instructed Sanātana in the truth — in the sweetness (*mādhurya*) of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's own form, in the majesty (*aiśvarya*) of that form, and in the shelter of *bhakti-rasa*.

Anubhāṣya.

saḥ īśaḥ (Mahāprabhu) **kṛpayā** (with incomparable compassion) **sanātanāya** (to Sanātana Gosvāmī) **kṛṣṇa-svarūpa-mādhuryaiśvarya-bhakti-rasāśrayaṁ** (Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa* — that He, the Lord of all lords, is the son of Yaśodā, the crown of youths, whose very self is concentrated eternity, knowledge and bliss; *mādhurya* — the beauty of His natural form, qualities, pastimes and so on, which enchants everyone, for nothing equals or surpasses it; *aiśvarya* — His natural, unlimited lordship, which nothing equals or surpasses; and *bhakti-rasa*; the shelter of all these — the Reality pointed to by the words "In the Tenth Canto the goal is the tenth subject: the form who is the shelter of all who seek shelter"[30] — just that) **tattvam** (nondual Knowledge, *advaya-jñāna*) **upadideśa** (expounded).

The description of the "instructions to Sanātana" begins. To teach the world, the eternally perfect Sanātana plays the part of a conditioned jīva: with humility he bows down, inquires and serves, and like a disciple asks about the truth from the Lord, the teacher of the world, the embodiment of kīrtana —

তবে সনাতন প্রভুর চরণে ধরিয়া ।
দৈন্য বিনতি করে দন্তে তৃণ লঞা ॥ ৯৮ ॥

tabe sanātana prabhura caraṇe dhariyā
then Sanātana the Lord's feet clasping
dainya vinati kare dante ṭṛṇa lañā
humble entreaty makes in his teeth straw taking

98 Then Sanātana clasped the Lord's feet and, holding a straw between his teeth, humbly entreated Him:

নীচ-জাতি, নীচ-সঙ্গী, পতিত অধম ।
কুবিষয়-কূপে পড়ি' গোঙাইনু জনম! ॥ ৯৯ ॥

nīca-jāti, nīca-saṅgī, patita adhama
low by birth in low company fallen most wretched
kuviṣaya-kūpe paḍi' goṅāinu janama!
into the well of sinful worldliness having fallen I have wasted my life

99 "I am low-born, I keep low company, I am fallen and wretched. Fallen into the well of sinful worldliness, I have wasted my life.

আপনার হিতাহিত কিছুই না জানি !
গ্রাম্য-ব্যবহারে পণ্ডিত, তাই সত্য মানি ॥ ১০০ ॥

āpanāra hitāhita kichui nā jāni!
my own good and harm anything not I know
grāmya-vyavahāre paṇḍita, tāi satya māni
in worldly dealings learned that as truth I accept

100 I know nothing of what is good or harmful for me. I am learned only in worldly dealings, and I take that for the truth.

Anubhāṣya.
Grāmya-vyavahāra — worldly dealings between men and women.

কৃপা করি' যদি মোরে করিয়াছ উদ্ধার ।
আপন-কৃপাতে কহ 'কর্ত্তব্য' আমার ॥ ১০১ ॥

kṛpā kari' yadi more kariyācha uddhāra
mercy showing since me You have made deliverance
āpana-kṛpāte kaha 'kartavya' āmāra
by Your own mercy tell the duty my

101 Since You in Your mercy have delivered me, tell me, by that same mercy, what my duty is.

The question about the true nature of the jīva and the cause of the miseries born of his bondage —

'কে আমি', 'কেনে আমায় জারে তাপত্রয়' ।
ইহা নাহি জানি — 'কেমনে হিত হয়' ॥ ১০২ ॥

'ke āmi', 'kene āmāya jāre tāpa-traya'
who am I why me burn the threefold miseries
ihā nāhi jāni — 'kemane hita haya'
this not I know how good will come

102 Who am I? Why do the threefold miseries burn me? I do not know this, nor how I may attain my true good.

Anubhāṣya.
Tāpa-traya — the three kinds of misery: (1) *ādhyātmika*, (2) *ādhibhautika* and (3) *ādhidaivika*. (1) *Ādhyātmika* misery is of two kinds: (a) bodily, such as fever and other diseases; (b) mental, such as separation from loved ones and the like. (2) *Ādhibhautika* misery is of four kinds: misery caused (a) by creatures born from wombs, (b) by creatures born from eggs, (c) by creatures born from sweat, (d) by creatures born from sprouts. (3) *Ādhidaivika* misery is the misery that comes from the higher gods such as Indra — cold, lightning strikes and so on — and also the harmful calamities and misfortunes brought by malign spirits of violent nature, such as *yakṣas* and *piśācas*.

'সাধ্য'-'সাধন'-তত্ত্ব পুছিতে না জানি ।
কৃপা করি' সব তত্ত্ব কহ ত' আপনি ॥ ১০৩ ॥

'sādhya'-'sādhana'-tattva puchite nā jāni
of the goal and the means the truth to ask not I know
kṛpā kari' saba tattva kaha ta' āpani
mercy showing all the truths tell please Yourself

103 I do not even know how to ask about the truth of the goal (*sādhya*) and the means (*sādhana*). Be merciful and explain all these truths Yourself."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Sanātana asked: "Who am I? Why do the three kinds of misery — *ādhyātmika*, *ādhibhautika* and *ādhidaivika* — torment me? And how can I attain my good? I do not know how to ask about the truth of *sādhya* and *sādhana* (the goal and the means). Please be merciful and tell me what I need to know."

Knowing Sanātana to be eternally perfect, the Lord answers only for the good of conditioned jīvas —

প্রভু কহে, — কৃষ্ণ-কৃপা তোমাতে পূর্ণ হয়।
সব তত্ত্ব জান, তোমার নাহি তাপত্রয় ॥ ১০৪ ॥

prabhu kahe, — kṛṣṇa-kṛpā tomāte pūrṇa haya
the Lord says Kṛṣṇa's mercy in you full is
saba tattva jāna, tomāra nāhi tāpa-traya
all the truths you know of you there are not the threefold miseries

104 The Lord said, "Kṛṣṇa's mercy rests on you in full. You know all these truths, and the threefold miseries do not touch you.

কৃষ্ণভক্তি ধর তুমি, জান তত্ত্বভাব।
জানি' দার্ঢ্য লাগি' পুছে, — সাধুর স্বভাব ॥ ১০৫ ॥

kṛṣṇa-bhakti dhara tumi, jāna tattva-bhāva
devotion to Kṛṣṇa possess you you know the essence of the truths
jāni' dārḍhya lāgi' puche, — sādhura svabhāva
knowing for firmness' sake he asks of a sādhu the nature

105 You possess devotion to Kṛṣṇa and know the essence of all the truths. Yet a sādhu, though he knows, still asks in order to make his understanding

firm — such is his nature.

Inquiry into the truth is absolutely necessary: only by it is the desired goal attained —

অচিরাদেব সর্ব্বার্থঃ সিধ্যত্যেষামভীপ্সিতঃ ৷
সদ্ধর্ম্মস্যাববোধায় যেষাং নির্ব্বন্ধিনী মতিঃ ॥ ১০৬ ॥

acirād eva sarvārthaḥ
soon indeed every aim
sidhyaty eṣām abhīpsitaḥ
is fulfilled of those desired
sad-dharmasyāvabodhāya
of true religion for the understanding
yeṣāṁ nirbandhinī matiḥ
of whom persistent the mind

106 "Those whose minds are set with perseverance on understanding true religion soon attain every aim they desire." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Pūrva-vibhāga, Sādhana-bhakti-laharī, 47)[4]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Those who are firmly resolved to awaken the true dharma within themselves soon attain every goal they desire.

Anubhāṣya.
sad-dharmasya (of *bhāgavata-dharma*, which is always to be embraced) **avabodhāya** (for knowing the truth, that is, for inquiring about the truth) **yeṣāṁ** (of persons who are inclined to devotion and have pious merit) **nirbandhinī** (unwavering) **matiḥ** (taste or intelligence) (exists), **eṣāṁ** (of these people, pure in heart and spotless in mind) **abhīpsitaḥ** (prayed for) **sarvārthaḥ** (the goal) **acirāt** (soon) **eva sidhyati** (is fulfilled).

The Lord accepts Sanātana as an ācārya —

যোগ্যপাত্র হও তুমি ভক্তি প্রবর্ত্তাইতে ৷
ক্রমে সব তত্ত্ব শুন, কহিয়ে তোমাতে ॥ ১০৭ ॥

yogya-pātra hao tumi bhakti pravartāite
a worthy vessel are you devotion to propagate
krame saba tattva śuna, kahiye tomāte
in order all the truths hear I tell you

107 You are a worthy vessel for propagating devotion. Now hear all the truths in order as I tell them to you.

The instructions to Śrī Śrī Sanātana begin. (A-1) First of all, the true nature of the jīva —

জীবের 'স্বরূপ' হয় — কৃষ্ণের 'নিত্যদাস' ।
কৃষ্ণের 'তটস্থা-শক্তি', 'ভেদাভেদ-প্রকাশ' ॥ ১০৮ ॥

jīvera 'svarūpa' haya — kṛṣṇera 'nitya-dāsa'
of the jīva the true nature is of Kṛṣṇa the eternal servant
kṛṣṇera 'taṭasthā-śakti', 'bhedābheda-prakāśa'
of Kṛṣṇa the marginal potency different and nondifferent a manifestation

108 The true nature (*svarūpa*) of the jīva is to be Kṛṣṇa's eternal servant. The jīva is Kṛṣṇa's marginal potency (*taṭasthā-śakti*), a manifestation that is both different and not different from Him (*bhedābheda-prakāśa*).

সূর্য্যাংশ-কিরণ, যৈছে অগ্নিজ্বালাচয় ।
স্বাভাবিক কৃষ্ণের তিনপ্রকার 'শক্তি' হয় ॥ ১০৯ ॥

sūryāṁśa-kiraṇa, yaiche agni-jvālā-caya
a ray, part of the sun as of fire of flames a multitude
svābhāvika kṛṣṇera tina-prakāra 'śakti' haya
natural of Kṛṣṇa three kinds of potencies there are

109 The jīva is like a ray of the sun or a spark of fire. By His very nature Kṛṣṇa has three kinds of potency.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In answer to the question "Who am I?" Mahāprabhu says: "You are a jīva. Are you this body born of matter? No. Or are you, perhaps, the subtle body (*liṅga-śarīra*) made of mind, intelligence and false ego? No, not that either. By your intrinsic na-

ture you are Kṛṣṇa's eternal servant. You are Kṛṣṇa's marginal potency (*taṭastha-śakti*): you stand on the boundary between Kṛṣṇa's spiritual world and the world of māyā, and you are related to both worlds; that is why you are the marginal potency. Your relationship with Kṛṣṇa is twofold: you are His manifestation both different and nondifferent from Him (*bhedābheda-prakāśa*). In your spiritual nature you are a nondifferent manifestation of Kṛṣṇa; and because you are an atomic consciousness (*aṇu-caitanya*), you are a different manifestation of Kṛṣṇa, who is the great consciousness (*bṛhat-caitanya*). Difference and nondifference (between you and Kṛṣṇa) hold at the same time." This simultaneous manifestation of difference and nondifference follows from the *jīva's* marginal nature itself. The jīva is a ray, a particle, of Kṛṣṇa, who is like the sun; or again, the mass of sparks from a blazing fire also illustrates the jīvas.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.96.

Viṣṇu displays His pastimes through His all-pervading potency —

একদেশস্থিতস্যাগ্নের্জ্যোৎস্না বিস্তারিণী যথা ।
পরস্য ব্রহ্মণঃ শক্তিস্তথেদমখিলং জগৎ ॥ ১১০ ॥

eka-deśa-sthitasyāgner
in one place situated of a fire
jyotsnā vistāriṇī yathā
the light spreading as
parasya brahmaṇaḥ śaktis
of the Supreme Brahman the potency
tathedam akhilaṁ jagat
so this entire world

110 "As the light of a fire burning in one place spreads all around, so this entire world is the potency of the Supreme Brahman." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 1.22.53)[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
As the light of a fire situated in one place spreads all around, so the potency of the Supreme Brahman pervades the whole universe.

Anubhāṣya.

yathā eka-deśa-sthitasya (situated in a particular place) **agneḥ jyotsnā** (light) **vistāriṇī** (spreading), **tathā idaṁ akhilaṁ** (all — both spiritual and material) **jagat — parasya brahmaṇaḥ** (of Kṛṣṇa) **śaktiḥ**.

(A-2) On Kṛṣṇa's potency —

কৃষ্ণের স্বাভাবিক তিনশক্তি-পরিণতি ।
চিচ্ছক্তি, জীবশক্তি, আর মায়াশক্তি ॥ ১১১ ॥

kṛṣṇera svābhāvika tina-śakti-pariṇati
of Kṛṣṇa natural of the three potencies the manifestation
cic-chakti, jīva-śakti, āra māyā-śakti
the spiritual potency the jīva potency and the māyā potency

111 Kṛṣṇa's natural potency manifests in three ways: the spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*), the jīva potency (*jīva-śakti*) and the potency of māyā (*māyā-śakti*).

The three kinds of potency —

বিষ্ণুশক্তিঃ পরা প্রোক্তা ক্ষেত্রজ্ঞাখ্যা তথাপরা ।
অবিদ্যা-কর্ম্মসংজ্ঞান্যা তৃতীয়া শক্তিরিষ্যতে ॥ ১১২ ॥

viṣṇu-śaktiḥ parā proktā
Viṣṇu's potency superior is declared
kṣetrajñākhyā tathā parā
called the knower of the field likewise superior
avidyā-karma-saṁjñānyā
called ignorance and karma another
tṛtīyā śaktir iṣyate
a third potency is held to be

112 "The potency of Viṣṇu is declared to be superior; the potency called the knower of the field (*kṣetrajña*) is likewise superior; and the other, called ignorance and karma, is held to be a third potency." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 6.7.61)[6]

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 7.119.

(1) The internal potency, the svarūpa-śakti, abides inseparably in the possessor of potency —

শক্তয়ঃ সর্ব্বভাবানামচিন্ত্যজ্ঞানগোচরাঃ ।
যতোঽতো ব্রহ্মণস্তাস্তু সর্গাদ্যা ভাবশক্তয়ঃ ।
ভবন্তি তপতাং শ্রেষ্ঠ পাবকস্য যথোষ্ণতা ॥ ১১৩ ॥

śaktayaḥ sarva-bhāvānām
the potencies of all things
acintya-jñāna-gocarāḥ
inconceivable to ordinary knowledge
yato 'to brahmaṇas tās tu
since therefore of Brahman those indeed
sargādyā bhāva-śaktayaḥ
for creation and the rest natural potencies
bhavanti tapatāṁ śreṣṭha
are of ascetics O best
pāvakasya yathoṣṇatā
of fire as the heat

113 "The potencies of all things are inconceivable to ordinary knowledge. Therefore, O best of ascetics, Brahman possesses natural potencies for creation and the rest, just as fire possesses heat." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 1.3.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The potencies of all that exists, which only inconceivable knowledge can grasp, reside in Brahman; that is why these potencies of Brahman act as the potencies of being — of creation and the rest. O best of ascetics, as heat is a property inherent in fire itself, so the potencies are properties inherent in Brahman itself.

Anubhāṣya.
tapatāṁ (of ascetics) **śreṣṭha**, **yathā pāvakasya** (of fire) **uṣṇatā** (there is heat — the power to burn and so on), **tathā yataḥ** (from Brahman) **eva sarva-bhāvānāṁ acintya-jñāna-gocarāḥ** (beyond the reach of human intelligence), **ataḥ tu** (for that very reason) **tāḥ** (such) **sargādyāḥ** (the spiritual creation and the rest — inseparably) **brahmaṇaḥ śaktayaḥ** (eternally manifest) **bhavanti**.

(2) The marginal potency — the jīva-śakti —

যয়া ক্ষেত্রজ্ঞশক্তিঃ সা বেষ্টিতা নৃপ সর্ব্বগা ।
সংসারতাপানখিলানবাপ্নোত্যত্র সন্ততান্ ॥ ১১৪ ॥

yayā kṣetra-jña-śaktiḥ sā
by which the knower of the field potency that
veṣṭitā nṛpa sarva-gā
enveloped O king all-pervading
saṁsāra-tāpān akhilān
of worldly existence the miseries all
avāpnoty atra santatān
obtains here continual

114 "O king, the potency called the knower of the field can enter both spirit and matter; yet here, enveloped by that ignorance, it suffers without end all the miseries of worldly existence." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 6.7.62)[7]

তয়া তিরোহিতত্বাচ্চ শক্তিঃ ক্ষেত্রজ্ঞ-সংজ্ঞিতা ।
সর্ব্বভূতেষু ভূপাল তারতম্যেন বর্ত্ততে ॥ ১১৫ ॥

tayā tirohitatvāc ca
by it because of being covered and
śaktiḥ kṣetra-jña-saṁjñitā
the potency the knower of the field called
sarva-bhūteṣu bhū-pāla
in all beings O king
tāratamyena vartate
in varying degrees exists

115 "Because it is covered by that ignorance, O king, the potency called the knower of the field exists in all beings in varying degrees." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 6.7.63)[8]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 6.155–156.

(3) The external potency — the māyā-śakti —

অপরেয়মিতস্ত্বন্যাং প্রকৃতিং বিদ্ধি মে পরাম্ ।
জীবভূতাং মহাবাহো যয়েদং ধার্য্যতে জগৎ ॥ ১১৬ ॥

apareyam itas tv anyāṁ
inferior this beyond this but another
prakṛtiṁ viddhi me parām
nature know My superior
jīva-bhūtāṁ mahā-bāho
consisting of jīvas O mighty-armed
yayedaṁ dhāryate jagat
by which this is taken up the world

116 "This nature is inferior. But know, O mighty-armed, that I have another, superior nature, consisting of the jīvas, who take up this world for their own enjoyment." (Bhagavad-gītā, 7.5)[9]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 7.118.

(B) On the distorted nature (virūpa); the conditioned jīva's disease of worldly existence and its result — misery, or punishment —

কৃষ্ণ ভুলি' সেই জীব অনাদি-বহির্ম্মুখ ।
অতএব মায়া তারে দেয় সংসার-দুঃখ ॥ ১১৭ ॥

kṛṣṇa bhuli' sei jīva anādi-bahirmukha
Kṛṣṇa forgetting that jīva turned away since time without beginning
ataeva māyā tāre deya saṁsāra-duḥkha
therefore māyā to it gives the misery of worldly existence

117 Having forgotten Kṛṣṇa, the jīva has turned its face from Him since time without beginning. Therefore māyā gives it the miseries of worldly existence.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The jīva falls into the bondage of māyā precisely by forgetting, "I am Kṛṣṇa's eternal servant." The jīva, being the marginal potency, is situated where the spiritual

world and the world of māyā meet; while there, he desired to enjoy māyā, and so he entered māyā. The reckoning of māyic time begins only from this entry into māyā. Since the jīva turned away from Kṛṣṇa before that reckoning of time began, his aversion is called “beginningless”: it arose before māyic time.

কভু স্বর্গে উঠায়, কভু নরকে ডুবায় ।
দণ্ড্যজনে রাজা যেন নদীতে চুবায় ॥ ১১৮ ॥

kabhu svarge uṭhāya, kabhu narake ḍubāya
sometimes to heaven she raises sometimes in hell she sinks
daṇḍya-jane rājā yena nadīte cubāya
one to be punished a king as in a river dunks

118 Sometimes she raises it to heaven, sometimes she sinks it into hell — just as a king has a condemned man dunked again and again in a river.

Anubhāṣya.
The eternally liberated jīva never forgets Kṛṣṇa: from beginningless time he remains turned towards Kṛṣṇa, established in his eternal function — service to Hari. But those jīvas who have forgotten their right to serve Kṛṣṇa and, following a beginningless desire to enjoy the fruits of karma, cultivate māyā and think themselves the enjoyers of those fruits — for them māyā appoints the enjoyment of the fruits of karma. As a king rewards and punishes, so the conditioned jīva, by the power of pious deeds, rises to heaven, takes the position of a god and enjoys happiness, and again, as the fruit of sin, suffers in hell and elsewhere.

(C) The disease of the conditioned jīva, its cause and its cure — that is, the rules of diet and of taking the medicine —

ভয়ং দ্বিতীয়াভিনিবেশতঃ স্যা-
দীশাদপেতস্য বিপর্য্যয়োঽস্মৃতিঃ ।
তন্মায়য়াতো বুধ আভজেত্তং
ভক্ত্যৈকয়েশং গুরুদেবতাত্মা ॥ ১১৯ ॥

bhayaṁ dvitīyābhiniveśataḥ syād
fear from absorption in what is other arises
īśād apetasya viparyayo ʻsmṛtiḥ
from the Lord for one turned away misconception forgetfulness
tan-māyayāto budha ābhajet taṁ
by His māyā therefore the wise one should worship Him
bhaktyaikayeśaṁ guru-devatātmā
with devotion exclusive the Lord seeing the guru as his deity and his self

119 "For one who has turned away from the Lord, fear arises from absorption in what is other than Him; by His māyā come forgetfulness of the Lord and a false idea of oneself. Therefore the wise, seeing the guru as his worshipful deity and his very self, should worship the Lord with exclusive devotion." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.37)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Because the jīva is absorbed in māyā, which is other than Kṛṣṇa, "fear" comes upon him; and because he has turned away from that Lord, a reversed memory born of māyā arises in him. Therefore a wise person, regarding the guru as his "deity" and his "self," should worship that Supreme Lord with exclusive devotion.

Anubhāṣya.

In Dvārakā, in answer to Vasudeva's question, Devarṣi Nārada was glorifying *bhāgavata-dharma* and related the conversation between Nimi, king of Videha, and the nine Yogendras. When the nine Yogendras came to Nimi's sacrifice, he asked them to describe *bhāgavata-dharma*. One of them, the sage Kavi, first described the characteristics of *bhāgavata-dharma* and now teaches about the plight of the conditioned jīva and the duty to worship Bhagavān.

(Since) **īśāt** (from Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa) **apetasya** (of the conditioned jīva who has turned away) **tan-māyayā** (by the māyā — the external potency — of that Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa) **asmṛtiḥ** (forgetfulness of Bhagavān's own form, that is, absence of remembrance; then) **viparyayaḥ** (the false notion, created by māyā, that one is the enjoyer of the fruits of karma — that is, the reversed understanding "I am the body," rooted in misapprehension (*vivarta*) and arising from forgetting one's own nature; then) **dvitīyābhiniveśataḥ** (from fancies of one's own enjoyment — that is, from absorption in what is not one's own nature, the body and so on; this absorption comes from identifying oneself with the body, and that from forgetting one's

own nature) **bhayaṁ** (the round of birth and death, or anxiety over body, wealth and friends) **syāt** (arises); **ataḥ budhaḥ** (an intelligent jīva turned towards Kṛṣṇa) **tam** (that Lord — Adhokṣaja alone) **guru-devatātmā** (seeing the guru as his deity — the Lord — and as his self, the dearmost) **ekayā** (single — unwavering, exclusive) **bhaktyā** (by devotion — giving up the pursuit of the other paths, jñāna and *karma*) **ābhajet** (should serve fully).

(D) Description of the descent, or avatāra, of the Supreme Lord, the possessor of the spiritual potency; the only way to conquer māyā —

সাধু-শাস্ত্র-কৃপায় যদি কৃষ্ণোন্মুখ হয় ।
সেই জীব নিস্তরে, মায়া তাহারে ছাড়য় ॥ ১২০ ॥

sādhu-śāstra-kṛpāya yadi kṛṣṇonmukha haya
by the mercy of the sādhus and scriptures if turned towards Kṛṣṇa it becomes
sei jīva nistare, māyā tāhāre chāḍaya
that jīva crosses over māyā it releases

120 If by the mercy of the sādhus and the scriptures the jīva turns towards Kṛṣṇa, it crosses over, and māyā releases it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
That the jīva fell because he turned away from Kṛṣṇa is learned by the mercy of the sādhus and the scriptures. The jīva who learns this and turns towards Kṛṣṇa again is delivered, and māyā leaves him.

Anubhāṣya.
Turned away from Kṛṣṇa, the jīva is busy enjoying worldly happiness. When, by the mercy of the Vaiṣṇavas and the grace of the scriptures, he becomes free from the desire to enjoy the fruits of karma and turns eagerly to Kṛṣṇa's service, he is delivered from the thirst for enjoyment or for liberation. When his intelligence becomes devoted to serving Kṛṣṇa, māyā — the desire for worldly enjoyment — lets him go. Once turned towards Kṛṣṇa's service, the jīva is no longer intoxicated with *ahaṁgrahopāsanā* (worshipping oneself as God) as a *jñānī* who desires liberation; nor, led by the desire for worldly enjoyment, does he seek to enjoy fruits. He is no longer bound to anything other than Kṛṣṇa, but escapes from the hands of māyā.

Only a devotee surrendered to Kṛṣṇa conquers māyā —

দৈবী হ্যেষা গুণময়ী মম মায়া দুরত্যয়া ।
মামেব যে প্রপদ্যন্তে মায়ামেতাং তরন্তি তে ॥ ১২১ ॥

daivī hy eṣā guṇa-mayī
divine indeed this made of the guṇas
mama māyā duratyayā
My māyā hard to overcome
mām eva ye prapadyante
to Me alone those who surrender
māyām etāṁ taranti te
māyā this cross over they

121 "This divine māyā of Mine, made of the guṇas, is hard to overcome. But those who surrender to Me alone cross beyond this māyā." (Bhagavad-gītā, 7.14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This māyā of Mine, made of the three *guṇas*, is extremely hard to cross. Only one who surrenders to Me can cross this māyā.

Anubhāṣya.

eṣā mama (of Me, the Supreme Lord) **daivī** (divine — extraordinary, belonging to Viṣṇu) **guṇamayī** (made of *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*) **māyā** (the external potency) **duratyayā** (insurmountable for jīvas bound by desires for enjoyment and liberation) **hi** (indeed); **mām** (to Kṛṣṇa — Svayaṁ Bhagavān, possessed of His *svarūpa-śakti*) **ye** (those people who) **prapadyante** (surrender with their whole being), **te** (they alone) **etāṁ māyāṁ** (the *prakṛti* that bewilders the *jīvas*) **taranti** (cross over, conquer).

Adhokṣaja Viṣṇu, full of causeless mercy towards the jīvas, appears as an avatāra —

মায়ামুগ্ধ জীবের নাহি কৃষ্ণস্মৃতি জ্ঞান ।
জীবেরে কৃপায় কৈলা কৃষ্ণ বেদ-পুরাণ ॥ ১২২ ॥

māyā-mugdha jīvera nāhi kṛṣṇa-smṛti jñāna
by māyā bewildered of the jīva there is not remembrance of Kṛṣṇa knowledge
jīvere kṛpāya kailā kṛṣṇa veda-purāṇa
for the jīva out of mercy made Kṛṣṇa the Vedas and Purāṇas

122 The jīva bewildered by māyā has no remembrance or knowledge of Kṛṣṇa. So, out of mercy for the jīva, Kṛṣṇa made the Vedas and Purāṇas.

Anubhāṣya.
The jīva bewitched by māyā, deluded about his own true nature, is engaged every moment and in every matter in obtaining fruits for his own enjoyment. Sometimes, with a mind in bondage, he longs to be freed from the desire to enjoy fruits; and sometimes, desiring fruits, he prizes fleeting enjoyment. In either case one sees that, covered by māyā, he does not remember Kṛṣṇa. Therefore the all-merciful Kṛṣṇa has revealed the Vedas, the Purāṇas and the other scriptures to save from misfortune such a person, deluded in understanding and given to wrong reasoning and enjoyment.

Kṛṣṇa Himself descends in three manifestations to give knowledge of Kṛṣṇa: (1) the Veda, or the commentary on the Vedānta, the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam; (2) the best of bhāgavatas, the guru; (3) the Antaryāmī —

'শাস্ত্র-গুরু-আত্ম'-রূপে আপনারে জানান ।
'কৃষ্ণ মোর প্রভু, ত্রাতা' — জীবের হয় জ্ঞান ॥ ১২৩ ॥

'śāstra-guru-ātma'-rūpe āpanāre jānāna
in the form of scripture, guru and Supersoul Himself He makes known
'kṛṣṇa mora prabhu, trātā' — jīvera haya jñāna
Kṛṣṇa my Lord protector of the jīva arises knowledge

123 He makes Himself known in the form of scripture, the guru and the Supersoul, and the jīva comes to know: "Kṛṣṇa is my Lord and protector."

Anubhāṣya.
Bhagavān appears in three forms — the scripture, the guru and the *caitya-guru* — and awakens in the heart of the conditioned jīva such sentiments as "He is the Lord of the *jīva*" or "He is the deliverer of the jīva."

(E) Everyone who believes in God regards the Veda as not of human origin (apauruṣeya). Therefore, of the three kinds of evidence (pramāṇa) the author spoke of earlier, he relies on the Veda, or śruti, which is evident to all, and begins to establish his thesis: the best abhidheya is pure devotion alone. The three truths that the scriptures bid us seek are the Brahman, the supreme Reality —

বেদশাস্ত্র কহে — ‘সম্বন্ধ’, ‘অভিধেয়’, ‘প্রয়োজন’ ।
‘কৃষ্ণ’ — প্রাপ্য-সম্বন্ধ, ‘ভক্তি’ — প্রাপ্যের সাধন ॥ ১২৪ ॥

veda-śāstra kahe — ‘sambandha’, ‘abhidheya’, ‘prayojana’
the Vedic scriptures say sambandha abhidheya prayojana
‘kṛṣṇa’ — prāpya-sambandha, ‘bhakti’ — prāpyera sādhana
Kṛṣṇa the one to be attained, the sambandha devotion of attaining Him the means

124 The Vedic scriptures speak of *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana*. Kṛṣṇa, the one to be attained, is the *sambandha*; devotion (bhakti) is the means of attaining Him.

Sambandha is Kṛṣṇa, abhidheya is pure devotion, prayojana is prema —

অভিধেয়-নাম — ‘ভক্তি’, ‘প্রেম’ — প্রয়োজন ।
পুরুষার্থ-শিরোমণি প্রেম — মহাধন ॥ ১২৫ ॥

abhidheya-nāma — ‘bhakti’, ‘prema’ — prayojana
of the abhidheya the name devotion prema the prayojana
puruṣārtha-śiromaṇi prema — mahā-dhana
of the human goals the crown jewel prema the great treasure

125 Bhakti is called the *abhidheya*, and prema is the *prayojana*. Prema, the crown jewel of all human goals, is the greatest treasure.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Seeing that the jīva, bewitched by māyā, had lost the knowledge that is remembrance of Kṛṣṇa, the boundlessly compassionate Kṛṣṇa revealed the scriptures — the Vedas and Purāṇas. In the form of those scriptures, in the form of the guru who reveals their meaning, and in the form of the indwelling Self, the Antaryāmī, He

makes the jīva know the truth about himself. All the Vedic scriptures teach knowledge of *sambandha*, knowledge of *abhidheya* and knowledge of *prayojana*. The truth that Kṛṣṇa is the One whom the jīva is to attain is found in knowledge of *sambandha*. The means of attaining Kṛṣṇa is called "*bhakti*"; it is called the "*abhidheya*." In attaining Kṛṣṇa there is a wonderful thing called "*prema*"; it is called the "*prayojana*."

Anubhāṣya.

The Vedic scriptures describe three subjects: "*sambandha*," "*abhidheya*" and "*prayojana*." Kṛṣṇa, whom the pure jīva is to attain, is the "*sambandha*"; service to Kṛṣṇa as the means of attaining Him is the "*abhidheya*"; and love for Kṛṣṇa — the great treasure higher than the four goals of life (*dharma*, *artha*, the enjoyment of *kāma*, and "*mokṣa*," which is without enjoyment), the treasure to be attained — is the "*prayojana*."

How prema, the goal of sādhana-bhakti, acts —

কৃষ্ণমাধুর্য্য-সেবানন্দ-প্রাপ্তির কারণ ।
কৃষ্ণে সেবা করে, কৃষ্ণরস-আস্বাদন ॥ ১২৬ ॥

kṛṣṇa-mādhurya-sevānanda-prāptira kāraṇa
of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness of the bliss of service of attaining the cause
kṛṣṇe sevā kare, kṛṣṇa-rasa-āsvādana
to Kṛṣṇa service one renders Kṛṣṇa's rasa tasting

126 Prema is what brings one the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa in His sweetness: through it one serves Kṛṣṇa and tastes the rasa of Kṛṣṇa.

Of the four kinds of abhidheya, all the scriptures call pure devotion alone safe and easy. The illustration — the instruction of the all-knowing one, or of a perfected mahājana —

ইহাতে দৃষ্টান্ত — যৈছে দরিদ্রের ঘরে ।
'সর্ব্বজ্ঞ' আসি' দুঃখ দেখি' পুছয়ে তাহারে ॥ ১২৭ ॥

ihāte dṛṣṭānta — yaiche daridrera ghare
of this an example as of a poor man to the house
'sarvajña' āsi' duḥkha dekhi' puchaye tāhāre
an all-knowing one coming the misery seeing asks him

127 Here is an illustration: an all-knowing sage (*sarvajña*) came to a poor man's house and, seeing his misery, asked him,

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When the jīva turned away from Kṛṣṇa and gradually lost the memory of his own true nature, Kṛṣṇa revealed Himself by producing the Vedas, the Purāṇas and the other scriptures. The story of the poor man and the all-knowing one (*sarvajña*) illustrates just this.

Anubhāṣya.
Sarvajña — see Madhva's commentary on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.5.10–13.

The jīva's eternally perfect nature is love for Kṛṣṇa —

তুমি কেনে এত দুঃখী, তোমার আছে পিতৃধন ।
তোমারে না কহিল, অন্যত্র ছাড়িল জীবন ॥ ১২৮ ॥

tumi kene eta duḥkhī, tomāra āche pitṛ-dhana
you why so wretched you have a father's treasure
tomāre nā kahila, anyatra chāḍila jīvana
to you he did not tell elsewhere he left his life

128 'Why are you so miserable? You have your father's treasure. He did not tell you about it because he died far from home.'

Devotion, the means to the goal, prema, is an obligatory duty; this is the injunction of the scriptures —

সর্ব্বজ্ঞের বাক্যে করে ধনের উদ্দেশে ।
ঐছে বেদ-পুরাণ জীবে 'কৃষ্ণ' উপদেশে ॥ ১২৯ ॥

sarvajñera vākye kare dhanera uddeśe
of the all-knowing one by the words he makes for the treasure search
aiche veda-purāṇa jīve 'kṛṣṇa' upadeśe
so the Vedas and Purāṇas to the jīva Kṛṣṇa teach

129 Guided by the sage's words, the poor man set out to find the treasure. In the same way the Vedas and Purāṇas teach the jīva about Kṛṣṇa.

All the scriptures point to Kṛṣṇa, to whom the jīva is eternally related —

সর্ব্বজ্ঞের বাক্যে মূলধন অনুবন্ধ ।
সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রে উপদেশে, 'শ্রীকৃষ্ণ' — সম্বন্ধ ॥ ১৩০ ॥

sarvajñera vākye mūla-dhana anubandha
of the all-knowing one by the words with the original treasure connection
sarva-śāstre upadeśe, 'śrī-kṛṣṇa' — sambandha
all the scriptures teach Śrī Kṛṣṇa the sambandha

130 By the sage's words the poor man learned of his link with the original treasure; so too all the scriptures teach that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the *sambandha*.

The sādhana of the conditioned jīva is simply the awakening of his eternally perfect nature —

'বাপের ধন আছে' — জ্ঞানে ধন নাহি পায় ।
তবে সর্ব্বজ্ঞ কহে তারে প্রাপ্তির উপায় ॥ ১৩১ ॥

'bāpera dhana āche' — jñāne dhana nāhi pāya
the father's wealth there is by knowing the wealth not he obtains
tabe sarvajña kahe tāre prāptira upāya
then the all-knowing one tells him of obtaining the means

131 Merely knowing that his father's wealth was there did not bring it to him, so the sage told him how to obtain it:

The paths without devotion — (1) the dangers of the path of karma, which

seeks worldly enjoyment (bhukti) —

‘এই স্থানে আছে ধন’ — যদি দক্ষিণে খুদিবে ।
‘ভীমরুল-বরুলী’ উঠিবে, ধন না পাইবে ॥ ১৩২ ॥

‘ei sthāne āche dhana’ — yadi dakṣiṇe khudibe
in this place is the treasure if on the south you dig
‘bhīmarula-barulī’ uṭhibe, dhana nā pāibe
hornets and wasps will rise the treasure not you will get

132 ‘The treasure is here in this place. If you dig on the south side, hornets and wasps will rise up and you will not get the treasure.

(2) The dangers of the path of yoga, which seeks mystic powers (vibhūti-siddhi) —

‘পশ্চিমে’ খুদিবে, তাহা ‘যক্ষ’ এক হয় ।
সে বিঘ্ন করিবে, — ধনে হাত না পড়য় ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

‘paścime’ khudibe, tāhā ‘yakṣa’ eka haya
on the west you dig there a yakṣa one there is
se vighna karibe, — dhane hāta nā paḍaya
he obstruction will make the treasure the hand will not touch

133 If you dig on the west side, there is a *yakṣa* there; he will obstruct you, and your hand will never touch the treasure.

(3) The dangers of the path of jñāna, which seeks sāyujya —

‘উত্তরে’ খুদিলে আছে কৃষ্ণ ‘অজগরে’ ।
ধন নাহি পাবে, খুদিতে গিলিবে সবারে ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

‘uttare’ khudile āche kṛṣṇa ‘ajagare’
on the north if you dig there is a black python
dhana nāhi pābe, khudite gilibe sabāre
the treasure not you will get in digging it will swallow everyone

134 If you dig on the north side, there is a black python; you will not get the treasure — it will swallow everyone who digs.

Only the "former," original, eternal and abiding treasure — devotion to Kṛṣṇa — is free from danger —

পূর্ব্বদিকে তাতে মাটী অল্প খুদিতে।
ধনের ঝারি পড়িবেক তোমার হাতেতে ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

pūrva-dike tāte māṭī alpa khudite
on the east side there the earth a little digging
dhanera jhāri paḍibeka tomāra hātete
of treasure the pot will fall your into the hands

135 But on the east side, as soon as you dig away a little earth, the pot of treasure will fall into your hands.'

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Vedas and Purāṇas speak in many places of many kinds of means. On one side is the *karma-kāṇḍa*, like hornets and wasps (*bhīmarula-barulī*); on another, the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*, like a *yakṣa*; on another, *kaivalya* attained by yoga, like a black python; and on yet another, a pot of hidden treasure that comes into one's hands with little effort. Therefore the Vedic scriptures say that Kṛṣṇa is attained only on the path of devotion, by giving up karma, jñāna and yoga.

Anubhāṣya.

What is being compared: in the east — devotion to Kṛṣṇa; in the south — the *karma-kāṇḍa*; in the west — the *siddhi-kāṇḍa* (in another view, the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*); in the north — the *jñāna-kāṇḍa* (in another view, the *yoga-kāṇḍa*).

What they are compared to: in the east — the father's treasure; in the south — hornets and wasps; in the west — a *yakṣa*; in the north — a black snake.

The practice of the southern path (*dakṣiṇā-mārga*)[31] is the *karma-kāṇḍa*, aimed at enjoying fruits: the agents of Yama's punishment accept the "*dakṣiṇā*" and assign the fruits. On this path of karma the jīva is stung by the hornets and wasps of the desire for enjoyment and suffers. His hope of enjoyment is not fulfilled by this; it only grows more and more.

The practice of the northern path (*uttarā-mārga*) is the path of yoga, aimed at mystic powers (*siddhis*). On it the black python of *kaivalya* swallows the pure existence of the jīva. In the view of some, the practice of the northern path is the path

of desireless jñāna; there the pure existence of the jīva falls into the jaws of the black snake of *brahma-sāyujya*.

The *yakṣa* guards the treasure: that is, he is its keeper, not its giver. To hope to get treasure from a *yakṣa* without perishing is a vain hope: after tempting one with greed for wealth, the *yakṣa* in the end destroys the very person who wants to take it. In truth, *sāyujya* on the path of jñāna and *kaivalya* on the path of yoga both destroy the existence of the jīva.

Devotion to Kṛṣṇa is the conditioned *jīva's* "former" treasure, that is, the treasure already his (*siddha-dhana*); attaining it, the pure jīva is rich forever. One who lacks the treasure of devotion suffers want in the perishable world of matter. Sometimes he writhes from the stings of the hornets of karma and does not get the treasure. Sometimes, turning his back on Kṛṣṇa[32] and busying himself with *ahaṁgrahopāsanā* (worshipping oneself as God) or the pursuit of *kaivalya*, he is robbed of the treasure of prema by the *yakṣa* of yoga. And sometimes, in the north — that is, losing the pure existence of the jīva — he falls into the jaws of the snake of *sāyujya* or *kaivalya*, and again does not gain the treasure.

The purport of all the scriptures is to attain love for Kṛṣṇa by the power of pure devotion —

ঐছে শাস্ত্র কহে, — কর্ম্ম, জ্ঞান, যোগ ত্যজি' ।
'ভক্ত্যে' কৃষ্ণ বশ হয়, ভক্ত্যে তাঁরে ভজি' ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

aiche śāstra kahe, — karma, jñāna, yoga tyaji'
thus the scriptures say karma jñāna yoga giving up
'bhaktye' kṛṣṇa vaśa haya, bhaktye tāṁre bhaji'
by devotion Kṛṣṇa subdued becomes by devotion Him worship

136 So too the scriptures say: give up karma, jñāna and yoga. Kṛṣṇa is won by devotion; worship Him, then, with devotion.

ন সাধয়তি মাং যোগো ন সাংখ্যং ধর্ম্ম উদ্ধব ।
ন স্বাধ্যায়স্তপস্ত্যাগো যথা ভক্তির্মমোর্জ্জিতা ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

na sādhayati māṁ yogo
not wins Me yoga
na sāṁkhyaṁ dharma uddhava
not sāṅkhya dharma O Uddhava
na svādhyāyas tapas tyāgo
not Vedic study austerity renunciation
yathā bhaktir mamorjitā
as devotion to Me intense

137 (Śrī Kṛṣṇa said:) "O Uddhava, neither yoga nor sāṅkhya, neither dharma nor study of the Vedas, neither austerity nor renunciation can win Me as intense devotion to Me does." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.14.20)[10]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 17.76.

Bhagavān can be attained only by devotion; by the power of devotion even a cobbler becomes pure —

ভক্ত্যাহমেকয়া গ্রাহ্যঃ শ্রদ্ধয়াত্মা প্রিয়ঃ সতাম্ ।
ভক্তিঃ পুনাতি মন্নিষ্ঠা শ্বপাকানপি সম্ভবাৎ ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

bhaktyāham ekayā grāhyaḥ
by devotion I by exclusive am attained
śraddhayātmā priyaḥ satām
by faith the Self dear of the saintly
bhaktiḥ punāti man-niṣṭhā
devotion purifies fixed on Me
śva-pākān api sambhavāt
dog-eaters even from (the stain of) birth

138 "I, the dear Self of the saintly, am attained by single-minded devotion born of faith. Devotion fixed on Me purifies even dog-eaters from the stain of their birth." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.14.21)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I, who am dear to the sādhus, am attained only by devotion born of exclusive faith. Devotion fixed on Me frees even a *caṇḍāla* from the defect of birth.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa's words in answer to Uddhava's question.

satāṁ (of the sādhus, His eternal servants) **priyaḥ** (the One they serve) **ātmā** (the dearmost) **aham** (I, Svayaṁ Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa) **ekayā** (unwavering, causeless) **śraddhayā** (full of faith) **bhaktyā grāhyaḥ** (attainable, that is, I can be reached); **man-niṣṭhā** (dedicated to serving Kṛṣṇa alone) **bhaktiḥ śvapākān** (people born in low families) **api sambhavāt** (from the defect of birth in a caste by seminal descent, produced by past sins) **punāti**.

All the scriptures sing of devotion, the means of attaining Kṛṣṇa, as the abhidheya —

অতএব 'ভক্তি' — কৃষ্ণপ্রাপ্ত্যের উপায় ।
'অভিধেয়' বলি' তারে সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রে গায় ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

ataeva 'bhakti' — kṛṣṇa-prāptyera upāya
therefore devotion of Kṛṣṇa of attaining the means
'abhidheya' bali' tāre sarva-śāstre gāya
abhidheya calling it in all the scriptures they sing

139 Therefore devotion is the way to attain Kṛṣṇa, and all the scriptures sing of it as *abhidheya*, the means.

An illustration —

ধন পাইলে যৈছে সুখভোগ-ফল পায় ।
সুখভোগ হৈতে দুঃখ আপনি পলায় ॥ ১৪০ ॥

dhana pāile yaiche sukha-bhoga-phala pāya
wealth on obtaining as of happiness enjoyment the fruit one gets
sukha-bhoga haite duḥkha āpani palāya
from happiness enjoyment sorrow by itself flees

140 When a man gains wealth, he enjoys its fruit, happiness, and in that enjoyment sorrow flees of itself.

Service joined with knowledge of sambandha makes love for Kṛṣṇa grow, and with it come liberation, or freedom from anarthas —

তৈছে ভক্তি-ফলে কৃষ্ণে প্রেম উপজয় ।
প্রেমে কৃষ্ণাস্বাদ হৈলে ভব নাশ পায় ॥ ১৪১ ॥

taiche bhakti-phale kṛṣṇe prema upajaya
so of devotion as the fruit for Kṛṣṇa love arises
preme kṛṣṇāsvāda haile bhava nāśa pāya
in love the tasting of Kṛṣṇa when there is worldly existence destruction attains

141 So too, as the fruit of devotion, love (prema) for Kṛṣṇa arises; and when Kṛṣṇa is tasted in love, worldly existence comes to an end.

The chief fruit of service rooted in love for Kṛṣṇa is the bliss of prema; the secondary fruit is the end of aversion and liberation —

দারিদ্র্য নাশ, ভবক্ষয়, — প্রেমের 'ফল' নয় ।
প্রেমসুখ-ভোগ — মুখ্য প্রয়োজন হয় ॥ ১৪২ ॥

dāridrya nāśa, bhava-kṣaya, — premera 'phala' naya
of poverty the destruction of worldly existence the end of love the fruit is not
prema-sukha-bhoga — mukhya prayojana haya
of love the happiness the enjoyment the chief goal is

142 The end of poverty and the end of worldly existence are not the 'fruit' of love. To enjoy the happiness of love is the chief goal (*prayojana*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The chief fruit of tasting service to Kṛṣṇa is the happiness of love. The *jīva's* poverty is his aversion to Kṛṣṇa. The end of this poverty and the end of *saṁsāra* come along with the taste of service to Kṛṣṇa as by-products; in truth they are not the chief fruit.

In the Vedas Kṛṣṇa is sambandha, bhakti is abhidheya, prema is prayojana —

বেদশাস্ত্রে কহে সম্বন্ধ, অভিধেয়, প্রয়োজন ।
কৃষ্ণ, কৃষ্ণভক্তি, প্রেম, — তিন মহাধন ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

veda-śāstre kahe sambandha, abhidheya, prayojana
in the Vedic scriptures are told sambandha abhidheya prayojana
kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇa-bhakti, prema, — tina mahā-dhana
Kṛṣṇa devotion to Kṛṣṇa love three great treasures

143 The Vedic scriptures speak of *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana*: Kṛṣṇa, devotion to Kṛṣṇa and love — these are the three great treasures.

Together with knowledge of sambandha, the bonds of worldly existence fall away —

বেদাদি সকল শাস্ত্রে কৃষ্ণ — মুখ্য সম্বন্ধ ।
তাঁর জ্ঞানে আনুষঙ্গে যায় মায়াবন্ধ ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

vedādi sakala śāstre kṛṣṇa — mukhya sambandha
in the Vedas and the rest all scriptures Kṛṣṇa the chief sambandha
tāṁra jñāne ānuṣaṅge yāya māyā-bandha
of Him by knowledge as a matter of course goes of māyā the bondage

144 In the Vedas and all the scriptures Kṛṣṇa is the chief *sambandha*. When He is known, the bonds of māyā fall away of themselves.

All the Purāṇas and Āgamas describe the supremacy of Viṣṇu alone — (Padma Purāṇa, Vaiśākha-māhātmya, the dialogue of Yama and a brāhmaṇa) —

ব্যামোহায় চরাচরস্য জগতস্তে তে পুরাণাগমা-
স্তাং তামেব হি দেবতাং পরমিকাং জল্পন্ত কল্পাবধি ।
সিদ্ধান্তে পুনরেক এব ভগবান্ বিষ্ণুঃ সমস্তাগম-
ব্যাপারেষু বিবেচনব্যতিকরং নীতেষু নিশ্চীয়তে ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

vyāmohāya carācarasya jagatas te te purāṇāgamās
to bewilder the moving and unmoving world those those Purāṇas and Āgamas
tāṁ tām eva hi devatāṁ paramikāṁ jalpantu kalpāvadhi
that that very indeed deity supreme let them prattle till the end of the kalpa
siddhānte punar eka eva bhagavān viṣṇuḥ samastāgama-
in conclusion however one alone Bhagavān Viṣṇu of all the scriptures
vyāpāreṣu vivecana-vyatikaraṁ nīteṣu niścīyate
the subjects of analysis to the comparison when brought is ascertained

145 "To bewilder the world of moving and unmoving beings, let the various Purāṇas and Āgamas prattle until the end of the *kalpa* that this or that deity is supreme. But when the teachings of all the scriptures are carefully weighed and compared, the conclusion is certain: Viṣṇu alone is Bhagavān." (Padma Purāṇa, Vaiśākha-māhātmya, the conversation of Yama and a brāhmaṇa)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Let all those Purāṇas and Āgamas declare, until the end of the *kalpa*, that the deity each of them speaks of is "the chief," and so bewilder the moving and the unmoving. Yet when all those Āgamas and other scriptures are examined well, in their conclusions they establish Viṣṇu alone as Bhagavān.

Anubhāṣya.

carācarasya (of the unmoving and the moving) **jagataḥ vyāmohāya** (to increase the darkness of ignorance) **te te purāṇāgamāḥ** (the *smṛtis*, *tantras* and the rest) **kalpāvadhi** (until the end of the *kalpa*) **tāṁ tām devatām eva paramikāṁ** (the highest) **jalpantu** (let them prattle — said in derision); **punaḥ** (but) **samastāgama-vyāpāreṣu** (when the subjects, that is, the aims, of all the Āgamas — the scriptures) **vivecana-vyatikaraṁ** (to comparison in examination: examination is a search for faults, and *vyatikara* here is contact with the examination of the *Skanda Purāṇa* and the rest) **nīteṣu** (have been brought) **siddhānte** (in the conclusion) **viṣṇuḥ eva ekaḥ bhagavān** (the Lord of all) **niścīyate** (is determined, that is, established).

Directly and indirectly, in all the Vedas Kṛṣṇa is the One to be known and the

One they establish —

মুখ্য-গৌণ-বৃত্তি কিংবা অন্বয়-ব্যতিরেকে ।
বেদের প্রতিজ্ঞা কেবল কহয়ে কৃষ্ণকে ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

mukhya-gauṇa-vṛtti kiṁvā anvaya-vyatireke
by the primary secondary sense or by affirmation and negation
vedera pratijñā kevala kahaye kṛṣṇake
of the Vedas the declaration only speaks of Kṛṣṇa

146 Whether by the primary or the secondary sense of words, or by affirmation and negation, the declaration of the Vedas speaks only of Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
Whether by the primary sense (*rūḍhi*) or the secondary sense (*lakṣaṇā*), or by the positive and negative method (*anvaya* and *vyatireka*), Kṛṣṇa is shown to be the subject the Vedas establish.

The evidence of scripture: words from the Lord's own mouth — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.21.42–43) —

কিং বিধত্তে কিমাচষ্টে কিমনূদ্য বিকল্পয়েৎ ।
ইত্যস্যা হৃদয়ং লোকে নান্যো মদ্বেদ কশ্চন ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

kiṁ vidhatte kim ācaṣṭe
what it enjoins what it declares
kim anūdya vikalpayet
what naming it considers as an option
ity asyā hṛdayaṁ loke
thus of this (Veda) the heart in the world
nānyo mad veda kaścana
not another than Me knows anyone

147 "What does the Veda enjoin? What does it declare? Of what does it speak when it weighs alternatives? No one in the world but Me knows its heart." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.21.42)

মাং বিধত্তেঽভিধত্তে মাং বিকল্প্যাপোহ্যতে হ্যহম্ ।
এতাবান্ সর্ব্ববেদার্থঃ শব্দ আস্থায় মাং ভিদাম্ ।
মায়ামাত্রমনূদ্যান্তে প্রতিষিধ্য প্রসীদতি ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

māṁ vidhatte 'bhidhatte māṁ
Me it enjoins it declares Me

vikalpyāpohyate hy aham
having been considered is set aside indeed I

etāvān sarva-vedārthaḥ
this much of all the Vedas the meaning

śabda āsthāya māṁ bhidām
the Veda resting on Me the differences

māyā-mātram anūdyānte
as mere māyā having named at the end

pratiṣidhya prasīdati
having negated comes to rest

148 "It enjoins Me, it declares Me; and what it considers and then sets aside is also Me. This is the meaning of all the Vedas: resting on Me, the Veda names the differences of this world as mere māyā, negates them, and in the end comes to rest." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.21.43)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

What all the statements of the Vedas enjoin, what they establish, what they have in view when they weigh alternatives (*vikalpa*) — no one but Me knows this purport of the Vedas. I say: the statements of the Vedas directly enjoin and name Me, and when they weigh alternatives, they speak of Me as well. I alone am the purport of all the Vedas. The Vedas examine māyā alone, at last reject it completely, and come to rest (cease from reasoning).

Anubhāṣya.

Uddhava asked about the injunctions and prohibitions of the Vedas. In answer Śrī Kṛṣṇa first describes the fruits that the *karma-kāṇḍa* of the Vedas promises (*phala-śruti*), then the various Vedic meters, and He says that He Himself is the one subject to be established and known in the Vedas — full of deep mystery, hard to understand, made up of three divisions (*kāṇḍas*):

(Having said that the great Vedic speech in its entirety is unknowable in its nature, He says that it is unknowable in its meaning too:) **kiṁ vidhatte** (what does the *karma-kāṇḍa* — one of the three *kāṇḍas* of the Vedic scriptures: of karma, of the *devatās* and of jñāna — enjoin by its injunctions), **kim ācaṣṭe** (what does the *devatā-kāṇḍa* reveal by its statements, that is, of what does it speak), **kim anūdya** (relying on what in the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*) **vikalpayet iti** (thus) **asyāḥ** (of this *śruti*) **hṛdayaṁ loke** (here in the world) **mat** (besides Me) **anyaḥ kaścana na veda** (knows). ("Then by Your mercy tell it," — to this He says:) **mām** (Me in the form of sacrifice, by injunction) **vidhatte** (by the primary sense); **mām eva** (Me in the form of this or that deity) **abhidhatte**; **aham** (I alone) **vikalpya** (having raised doubt) **apohyate** (am rejected: what is rejected is also I; nothing is separate from Me). (He states briefly the meaning of all the Vedas:) **etāvān eva sarva-vedārthaḥ** (the meaning of all the Vedas) — **śabdaḥ** (the Veda) **bhidām** (the differences — the forms of the avatāras and the rest) **anūdya** (having named), **māyā-mātram** (the world) **pratiṣidhya** (having rejected), **tad-ante** (at the end) **mām** (Me, the highest goal) **āsthāya** (taking as shelter) **prasīdati** (ceases from activity; that is, resting on Me alone in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, it attains its goal).

The unlimited potencies and opulences of Kṛṣṇa, whose nature is unlimited —

কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ — অনন্ত, বৈভব — অপার ।
চিচ্ছক্তি, মায়াশক্তি, জীবশক্তি আর ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

kṛṣṇera svarūpa — ananta, vaibhava — apāra
Kṛṣṇa's own nature is infinite splendour is boundless
cic-chakti, māyā-śakti, jīva-śakti āra
the spiritual potency the potency of māyā the potency of the jīvas and

149 Kṛṣṇa's own nature (*svarūpa*) is infinite, His splendour boundless: the spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*), the potency of māyā (*māyā-śakti*) and the potency of the jīvas (*jīva-śakti*) are all His.

The spiritual and nonspiritual worlds are transformations of the respective potencies, and both rest on Kṛṣṇa —

বৈকুণ্ঠ, ব্রহ্মাণ্ডগণ — শক্তি-কার্য্য হয় ।
স্বরূপশক্তি শক্তিকার্য্যের — কৃষ্ণ সমাশ্রয় ॥ ১৫০ ॥

vaikuṇṭha, brahmāṇḍa-gaṇa — śakti-kārya haya
Vaikuṇṭha the multitude of universes of the potencies the works are
svarūpa-śakti śakti-kāryera — kṛṣṇa samāśraya
of the potency of His own nature of the works of the potencies Kṛṣṇa the shelter

150 Vaikuṇṭha and the countless universes are the works of these potencies. Of His own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) and of all the works of His potencies, Kṛṣṇa is the shelter.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The potency of His own nature (*svarūpa-śakti*) and the world, which is the work of all His potencies, have one shelter only — Kṛṣṇa.

(Śrīdhara Svāmī's words in his commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.1.1) —

দশমে দশমং লক্ষ্যমাশ্রিতাশ্রয়-বিগ্রহম্ ।
শ্রীকৃষ্ণাখ্যং পরং ধাম জগদ্ধাম নমামি তৎ ॥ ১৫১ ॥

daśame daśamaṁ lakṣyam
in the Tenth (Canto) the tenth the subject
āśritāśraya-vigraham
of the sheltered the shelter the embodiment
śrī-kṛṣṇākhyaṁ paraṁ dhāma
Śrī Kṛṣṇa named the supreme abode
jagad-dhāma namāmi tat
of the world the abode I bow to That

151 "In the Tenth Canto the tenth subject is revealed: the embodiment of the shelter of all who take shelter, the supreme abode named Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the abode of the world. To That I bow down." (Śrīdhara Svāmī, *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.1.1)[11]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.95.

Kṛṣṇa's nature examined: He is nondual knowledge, all-pervading, eternity, knowledge and bliss, the source of all avatāras, youthful and the son of the

King of Vraja —

কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপবিচার শুন, সনাতন ।
অদ্বয়জ্ঞান-তত্ত্ব, ব্রজে ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ॥ ১৫২ ॥

kṛṣṇera svarūpa-vicāra śuna, sanātana
of Kṛṣṇa on the own nature the deliberation hear Sanātana
advaya-jñāna-tattva, vraje vrajendra-nandana
of non-dual knowledge the Truth in Vraja the son of Vraja's king

152 Now hear, Sanātana, the truth about Kṛṣṇa's own nature (*svarūpa*). He is the Truth of non-dual knowledge, and in Vraja He is the son of the king of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.
O Sanātana, this is how Kṛṣṇa's nature is examined: Kṛṣṇa is the son of Nanda, the king of Vraja, in the abode of Vraja. He is the truth of nondual knowledge (*advaya-jñāna-tattva*). In His four truths — His name, form, qualities and pastimes — no difference or contradiction born of māyā is seen. In other words, the order of differences that belongs to māyā cannot operate between Kṛṣṇa's name, form, qualities and pastimes.

সর্ব্ব-আদি, সর্ব্ব-অংশী, কিশোর-শেখর ।
চিদানন্দ-দেহ, সর্ব্বাশ্রয়, সর্ব্বেশ্বর ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

sarva-ādi, sarva-aṁśī, kiśora-śekhara
of all the origin of all the source of the parts of youths the crown
cidānanda-deha, sarvāśraya, sarveśvara
of spirit and bliss whose body the shelter of all the Lord of all

153 He is the origin of all and the source of all parts (*aṁśī*), the crown of youths. His body is spirit and bliss; He is the shelter of all and the Lord of all.

Anubhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa is the original truth of all the *viṣṇu-tattvas* and *vaiṣṇava-tattvas*: from Him all the parts (*aṁśas*) have become manifest. He is in the full bloom of youth

(*kiśora*), His form is eternity, knowledge and bliss (*sac-cid-ānanda-vigraha*), He is the Lord of all and the shelter of all that exists.

(Brahma-saṁhitā 5.1) —

ঈশ্বরঃ পরমঃ কৃষ্ণঃ সচ্চিদানন্দবিগ্রহঃ ।
অনাদিরাদির্গোবিন্দঃ সর্ব্বকারণকারণম্ ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

īśvaraḥ paramaḥ kṛṣṇaḥ
the Lord Supreme Kṛṣṇa
sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaḥ
of being knowledge bliss whose form
anādir ādir govindaḥ
without beginning the beginning Govinda
sarva-kāraṇa-kāraṇam
of all causes the cause

154 "Kṛṣṇa, Govinda, is the Supreme Lord; His form is eternal being, knowledge and bliss. He has no beginning, yet He is the beginning of all, the cause of all causes." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.1)[12]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.107.

Kṛṣṇa is Govinda, and He abides in the abode of Goloka —

স্বয়ং ভগবান্ কৃষ্ণ, 'গোবিন্দ' পর নাম ।
সর্ব্বৈশ্বর্য্যপূর্ণ যাঁর গোলোক — নিত্যধাম ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa, 'govinda' para nāma
Himself Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa Govinda the supreme name
sarvaiśvarya-pūrṇa yāṁra goloka — nitya-dhāma
with all opulence full whose Goloka the eternal abode

155 Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself; 'Govinda' is His supreme name. He is full of all opulence, and Goloka is His eternal abode.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *para* name is the highest, that is, the principal name: "Kṛṣṇa," "Govinda" and the like are the principal names of Bhagavān.

Anubhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa's dwelling is Goloka-dhāma, full of all opulence, imperishable and eternal.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.3.28) —

এতে চাংশকলাঃ পুংসঃ কৃষ্ণস্তু ভগবান্ স্বয়ম্ ।
ইন্দ্রারিব্যাকুলং লোকং মৃড়য়ন্তি যুগে যুগে ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ puṁsaḥ
these and portions and parts of the Puruṣa
kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam
Kṛṣṇa but Bhagavān Himself
indrāri-vyākulaṁ lokaṁ
by the enemies of Indra troubled the world
mṛḍayanti yuge yuge
make happy in age after age

156 "All these (avatāras) are portions (*aṁśa*) and parts of portions (*kalā*) of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring happiness to the world when it is troubled by the enemies of Indra." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.28)[13]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.67.

In the three kinds of abhidheya, the truth of sambandha — nondual knowledge, Kṛṣṇa — is perceived in three ways —

জ্ঞান, যোগ, ভক্তি, — তিন সাধনের বশে ।
ব্রহ্ম, আত্মা, ভগবান্, — ত্রিবিধ প্রকাশে ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

jñāna, yoga, bhakti, — tina sādhanera vaśe
knowledge yoga devotion of the three practices by the power
brahma, ātmā, bhagavān, — trividha prakāśe
Brahman Paramātmā Bhagavān threefold He is manifest

157 According to the three practices — knowledge, yoga and devotion — He is manifest in three ways: as Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
To those who seek that nondual Truth through knowledge of the featureless, it appears as the featureless Brahman. To those who seek that Supreme Reality on the path of eightfold yoga, it appears as the Paramātmā, who abides in the heart and pervades the world. And those who pursue the supreme Truth by pure bhakti see Bhagavān.

The evidence of scripture — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.11) —

বদন্তি তত্তত্ত্ববিদস্তত্ত্বং যজ্‌জ্ঞানমদ্বয়ম্ ।
ব্রহ্মেতি পরমাত্মেতি ভগবানিতি শব্দ্যতে ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

vadanti tat tattva-vidas
they call that of truth the knowers
tattvaṁ yaj jñānam advayam
the Truth which knowledge non-dual
brahmeti paramātmeti
Brahman thus Paramātmā thus
bhagavān iti śabdyate
Bhagavān thus is named

158 "The knowers of the Truth call the non-dual knowledge the Truth; it is named Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.2.11)[14]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.11.

(1) The featureless Brahman is the effulgence of Kṛṣṇa's body —

ব্রহ্ম — অঙ্গকান্তি তাঁর, নির্ব্বিশেষ-প্রকাশে ।
সূর্য্য যেন চর্ম্মচক্ষে জ্যোতির্ম্ময় ভাসে ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

brahma — aṅga-kānti tāṁra, nirviśeṣa-prakāśe
Brahman of the body the effulgence His as the featureless manifestation
sūrya yena carma-cakṣe jyotirmaya bhāse
the sun as to the fleshly eye as mere light appears

159 Brahman is the effulgence of His body, His featureless manifestation — just as the sun appears to the fleshly eye as nothing but light.

The evidence of scripture — (Brahma-saṁhitā 5.40) —

যস্য প্রভা প্রভবতো জগদণ্ডকোটি-
কোটিষ্বশেষবসুধাদিবিভূতিভিন্নম্ ।
তদ্ব্রহ্ম নিষ্কলমনন্তমশেষভূতং
গোবিন্দমাদিপুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ১৬০ ॥

yasya prabhā prabhavato jagad-aṇḍa-koṭi-
whose effulgence of the all-mighty of universes of millions
koṭiṣv aśeṣa-vasudhādi-vibhūti-bhinnam
in millions unlimited earths and the like opulences distinct from
tad brahma niṣkalam anantam aśeṣa-bhūtaṁ
that Brahman undivided infinite all-complete
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

160 "I worship Govinda, the original Person. Brahman — undivided, infinite and complete, distinct from all the opulences of countless universes, their earths and all else — is the effulgence of Him, the Almighty." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.40)[15]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.14.

(2) The Paramātmā is the glory of Kṛṣṇa's part —

পরমাত্মা যিঁহো, তিঁহো কৃষ্ণের এক অংশ ।
আত্মার 'আত্মা' হন কৃষ্ণ সর্ব্ব-অবতংস ॥ ১৬১ ॥

paramātmā yiṁho, tiṁho kṛṣṇera eka aṁśa
the Paramātmā He who He of Kṛṣṇa one part
ātmāra 'ātmā' hana kṛṣṇa sarva-avataṁsa
of the soul the Soul is Kṛṣṇa of all the crown

161 The Paramātmā is one part of Kṛṣṇa, and Kṛṣṇa, the crown of all, is the Soul of the soul.

Anubhāṣya.
In worldly perception the all-pervading Paramātmā is given the name "Paramātmā," the all-pervading, because He is the whole (*aṁśī*) of which the parts of the world are parts. But Kṛṣṇa is supreme over all, as the "Paramātmā" of all that is manifest in spirit and matter and of all the *paramātmās*.

Kṛṣṇa is the Paramātmā — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.14.55) —

কৃষ্ণমেনমবেহি ত্বমাত্মানমখিলাত্মনাম্ ।
জগদ্ধিতায় সোঽপ্যত্র দেহীবাভাতি মায়য়া ॥ ১৬২ ॥

kṛṣṇam enam avehi tvam
Kṛṣṇa this know you
ātmānam akhilātmanām
the Soul of all souls
jagad-dhitāya so 'py atra
for the good of the world He also here
dehīvābhāti māyayā
as if embodied appears by His own potency

162 "Know this Kṛṣṇa to be the Soul of all souls. For the good of the world He appears here, by His own potency, as if He were an embodied being." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.55)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Know this Śrī Kṛṣṇa to be the Self of all selves. Wishing the good of the world, He has appeared here like a human being, relying on His *svarūpa-śakti*.

Anubhāṣya.
Parīkṣit asked why the residents of Vraja held Kṛṣṇa dearer than their own sons, their lives and everything else. Śrī Śukadeva says that for every embodied being

the self (*ātmā*) is the dearest and most cherished of all, and that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the Self of all selves. Therefore by His very nature He attracts everyone and bestows eternal bliss:

tvam enam akhilātmanām (of all embodied beings) **ātmānam** (the very life) **kṛṣṇam avehi** (know); **yaḥ** (Kṛṣṇa) **api atra** (in the world) **jagad-dhitāya** (for the good of the earth) **māyayā** (by His *svarūpa-śakti*) **dehī** (a man, a *jīva*) **iva ābhāti** (manifests Himself).

(Bhagavad-gītā 10.42) —

অথবা বহুনৈতেন কিং জ্ঞাতেন তবার্জ্জুন ।
বিষ্টভ্যাহমিদং কৃৎস্নমেকাংশেন স্থিতো জগৎ ॥ ১৬৩ ॥

atha vā bahunaitena
but or with much this
kiṁ jñātena tavārjuna
what (use) by knowing for you Arjuna
viṣṭabhyāham idaṁ kṛtsnam
pervading I this entire
ekāṁśena sthito jagat
by one portion I stand the universe

163 "But what need have you, Arjuna, of all this detailed knowledge? By one portion of Myself I pervade and support this entire universe." (Bhagavad-gītā, 10.42)[16]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.20.

(3) Only in bhakti-yoga is Kṛṣṇa perceived fully as Bhagavān —

'ভক্ত্যে' ভগবানের অনুভব — পূর্ণরূপ ।
একই বিগ্রহে তাঁর অনন্ত স্বরূপ ॥ ১৬৪ ॥

'bhaktye' bhagavānera anubhava — pūrṇa-rūpa
by devotion of Bhagavān the realisation in His full form
eka-i vigrahe tāṁra ananta svarūpa
in one and the same form His infinite forms

164 Through devotion Bhagavān is realised in His full form: in His one form are His infinite forms.

The three forms of the one Kṛṣṇa: (a) svayaṁ-rūpa, (b) tad-ekātma-rūpa and (c) āveśa-rūpa —

স্বয়ংরূপ, তদেকাত্মরূপ, আবেশ — নাম ৷
প্রথমেই তিনরূপে রহেন ভগবান্ ॥ ১৬৫ ॥

svayaṁ-rūpa, tad-ekātma-rūpa, āveśa — nāma
svayaṁ-rūpa tad-ekātma-rūpa āveśa by name
prathamei tina-rūpe rahena bhagavān
first of all in three forms abides Bhagavān

165 First of all, Bhagavān abides in three forms, named *svayaṁ-rūpa*, *tad-ekātma-rūpa* and *āveśa*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

When one worships Bhagavān in bhakti, one experiences His full form: in that one eternal form (*vigraha*) countless forms shine forth. First of all Bhagavān is seen in three forms: *svayaṁ-rūpa*, *tad-ekātma-rūpa* and *āveśa-rūpa*. In the *svayaṁ-rūpa* He appears in two ways, as *svayam* and *prakāśa*; of these, in the *svayaṁ-rūpa* Śrī Kṛṣṇa appears in Vraja in the form of a cowherd boy. According to the *Bhāgavatāmṛta*, the *svayaṁ-rūpa* is Kṛṣṇa's cowherd form, because it depends on no other form of His. That form of His which is nondifferent from the *svayaṁ-rūpa* but differs in shape, opulence and so on is called *tad-ekātma-rūpa*. And the jīvas whom Bhagavān's potency enters and who perform great works are Bhagavān's *āveśa* forms.

Anubhāṣya.

The *svayaṁ-rūpa*. In Śrī Rūpa Prabhu's *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (*Pūrva-khaṇḍa* 12): "The form that depends on no other is called the *svayaṁ-rūpa*." He whose form does not depend on any other form, that is, who exists by Himself, is called the *svayaṁ-rūpa*.

The *tad-ekātma-rūpa*. In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (*Pūrva-khaṇḍa* 14): "The form that shines forth nondifferent from Him in nature, yet other in shape and so on, is called the *tad-ekātma-rūpa*." The form that is manifest as one with the *svayaṁ-rūpa* but appears different in shape, opulence and so on (in the build of the body, in character and so on) is called the *tad-ekātma-rūpa*. It is of two kinds: *svāṁśa* and *vilāsa*.

The *āveśa-rūpa*. In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (*Pūrva-khaṇḍa* 18): "Those whom Janārdana enters with a portion of His potency of knowledge and so on are called *āveśas*; they are the greatest of jīvas." The greatest jīvas, whom Janārdana enters with a portion (*kalā*) of His potency of knowledge and so on, are called *āveśa*.

(a) The svayaṁ-rūpa is of two kinds: (1) the svayaṁ-rūpa, the son of the King of Vraja, and (2) the svayaṁ-prakāśa —

'স্বয়ংরূপ', 'স্বয়ংপ্রকাশ', — দুই রূপে স্ফূর্ত্তি ।
স্বয়ংরূপে — এক 'কৃষ্ণ' ব্রজে গোপমূর্ত্তি ॥ ১৬৬ ॥

'svayaṁ-rūpa', 'svayaṁ-prakāśa', — dui rūpe sphūrti
svayaṁ-rūpa svayaṁ-prakāśa in two forms the manifestation
svayaṁ-rūpe — eka 'kṛṣṇa' vraje gopa-mūrti
in the svayaṁ-rūpa the one Kṛṣṇa in Vraja in the form of a cowherd

166 The original form shines forth in two ways, as the *svayaṁ-rūpa* and as the *svayaṁ-prakāśa*. As the *svayaṁ-rūpa*, the one Kṛṣṇa is a cowherd in Vraja.

Among the six kinds of vilāsa of Kṛṣṇa's form, (2) the svayaṁ-prakāśa is of two kinds, (a) prābhava and (b) vaibhava; in the rāsa — the prābhava-prakāśa, at the marriage with the queens — the vaibhava-prakāśa[33] *—*

'প্রাভব'-'বৈভব'-রূপে দ্বিবিধ প্রকাশে ।
এক-বপু বহু রূপ যৈছে হৈল রাসে ॥ ১৬৭ ॥

'prābhava'-'vaibhava'-rūpe dvividha prakāśe
of prābhava of vaibhava in the forms twofold manifestation
eka-vapu bahu rūpa yaiche haila rāse
one body many forms as became in the rāsa

167 The *svayaṁ-prakāśa* shows itself in two ways, as *prābhava* and *vaibhava*. Thus in the rāsa dance His one body became many forms.

মহিষী-বিবাহে হৈল বহুবিধ মূর্ত্তি ।
'বৈভবপ্রকাশ' — এই শাস্ত্র-পরসিদ্ধি ॥ ১৬৮ ॥

mahiṣī-vivāhe haila bahu-vidha mūrti
at the marriage with the queens there were of many kinds forms
'vaibhava-prakāśa' — ei śāstra-parasiddhi
vaibhava-prakāśa this in the scriptures well known

168 And at His marriages with the queens He appeared in forms of many kinds. This is the *vaibhava-prakāśa*, as is well known in the scriptures.

They captivate the mind even of the ātmārāmas and are never mundane —

সৌভর্য্যাদি-প্রায় সেই কায়ব্যূহ নয় ।
কায়ব্যূহ হৈলে নারদের বিস্ময় না হয় ॥ ১৬৯ ॥

saubhary-ādi-prāya sei kāya-vyūha naya
like Saubhari and others these multiplication of the body are not
kāya-vyūha haile nāradera vismaya nā haya
multiplication of the body if it were Nārada's wonder not would be

169 These forms are not a multiplication of the body (*kāya-vyūha*) like that of Saubhari and others; if they were, Nārada would not have been struck with wonder.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Saubhari and other sages made *kāya-vyūhas* (many bodies) by the power of yoga and so accomplished their aims. But the many forms that Kṛṣṇa manifests are not like that, for Nārada would not have been amazed at seeing the *kāya-vyūha* of the path of yoga.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.69.2) —

চিত্রং বতৈতদেকেন বপুষা যুগপৎ পৃথক্ ।
গৃহেষু দ্ব্যষ্টসাহস্রং স্ত্রিয় এক উদাবহৎ ॥ ১৭০ ॥

citraṁ bataitad ekena
wonderful indeed this with one
vapuṣā yugapat pṛthak
body at once separately
gṛheṣu dvy-aṣṭa-sāhasraṁ
in palaces sixteen thousand
striya eka udāvahat
women the One married

170 "How wonderful! The one Kṛṣṇa, in one and the same body, married sixteen thousand princesses at once, each in her own palace." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.69.2)[17]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.74.

(b) The definition of the vaibhava-prakāśa —

সেই বপু, সেই আকৃতি পৃথক যদি ভাসে ।
ভাবাবেশ-ভেদে নাম 'বৈভবপ্রকাশে' ॥ ১৭১ ॥

sei vapu, sei ākṛti pṛthak yadi bhāse
that same body that same form separately if appears
bhāvāveśa-bhede nāma 'vaibhava-prakāśe'
of absorption in bhāva by the difference the name vaibhava-prakāśa

171 When that same body, that same form, appears separately, differing only in the emotion (*bhāva*) that absorbs it, it is called *vaibhava-prakāśa*.

The countless prābhava- and vaibhava-prakāśas of the one Kṛṣṇa, the source of all parts, differ from one another in name, form and so on by His

inconceivable potency —

অনন্ত প্রকাশে কৃষ্ণের নাহি মূর্ত্তিভেদ ।
আকার-বর্ণ-অস্ত্র-ভেদে নাম বিভেদ ॥ ১৭২ ॥

ananta prakāśe kṛṣṇera nāhi mūrti-bheda
in the infinite manifestations of Kṛṣṇa there is no of form difference
ākāra-varṇa-astra-bhede nāma vibheda
of shape colour weapons by the difference of names difference

172 In Kṛṣṇa's infinite manifestations there is no difference in His person; they bear different names according to differences of shape, colour and weapons.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.40.7) —

অন্যে চ সংস্কৃতাত্মানো বিধিনাভিহিতেন তে ।
যজন্তি ত্বন্ময়াস্ত্বাং বৈ বহুমূর্ত্ত্যেকমূর্ত্তিকম্ ॥ ১৭৩ ॥

anye ca saṁskṛtātmāno
others and purified in self
vidhinābhihitena te
by the rule enjoined by You
yajanti tvan-mayās tvāṁ vai
worship absorbed in You You indeed
bahu-mūrty eka-mūrtikam
having many forms having one form

173 "Others, purified by the rules You Yourself have enjoined and absorbed in You, worship You alone, who have many forms and yet are one form." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.40.7)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Those who have been purified (*saṁskṛtātmā*) by the rules enjoined (in the Sātvata and Śaiva *tantras* and others) worship You Yourself, the one form in many forms.

Anubhāṣya.

Akrūra was taking Bhagavān Rāma and Kṛṣṇa by chariot from Gokula to Mathurā. On the way the great soul Akrūra entered the waters of the Yamunā, and there, in

Viṣṇuloka, he saw Bhagavān, full of supreme majesty, together with Śeṣa, Nārada, the four Sanas and others. Offering prayers, he spoke of the subject of the paths of Sāṅkhya, yoga and the three Vedas, and then describes the path of worship of those initiated with Vaiṣṇava, Śaiva-Pāśupata and other initiations:

anye ca (people) **te** (by You) **abhihitena** (spoken) **tena vidhinā** (by the rule — by the injunctions of the *Pañcarātra* and the like) **saṁskṛtātmānaḥ** (those whose selves are purified by initiation, Vaiṣṇava or Śaiva) **tvan-mayāḥ** (absorbed in You: regarding themselves as devoted to transcendental service, or holding You alone supreme) **bahu-mūrty-eka-mūrtikam** (You, many in Your forms — Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha, and the *yuga-*, *manvantara-* and *līlā-avatāras* — and one in the form of Mahā-Nārāyaṇa) **vai** (indeed) **yajanti** (worship).

(b) The vaibhava-prakāśa: (1) Śrī Balarāma —

বৈভবপ্রকাশ কৃষ্ণের — শ্রীবলরাম ।
বর্ণমাত্র-ভেদ, সব — কৃষ্ণের সমান ॥ ১৭৪ ॥

vaibhava-prakāśa kṛṣṇera — śrī-balarāma
vaibhava-prakāśa of Kṛṣṇa Śrī Balarāma

varṇa-mātra-bheda, saba — kṛṣṇera samāna
of colour only the difference in all to Kṛṣṇa equal

174 Śrī Balarāma is the *vaibhava-prakāśa* of Kṛṣṇa. They differ only in colour; in all else He is equal to Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

To understand *svayaṁ-rūpa*, *tad-ekātma-rūpa*, *āveśa*, *vaibhava*, *prābhava* and the rest, their relation to one another is shown briefly below.

The three original forms of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

(1) The *svayaṁ-rūpa*: Śrī Kṛṣṇa in the form of a cowherd boy in Vraja. (2) The *tad-ekātma-rūpa*: (a) *svāṁśa* — (1) Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, Garbhodaśāyī, Kṣīrodaśāyī; (2) Matsya, Kūrma, Varāha, Nṛsiṁha and others; (b) *vilāsa* — (1) *prābhava*: Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna, Aniruddha; (2) *vaibhava*: twenty-four forms — (a) the *āvaraṇa* (surrounding circle): the four forms of the *catur-vyūha*, Vāsudeva and the others; (b) each of them manifests three forms, twelve in all, the deities of the twelve months and the pattern of the (marks of) *tilaka*; (c) the eight

vilāsa forms of those four — Puruṣottama, Acyuta and others. These twenty-four forms bear different names according to how they hold their weapons.

(2) The two-armed Vāsudeva in Kṛṣṇa's form, that is, the son of Devakī; (3) the four-armed Vāsudeva in Kṛṣṇa's form, that is, the son of Devakī —

বৈভবপ্রকাশ যৈছে দেবকী-তনুজ ।
দ্বিভুজ-স্বরূপ কভু, কভু হন চতুর্ভুজ ॥ ১৭৫ ॥

vaibhava-prakāśa yaiche devakī-tanuja
vaibhava-prakāśa as of Devakī the son
dvibhuja-svarūpa kabhu, kabhu hana caturbhuja
two-armed form sometimes sometimes He is four-armed

175 Another *vaibhava-prakāśa* is the son of Devakī: sometimes His form is two-armed, and sometimes He is four-armed.

This four-armed form is a form in which the same two-armed one is manifest —

যে-কালে দ্বিভুজ, নাম — বৈভবপ্রকাশ ।
চতুর্ভুজ হৈলে, নাম — প্রাভববিলাস ॥ ১৭৬ ॥

ye-kāle dvibhuja, nāma — vaibhava-prakāśa
when two-armed the name vaibhava-prakāśa
caturbhuja haile, nāma — prābhava-vilāsa
four-armed on becoming the name prābhava-vilāsa

176 When He is two-armed, He is called *vaibhava-prakāśa*; when He becomes four-armed, He is called *prābhava-vilāsa*.

The son of the King of Vraja thinks of Himself as a cowherd, Vāsudeva as a kṣatriya —

স্বয়ংরূপের গোপবেশ, গোপ-অভিমান ।
বাসুদেবের ক্ষত্রিয়-বেশ, 'আমি — ক্ষত্রিয়'-জ্ঞান ॥ ১৭৭ ॥

svayaṁ-rūpera gopa-veśa, gopa-abhimāna
of the svayaṁ-rūpa a cowherd's dress a cowherd's self-conception
vāsudevera kṣatriya-veśa, 'āmi — kṣatriya'-jñāna
of Vāsudeva a kṣatriya's dress I a kṣatriya the awareness

177 The *svayaṁ-rūpa* wears a cowherd's dress and thinks of Himself as a cowherd; Vāsudeva wears a kṣatriya's dress and is aware, 'I am a kṣatriya.'

In the son of Nanda there are four wonders more than in Vāsudeva —

সৌন্দর্য্য, ঐশ্বর্য্য, মাধুর্য্য, বৈদগ্ধ্য-বিলাস ।
ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দনে ইঁহা অধিক উল্লাস ॥ ১৭৮ ॥

saundarya, aiśvarya, mādhurya, vaidagdhya-vilāsa
beauty majesty sweetness of artfulness the play
vrajendra-nandane iṁhā adhika ullāsa
in the son of Vraja's king these greater delight

178 In the son of the king of Vraja, beauty, majesty, sweetness and the play of His artfulness (*vaidagdhya*) bring still greater delight.

Anubhāṣya.
The beauty, majesty, sweetness and play of artfulness (*vaidagdhya-vilāsa*) of the son of Nanda carry more delight (*ullāsa*) than those of the son of Vasudeva.

Even Vāsudeva is charmed and attracted by the sweetness of the son of Nanda —

গোবিন্দের মাধুরী দেখি' বাসুদেবের ক্ষোভ ।
সে মাধুরী আস্বাদিতে উপজয় লোভ ॥ ১৭৯ ॥

govindera mādhurī dekhi' vāsudevera kṣobha
Govinda's sweetness seeing Vāsudeva's agitation
se mādhurī āsvādite upajaya lobha
that sweetness to taste arises longing

179 Seeing Govinda's sweetness, Vāsudeva is stirred, and a longing arises in Him to taste that sweetness —

Anubhāṣya.

Seeing the alluring sweetness of the son of Nanda, Vāsudeva becomes agitated. The occasions when He grew eager to taste that sweetness are shown in Mathurā, when He watched the dance of the Gandharvas, and in Dvārakā, when He looked at a painting of Kṛṣṇa.

Examples — in Mathurā and in Dvārakā —

মথুরায় যৈছে গন্ধর্ব্বনৃত্য-দরশনে ।
পুনঃ দ্বারকাতে যৈছে চিত্র-বিলোকনে ॥ ১৮০ ॥

mathurāya yaiche gandharva-nṛtya-daraśane
in Mathurā as of the Gandharvas' dance on seeing
punaḥ dvārakāte yaiche citra-vilokane
again in Dvārakā as a picture on beholding

180 as in Mathurā, when He watched the dance of the Gandharvas, and again in Dvārakā, when He beheld a picture.

(Lalita-mādhava 4.19: Śrī Kṛṣṇa's words to Uddhava) —

উদ্গীর্ণাদ্ভুত-মাধুরী-পরিমলস্যাভীরলীলস্য মে
দ্বৈতং হন্ত সমীক্ষয়ন্ মুহুরসৌ চিত্রীয়তে চারণঃ ।
চেতঃ কেলি-কুতূহলোত্তরলিতং সত্যং সখে মামকং
যস্য প্রেক্ষ্য স্বরূপতাং ব্রজবধূসারূপ্যমন্বিচ্ছতি ॥ ১৮১ ॥

udgīrṇādbhuta-mādhurī-parimalasyābhīra-līlasya me
of overflowing wondrous sweetness fragrance of cowherd pastimes My
dvaitaṁ hanta samīkṣayan muhur asau citrīyate cāraṇaḥ
the double ah showing again and again this works wonders actor
cetaḥ keli-kutūhalottaralitaṁ satyaṁ sakhe māmakaṁ
the heart by eagerness for play stirred truly O friend My
yasya prekṣya svarūpatāṁ vraja-vadhū-sārūpyam anvicchati
whose seeing the likeness of the girls of Vraja the form desires

181 (Vāsudeva said:) "O friend, again and again this actor works wonders, showing a double of Me in My cowherd pastimes, which overflow with the

fragrance of wondrous sweetness. Ah, when I see how like Me he is, My heart, stirred by eagerness for such play, truly longs for a form like that of the girls of Vraja." (Lalita-mādhava, 4.19)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O friend, this *cāraṇa*, as if My second form, is portraying My pastimes — the pastimes of a cowherd boy, full of a wondrous fragrance of sweetness. My mind, stirred by eagerness for play, looks upon My own deeds and longs to take the form of the young women of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.

he sakhe, **asau cāraṇaḥ** (the actor) **udgīrṇādbhuta-mādhurī-parimalasya** (from whom the fragrance — the aroma — of a wondrous, unprecedented sweetness has risen and spread) **ābhīra-līlasya** (full of the pastimes of the son of Nanda the cowherd) **me** (My) **dvaitaṁ** (second form) **samīkṣayan** (showing) **muhuḥ** (again and again) **citrīyate**; **yasya svarūpatāṁ** (likeness) **prekṣya** (seeing) **hanta** (ah!) **māmakaṁ** (My) **cetaḥ** (mind) **satyaṁ keli-kutūhalottaralitam** (greatly melted with eagerness, that is, longing, for play — the sports befitting the people of Vraja) **vraja-vadhū-sārūpyam** (a form like that of the daughter of Vṛṣabhānu) **anvicchati** (desires).

(Lalita-mādhava 8.34) —

অপরিকলিতপূর্ব্বঃ কশ্চমৎকারকারী
স্ফুরতু মম গরীয়ানেষ মাধুর্য্যপূরঃ ।
অয়মহমপি হন্ত প্রেক্ষ্য যং লুব্ধচেতাঃ
সরভসমুপভোক্তুং কাময়ে রাধিকেব ॥ ১৮২ ॥

aparikalita-pūrvaḥ kaś camatkāra-kārī
never experienced before some wonder-working
sphuratu mama garīyān eṣa mādhurya-pūraḥ
may it appear My greater this of sweetness flood
ayam aham api hanta prekṣya yaṁ lubdha-cetāḥ
this I even alas seeing which with greedy heart
sarabhasam upabhoktuṁ kāmaye rādhikeva
eagerly to enjoy I desire like Rādhikā

182 “May this wondrous flood of My sweetness, never known before and surpassing all, shine forth! Alas, seeing it, even I long with an eager heart to enjoy it, as Rādhikā does.” (Lalita-mādhava, 8.34)[18]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.146.

(b) The definition of the tad-ekātma-rūpa —

সেই বপু ভিন্নাভাসে কিছু ভিন্নাকার ।
ভাবাবেশাকৃতি-ভেদে ‘তদেকাত্ম’ নাম তাঁর ॥ ১৮৩ ॥

sei vapu bhinnābhāse kichu bhinnākāra
that same body in a different appearance somewhat different in shape
bhāvāveśākṛti-bhede ‘tad-ekātma’ nāma tāṁra
of absorption in bhāva of form by the difference tad-ekātma the name His

183 When that same body appears in another guise, somewhat different in shape, with a different *bhāva* absorbing it and different features, it is called *tad-ekātma*.

It is of two kinds: (1) vilāsa and (2) svāṁśa —

তদেকাত্মরূপে ‘বিলাস’, ‘স্বাংশ’, — দুই ভেদ ।
বিলাস, স্বাংশের ভেদে বিবিধ বিভেদ ॥ ১৮৪ ॥

tad-ekātma-rūpe ‘vilāsa’, ‘svāṁśa’, — dui bheda
in the tad-ekātma-rūpa vilāsa svāṁśa two divisions
vilāsa, svāṁśera bhede vividha vibheda
of vilāsa of svāṁśa by the divisions various varieties

184 The *tad-ekātma-rūpa* has two divisions, *vilāsa* and *svāṁśa*, and each of them has many varieties.

Anubhāṣya.
Vilāsa — see Ādi 1.77.

Svāṁśa. In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (*Pūrva-khaṇḍa* 17): “He who, being of the same kind, manifests less potency is called a *svāṁśa*: such are Saṅkarṣaṇa and the

others, Matsya and the others, each in His own abode." He who is nondifferent from the *svayaṁ-rūpa* but manifests less potency than the *vilāsa* is called a *svāṁśa*. Such are the *puruṣa-avatāras* — Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others, each abiding in His own abode — and the *līlā-avatāras* — Matsya and the others — the *manvantara-avatāras* and the *yuga-avatāras*.

The vilāsa is of two kinds: (a) prābhava and (b) vaibhava —

প্রাভব-বৈভব-ভেদে বিলাস — দ্বিধাকার ।
বিলাসের বিলাস-ভেদ — অনন্ত প্রকার ॥ ১৮৫ ॥

prābhava-vaibhava-bhede vilāsa — dvidhākāra
of prābhava of vaibhava by the difference vilāsa of two kinds
vilāsera vilāsa-bheda — ananta prakāra
of vilāsa of vilāsa the divisions infinite kinds

185 *Vilāsa* is of two kinds, *prābhava* and *vaibhava*, and *vilāsa* has its own *vilāsas* without number.

(a) The prābhava-vilāsa: the four forms of the original catur-vyūha in Mathurā and Dvārakā-purī —

প্রাভববিলাস — বাসুদেব, সঙ্কর্ষণ ।
প্রদ্যুম্ন, অনিরুদ্ধ, — মুখ্য চারিজন ॥ ১৮৬ ॥

prābhava-vilāsa — vāsudeva, saṅkarṣaṇa
prābhava-vilāsa Vāsudeva Saṅkarṣaṇa
pradyumna, aniruddha, — mukhya cāri-jana
Pradyumna Aniruddha the chief four

186 The *prābhava-vilāsas* are Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha — the chief four.

Of them, one form is Balarāma: in Vraja He thinks of Himself as a cowherd,

and in the city as a kṣatriya; this is why He is called a vilāsa —

ব্রজে গোপভাব রামের, পুরে ক্ষত্রিয়-ভাবন ।
বর্ণ-বেশ-ভেদ, তাতে 'বিলাস' তাঁর নাম ॥ ১৮৭ ॥

vraje gopa-bhāva rāmera, pure kṣatriya-bhāvana
in Vraja a cowherd's mood Rāma's in the city a kṣatriya's self-awareness
varṇa-veśa-bheda, tāte 'vilāsa' tāṁra nāma
of colour of dress the difference therefore vilāsa His name

187 In Vraja Rāma has the mood of a cowherd; in the city, the self-awareness of a kṣatriya. Because His colour and dress differ, He is called *vilāsa*.

One and the same Balarāma, in the form of the vaibhava-prakāśa and in the form of the prābhava-vilāsa (the original catur-vyūha), by the difference of the mood of a cowherd and of a kṣatriya —

বৈভবপ্রকাশে আর প্রাভববিলাসে ।
একই মূর্ত্ত্যে বলদেব ভাব-ভেদে ভাসে ॥ ১৮৮ ॥

vaibhava-prakāśe āra prābhava-vilāse
in the vaibhava-prakāśa and in the prābhava-vilāsa
eka-i mūrtye baladeva bhāva-bhede bhāse
in one and the same form Baladeva by difference of mood appears

188 In one and the same form Baladeva appears both as *vaibhava-prakāśa* and as *prābhava-vilāsa*, according to the difference of mood.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Baladeva is the *vaibhava-prakāśa* of Kṛṣṇa. He, differing in mood, is also manifest in the four *prābhava-vilāsas*, the original *catur-vyūha*: Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha.

The prābhava-vilāsa, the original catur-vyūha, is the cause of all the vaibhava-vilāsas, that is, of all the catur-vyūhas —

আদি-চতুর্ব্যূহ — কেহ নাহি ইঁহার সম ।
অনন্ত চতুর্ব্যূহগণের প্রাকট্য-কারণ ॥ ১৮৯ ॥

ādi-catur-vyūha — keha nāhi iṁhāra sama
the original catur-vyūha anyone not to Them equal
ananta catur-vyūha-gaṇera prākaṭya-kāraṇa
of countless catur-vyūhas of the appearance the cause

189 No one is equal to the original *catur-vyūha*; They are the cause of the appearance of countless *catur-vyūhas*.

Anubhāṣya.
The countless *catur-vyūhas* are not equal to the original one. The original *catur-vyūha* is the *prābhava-vilāsa*; the other *catur-vyūhas* are *vaibhava-vilāsa*. It is owing to the *prābhava-vilāsa* that the *vaibhava-vilāsas* become manifest.

They are the lords of the cities, the abodes of Mathurā and Dvārakā —

কৃষ্ণের এই চারি প্রাভববিলাস ।
দ্বারকা-মথুরা-পুরে নিত্য ইঁহার বাস ॥ ১৯০ ॥

kṛṣṇera ei cāri prābhava-vilāsa
Kṛṣṇa's these four prābhava-vilāsas
dvārakā-mathurā-pure nitya iṁhāra vāsa
in Dvārakā and Mathurā the cities eternally Their residence

190 These four are Kṛṣṇa's *prābhava-vilāsas*; They reside eternally in the cities of Dvārakā and Mathurā.

(2) From the original catur-vyūha come 24 forms, varied in name and weapons — the vaibhava-vilāsa —

এই চারি হৈতে চব্বিশ মূর্ত্তি পরকাশ ।
অস্ত্রভেদে নাম ভেদ — বৈভববিলাস ॥ ১৯১ ॥

ei cāri haite cabbiśa mūrti parakāśa
these four from twenty-four forms manifestation
astra-bhede nāma bheda — vaibhava-vilāsa
by the difference of weapons of names the difference vaibhava-vilāsa

191 From these four, twenty-four forms are manifest. Their names differ according to their weapons; They are the *vaibhava-vilāsas*.

(a) It is Kṛṣṇa Himself who, from the city, with the original catur-vyūha, abides in Vaikuṇṭha as a vilāsa form — in the form of Nārāyaṇa with the second catur-vyūha —

পুনঃ কৃষ্ণ চতুর্ব্যূহ লঞা পূর্ব্বরূপে ।
পরব্যোম-মধ্যে বৈসে নারায়ণরূপে ॥ ১৯২ ॥

punaḥ kṛṣṇa catur-vyūha lañā pūrva-rūpe
again Kṛṣṇa the catur-vyūha taking as before
paravyoma-madhye vaise nārāyaṇa-rūpe
in the paravyoma resides in the form of Nārāyaṇa

192 Again Kṛṣṇa, taking the *catur-vyūha* with Him as before, resides in the spiritual sky (*paravyoma*) in the form of Nārāyaṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

In the upper region of Paravyoma, within the three chambers of Goloka, in Mathurā- and Dvārakā-purī, Kṛṣṇa's *prābhava-vilāsa* eternally abides. In Gokula the *vaibhava-prakāśa* Baladeva eternally abides. From the four *prābhava-vilāsas*, by the difference of the weapons in the four hands of each, the *vaibhava-vilāsa* is manifest in twenty-four forms.

Below Goloka, the upper region, in Paravyoma Kṛṣṇa Himself, in a four-armed form, abides as Nārāyaṇa.

তাঁহা হৈতে পুনঃ চতুর্ব্যূহ-পরকাশ ।
আবরণরূপে চারিদিকে যাঁর বাস ॥ ১৯৩ ॥

tāṁhā haite punaḥ catur-vyūha-parakāśa
from Him again of a catur-vyūha the manifestation
āvaraṇa-rūpe cāri-dike yāṁra vāsa
as an enclosure on the four sides whose residence

193 From Him a *catur-vyūha* is manifest once more; They reside on the four sides as His enclosure (*āvaraṇa*).

Anubhāṣya.

From Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of Paravyoma, countless *catur-vyūhas* are again manifest all around as His surrounding circle (*āvaraṇa*).

(b) Each of the second catur-vyūha manifests in three forms — these are the 12 forms, the deities of the 12 months and of the 12 marks of tilaka —

চারিজনের পুনঃ পৃথক্ তিন তিন মূর্ত্তি ।
কেশবাদি যাহা হৈতে বিলাসের পূর্ত্তি ॥ ১৯৪ ॥

cāri-janera punaḥ pṛthak tina tina mūrti
of the four again separately three three forms
keśavādi yāhā haite vilāsera pūrti
Keśava and the others from whom of the vilāsas the completion

194 Again, each of the four has three separate forms — Keśava and the others — by whom the *vilāsas* are completed.

An introduction to these 12 forms of the vaibhava-vilāsa —

চক্রাদি-ধারণ-ভেদে নাম-ভেদ সব ।
বাসুদেবের মূর্ত্তি — কেশব, নারায়ণ, মাধব ॥ ১৯৫ ॥

cakrādi-dhāraṇa-bhede nāma-bheda saba
of the disc and the rest holding by the difference names differ all
vāsudevera mūrti — keśava, nārāyaṇa, mādhava
Vāsudeva's forms Keśava Nārāyaṇa Mādhava

195 All Their names differ according to how They hold the disc and the other weapons. Vāsudeva's forms are Keśava, Nārāyaṇa and Mādhava.

সঙ্কর্ষণের মূর্ত্তি — গোবিন্দ, বিষ্ণু, মধুসূদন ।
এ অন্য গোবিন্দ — নহে ব্রজেন্দ্র-নন্দন ॥ ১৯৬ ॥

saṅkarṣaṇera mūrti — govinda, viṣṇu, madhusūdana
Saṅkarṣaṇa's forms Govinda Viṣṇu Madhusūdana
e anya govinda — nahe vrajendra-nandana
this another Govinda is not the son of Vraja's king

196 Saṅkarṣaṇa's forms are Govinda, Viṣṇu and Madhusūdana. This is another Govinda, not the son of the king of Vraja.

প্রদ্যুম্নের মূর্ত্তি — ত্রিবিক্রম, বামন, শ্রীধর ।
অনিরুদ্ধের মূর্ত্তি — হৃষীকেশ, পদ্মনাভ, দামোদর ॥ ১৯৭ ॥

pradyumnera mūrti — trivikrama, vāmana, śrīdhara
Pradyumna's forms Trivikrama Vāmana Śrīdhara
aniruddhera mūrti — hṛṣīkeśa, padmanābha, dāmodara
Aniruddha's forms Hṛṣīkeśa Padmanābha Dāmodara

197 Pradyumna's forms are Trivikrama, Vāmana and Śrīdhara; Aniruddha's forms are Hṛṣīkeśa, Padmanābha and Dāmodara.

They are the 12 forms, the deities of the 12 months —

দ্বাদশ-মাসের দেবতা — এই বার জন ।
মার্গশীর্ষে — কেশব, পৌষে নারায়ণ ॥ ১৯৮ ॥

dvādaśa-māsera devatā — ei bāra jana
of the twelve months the Deities these twelve persons
mārgaśīrṣe — keśava, pauṣe nārāyaṇa
in Mārgaśīrṣa Keśava in Pauṣa Nārāyaṇa

198 These twelve are the Deities of the twelve months: in Mārgaśīrṣa, Keśava; in Pauṣa, Nārāyaṇa;

মাঘের দেবতা — মাধব, গোবিন্দ — ফাল্গুনে ।
চৈত্রে — বিষ্ণু বৈশাখে — শ্রীমধুসূদনে ॥ ১৯৯ ॥

māghera devatā — mādhava, govinda — phālgune
of Māgha the Deity Mādhava Govinda in Phālguna
caitre — viṣṇu vaiśākhe — śrī-madhusūdane
in Caitra Viṣṇu in Vaiśākha Śrī Madhusūdana

199 the Deity of Māgha is Mādhava, and of Phālguna, Govinda; in Caitra, Viṣṇu; in Vaiśākha, Śrī Madhusūdana;

জ্যৈষ্ঠে — ত্রিবিক্রম, আষাঢ়ে — বামন দেবেশ ।
শ্রাবণে — শ্রীধর, ভাদ্রে — দেব হৃষীকেশ ॥ ২০০ ॥

jyaiṣṭhe — trivikrama, āṣāḍhe — vāmana deveśa
in Jyaiṣṭha Trivikrama in Āṣāḍha Vāmana the Lord of the gods
śrāvaṇe — śrīdhara, bhādre — deva hṛṣīkeśa
in Śrāvaṇa Śrīdhara in Bhādra Lord Hṛṣīkeśa

200 in Jyaiṣṭha, Trivikrama; in Āṣāḍha, Vāmana, the Lord of the gods; in Śrāvaṇa, Śrīdhara; in Bhādra, Lord Hṛṣīkeśa;

আশ্বিনে — পদ্মনাভ, কার্ত্তিকে — দামোদর ।
'রাধা-দামোদর' অন্য ব্রজেন্দ্র-কোঙর ॥ ২০১ ॥

āśvine — padmanābha, kārtike — dāmodara
in Āśvina Padmanābha in Kārttika Dāmodara
'rādhā-dāmodara' anya vrajendra-koṅara
Rādhā-Dāmodara another the son of Vraja's king

201 in Āśvina, Padmanābha; in Kārttika, Dāmodara. Rādhā-Dāmodara, the son of the king of Vraja, is another.

And they again are the 12 forms, the deities of the 12 tilaka-mantras —

দ্বাদশ তিলক-মন্ত্র এই দ্বাদশ নাম ।
আচমনে এই নামে স্পর্শি তত্তৎস্থান ॥ ২০২ ॥

dvādaśa tilaka-mantra ei dvādaśa nāma
twelve tilaka mantras these twelve names
ācamane ei nāme sparśi tat-tat-sthāna
in ācamana with these names touching the respective places

202 These twelve names are the twelve mantras for *tilaka*; in *ācamana* one touches the respective places of the body with these names.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Ācamana — the touching of the mouth with water that is prescribed after the daily worship (*āhnika*).

Anubhāṣya.
The twelve names of Viṣṇu in the twelve *tilaka-mantras*: "On the forehead let him meditate on Keśava, on the abdomen on Nārāyaṇa, on the chest on Mādhava, in the

hollow of the throat on Govinda, on the right side of the belly on Viṣṇu, on the arm on Madhusūdana, on the neck on Trivikrama, on the left side on Vāmana, on the left arm on Śrīdhara, on the neck on Hṛṣīkeśa, on the back on Padmanābha, and on the waist let him place Dāmodara."

The Vaiṣṇava *ācamana* (*Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* 3.120): "With the three sips — Keśava, Nārāyaṇa and Mādhava; washing both hands — both Govinda and Viṣṇu; in wiping — Madhusūdana and then Trivikrama; wiping the lips — both Vāmana and Śrīdhara; washing the hands again — Hṛṣīkeśa, and washing the feet — Padmanābha; sprinkling the head — then Dāmodara; Vāsudeva on the mouth, Saṅkarṣaṇa and Pradyumna, both, on the nostrils; Aniruddha and Puruṣottama on the eyes; Adhokṣaja and Nṛsiṁha on the ears; Acyuta at the navel; Janārdana on the heart, then Upendra on the head; Hari on the right arm, Kṛṣṇa on the left, according to the rules. Let him perform *ācamana*, reciting [these names] in order in the dative case ending with *namaḥ*."

(c) Each of the second catur-vyūha manifests two forms — vilāsa forms: the eight vaibhava-vilāsas —

এই চারিজনের বিলাস-মূর্ত্তি আর অষ্ট জন ।
তাঁ-সবার নাম কহি, শুন, সনাতন ॥ ২০৩ ॥

ei cāri-janera vilāsa-mūrti āra aṣṭa jana
of these four the vilāsa-forms further eight persons
tāṁ-sabāra nāma kahi, śuna, sanātana
of Them all the names I tell hear Sanātana

203 These four have eight further *vilāsa* forms. I shall tell you all Their names; hear, Sanātana.

পুরুষোত্তম, অচ্যুত, নৃসিংহ, জনার্দ্দন ।
হরি, কৃষ্ণ, অধোক্ষজ, উপেন্দ্র, — অষ্টজন ॥ ২০৪ ॥

puruṣottama, acyuta, nṛsiṁha, janārdana
Puruṣottama Acyuta Nṛsiṁha Janārdana
hari, kṛṣṇa, adhokṣaja, upendra, — aṣṭa-jana
Hari Kṛṣṇa Adhokṣaja Upendra eight persons

204 Puruṣottama, Acyuta, Nṛsiṁha, Janārdana, Hari, Kṛṣṇa, Adhokṣaja and Upendra — these are the eight.

বাসুদেবের বিলাস দুই — অধোক্ষজ, পুরুষোত্তম ।
সঙ্কর্ষণের বিলাস — উপেন্দ্র, অচ্যুত, দুইজন ॥ ২০৫ ॥

vāsudevera vilāsa dui — adhokṣaja, puruṣottama
Vāsudeva's vilāsas two Adhokṣaja Puruṣottama
saṅkarṣaṇera vilāsa — upendra, acyuta, dui-jana
Saṅkarṣaṇa's vilāsas Upendra Acyuta the two

205 Vāsudeva's two *vilāsas* are Adhokṣaja and Puruṣottama, and Saṅkarṣaṇa's are Upendra and Acyuta.

প্রদ্যুম্নের বিলাস — নৃসিংহ, জনার্দ্দন ।
অনিরুদ্ধের বিলাস — হরি, কৃষ্ণ দুইজন ॥ ২০৬ ॥

pradyumnera vilāsa — nṛsiṁha, janārdana
Pradyumna's vilāsas Nṛsiṁha Janārdana
aniruddhera vilāsa — hari, kṛṣṇa dui-jana
Aniruddha's vilāsas Hari Kṛṣṇa the two

206 Pradyumna's *vilāsas* are Nṛsiṁha and Janārdana, and Aniruddha's are Hari and Kṛṣṇa.

The vilāsa of the prābhava-vilāsa — of the original catur-vyūha itself — is the vaibhava-vilāsa; by the difference of weapons, a variety of names —

এই চব্বিশ মূর্ত্তি — বৈভব-বিলাস প্রধান ।
অস্ত্রধারণ-ভেদে ধরে ভিন্ন ভিন্ন নাম ॥ ২০৭ ॥

ei cabbiśa mūrti — vaibhava-vilāsa pradhāna
these twenty-four forms vaibhava-vilāsas the chief
astra-dhāraṇa-bhede dhare bhinna bhinna nāma
of weapons holding by the difference bear different different names

207 These twenty-four forms are the chief *vaibhava-vilāsas*. According to how They hold Their weapons, They bear different names.

By the difference of dress and shape, again a variety of their vilāsa and vaibhava —

ইঁহার মধ্যে যাঁহার হয় আকার-বেশ-ভেদ ।
সেই সেই হয় বিলাস-বৈভব-বিভেদ ॥ ২০৮ ॥

iṁhāra madhye yānṁhāra haya ākāra-veśa-bheda
of Them among of whom there is of shape of dress a difference
sei sei haya vilāsa-vaibhava-vibheda
those those are of vilāsa of vaibhava varieties

208 Those among Them who differ in shape and dress are varieties of *vilāsa* and *vaibhava*.

The forms of Viṣṇu that differ in shape —

পদ্মনাভ, ত্রিবিক্রম, নৃসিংহ, বামন ।
হরি, কৃষ্ণ আদি হয় 'আকারে' বিলক্ষণ ॥ ২০৯ ॥

padmanābha, trivikrama, nṛsiṁha, vāmana
Padmanābha Trivikrama Nṛsiṁha Vāmana
hari, kṛṣṇa ādi haya 'ākāre' vilakṣaṇa
Hari Kṛṣṇa and others are in shape distinctive

209 Padmanābha, Trivikrama, Nṛsiṁha, Vāmana, Hari, Kṛṣṇa and others are distinctive in shape.

Apart from the second catur-vyūha, the remaining 20 forms are vilāsa forms —

কৃষ্ণের প্রাভববিলাস — বাসুদেবাদি চারি জন ।
সেই চারিজনার বিলাস — বিংশতি গণন ॥ ২১০ ॥

kṛṣṇera prābhava-vilāsa — vāsudevādi cāri jana
Kṛṣṇa's prābhava-vilāsa Vāsudeva and the others four persons
sei cāri-janāra vilāsa — viṁśati gaṇana
of those four the vilāsas twenty in number

210 Kṛṣṇa's *prābhava-vilāsas* are the four, Vāsudeva and the others, and Their *vilāsas* number twenty.

In each of the eight directions, three forms: these 24 forms abide eternally in Vaikuṇṭha, each in His own abode —

ইঁহা-সবার পৃথক্ বৈকুণ্ঠ — পরব্যোম-ধামে ।
পূর্ব্বাদি অষ্টদিকে তিন তিন ক্রমে ॥ ২১১ ॥

iṁhā-sabāra pṛthak vaikuṇṭha — paravyoma-dhāme
of Them all separate Vaikuṇṭhas in the abode of the paravyoma
pūrvādi aṣṭa-dike tina tina krame
from the east onward in the eight directions three three in order

211 Each of Them has His own Vaikuṇṭha in the spiritual sky, three in each of the eight directions, in order, beginning with the east.

The presence of some tad-ekātma-rūpas, with their abodes, within the universe —

যদ্যপি পরব্যোম সবাকার নিত্যধাম ।
তথাপি ব্রহ্মাণ্ডে কারো কাঁহো সন্নিধান ॥ ২১২ ॥

yadyapi paravyoma sabākāra nitya-dhāma
although the paravyoma of all the eternal abode
tathāpi brahmāṇḍe kāro kāṁho sannidhāna
still in the universe of some somewhere the presence

212 Although the spiritual sky is the eternal abode of all of Them, some of Them are also present in places within the universe.

In Vaikuṇṭha, Nārāyaṇa surrounded by the second catur-vyūha; above it, in Goloka, that is, in the city, the son of Devakī surrounded by the original catur-

vyūha, and in Gokula the son of Yaśodā —

পরব্যোম-মধ্যে নারায়ণের নিত্য-স্থিতি ।
পরব্যোম-উপরি কৃষ্ণলোকের বিভূতি ॥ ২১৩ ॥

paravyoma-madhye nārāyaṇera nitya-sthiti
in the paravyoma Nārāyaṇa's eternal residence
paravyoma-upari kṛṣṇalokera vibhūti
above the paravyoma of Kṛṣṇaloka the splendour

213 Within the spiritual sky Nārāyaṇa eternally resides; above the spiritual sky is the splendour of Kṛṣṇaloka.

In Goloka there are three chambers —

এক 'কৃষ্ণলোক' হয় ত্রিবিধপ্রকার ।
গোকুলাখ্য, মথুরাখ্য, দ্বারকাখ্য আর ॥ ২১৪ ॥

eka 'kṛṣṇaloka' haya trividha-prakāra
one Kṛṣṇaloka is of three kinds
gokulākhya, mathurākhya, dvārakākhya āra
called Gokula called Mathurā called Dvārakā and

214 The one Kṛṣṇaloka is of three kinds: Gokula, Mathurā and Dvārakā.

In the universe these 24 forms abide in 24 different places, each with His own abode —

মথুরাতে কেশবের নিত্য সন্নিধান ।
নীলাচলে পুরুষোত্তম — 'জগন্নাথ' নাম ॥ ২১৫ ॥

mathurāte keśavera nitya sannidhāna
in Mathurā Keśava's eternal presence
nīlācale puruṣottama — 'jagannātha' nāma
in Nīlācala Puruṣottama Jagannātha by name

215 Keśava is eternally present in Mathurā; in Nīlācala it is Puruṣottama, named Jagannātha.

প্রয়াগে মাধব, মন্দারে শ্রীমধুসূদন ।
আনন্দারণ্যে বাসুদেব, পদ্মনাভ, জনার্দ্দন ॥ ২১৬ ॥

prayāge mādhava, mandāre śrī-madhusūdana
at Prayāga Mādhava at Mandāra Śrī Madhusūdana
ānandāraṇye vāsudeva, padmanābha, janārdana
at Ānandāraṇya Vāsudeva Padmanābha Janārdana

216 At Prayāga He is Mādhava; at Mandāra, Śrī Madhusūdana; at Ānandāraṇya, Vāsudeva, Padmanābha and Janārdana.

বিষ্ণুকাঞ্চীতে বিষ্ণু, হরি রহে মায়াপুরে ।
ঐছে আর নানা মূর্ত্তি ব্রহ্মাণ্ড-ভিতরে ॥ ২১৭ ॥

viṣṇu-kāñcīte viṣṇu, hari rahe māyāpure
at Viṣṇu-kāñcī Viṣṇu Hari stays at Māyāpura
aiche āra nānā mūrti brahmāṇḍa-bhitare
thus also various forms within the universe

217 At Viṣṇu-kāñcī He is Viṣṇu, and Hari stays at Māyāpura. In the same way there are various other forms within the universe.

Anubhāṣya.
Within the universe Bhagavān abides as *arcā-mūrtis* (Deities) in various forms: in Mathurā as "Keśava," in Nīlācala as "Puruṣottama Jagannātha," in Prayāga as "Bindu-mādhava," in Mandāra as "Madhusūdana," in the south, in the land of Kerala, in Ānandāraṇya as "Vāsudeva," "Padmanābha" and "Janārdana," in Viṣṇu-kāñcī as "Varadarāja Viṣṇu," in Māyāpura as "Hari," and in other places as well.

For the joy of the devotees, the establishment of dharma and the destruction of adharma — that is, for vilāsa, or pastimes — they appear in the universe —

এইমত ব্রহ্মাণ্ড মধ্যে সবার 'পরকাশ' ।
সপ্তদ্বীপে নবখণ্ডে যাঁহার বিলাস ॥ ২১৮ ॥

ei-mata brahmāṇḍa madhye sabāra 'parakāśa'
in this way the universe within of all the manifestation
sapta-dvīpe nava-khaṇḍe yāṁhāra vilāsa
in the seven dvīpas in the nine khaṇḍas whose pastimes

218 In this way all of Them are manifest within the universe, and Their pastimes take place in the seven *dvīpas* and the nine *khaṇḍas*.

Anubhāṣya.

The *sapta-dvīpa* (the seven *dvīpas*). In the *Siddhānta-śiromaṇi* (in the *Golādhyāya*, in the section in praise of the sphere): "The best of ācāryas call Jambudvīpa that half of the earth which lies north of the ocean of milk. In the other half, to the south, lie six *dvīpas* and the oceans of salt, milk and the rest. Śāka, then Śālmala, Kuśa, Krauñca, Gomedaka and Puṣkara: each of them, lying between two oceans, is called a *dvīpa*." (1) Jambu, (2) Śāka, (3) Śālmalī, (4) Kuśa, (5) Krauñca, (6) Gomeda, or Plakṣa, and (7) Puṣkara — these are the seven *dvīpas*.

The *nava-khaṇḍa* (the nine *khaṇḍas*): (1) Bhārata, (2) Kinnara (Kimpuruṣa), (3) Hari, (4) Kuru, (5) Hiraṇmaya, (6) Ramyaka (Ramaṇaka), (7) Ilāvṛta, (8) Bhadrāśva, (9) Ketumāla — these are the nine *khaṇḍas*, or *varṣas* (the nine parts of Jambudvīpa). The region between two mountain ranges is called a *khaṇḍa*, or *varṣa* — see the *Bhuvana-kośa* in the *Golādhyāya*.

সর্ব্বত্র প্রকাশ তাঁর — ভক্তে সুখ দিতে ।
জগতের অধর্ম্ম নাশি' ধর্ম্ম স্থাপিতে ॥ ২১৯ ॥

sarvatra prakāśa tāṁra — bhakte sukha dite
everywhere the manifestation His to the devotees joy to give
jagatera adharma nāśi' dharma sthāpite
of the world the irreligion destroying religion to establish

219 He is manifest everywhere to give joy to His devotees, to destroy the irreligion of the world and to establish dharma.

Some of them descend into the world —

ইঁহার মধ্যে কারো হয় 'অবতারে' গণন ।
যৈছে বিষ্ণু, ত্রিবিক্রম, নৃসিংহ, বামন ॥ ২২০ ॥

iṁhāra madhye kāro haya 'avatāre' gaṇana
of Them among of some there is among the avatāras the counting
yaiche viṣṇu, trivikrama, nṛsiṁha, vāmana
like Viṣṇu Trivikrama Nṛsiṁha Vāmana

220 Some of Them are counted among the avatāras, such as Viṣṇu, Trivikrama, Nṛsiṁha and Vāmana.

The names differ according to the weapons —

অস্ত্রধৃতি-ভেদ — নাম-ভেদের কারণ ।
চক্রাদি-ধারণ-ভেদ শুন, সনাতন ॥ ২২১ ॥

astra-dhṛti-bheda — nāma-bhedera kāraṇa
of weapons holding the difference of the difference of names the cause
cakrādi-dhāraṇa-bheda śuna, sanātana
of the disc and the rest holding the differences hear Sanātana

221 The different ways of holding the weapons are the cause of the different names. Hear, Sanātana, how differently They hold the disc and the rest.

দক্ষিণাধো হস্ত হৈতে বামাধঃ পর্য্যন্ত ।
চক্রাদি অস্ত্রধারণ-গণনার অন্ত ॥ ২২২ ॥

dakṣiṇādho hasta haite vāmādhaḥ paryanta
from the lower right hand starting the lower left up to
cakrādi astra-dhāraṇa-gaṇanāra anta
of the disc and the rest of weapons holding of the counting the end

222 The count of how They hold the disc and the other weapons begins with the lower right hand and ends with the lower left.

Anubhāṣya.
The four kinds of weapons are listed in order: in the lower right hand of the four-armed Viṣṇu, in the upper right, in the upper left and in the lower left.

The 24 forms named in the Siddhārtha-saṁhitā —

সিদ্ধার্থ সংহিতা করে চব্বিশ মূর্ত্তি গণন ।
তাঁর মতে আগে কহি চক্রাদি ধারণ ॥ ২২৩ ॥

siddhārtha saṁhitā kare cabbiśa mūrti gaṇana
the Siddhārtha Saṁhitā makes of twenty-four forms the enumeration
tāṁra mate āge kahi cakrādi dhāraṇa
its in the view first I tell of the disc and the rest the holding

223 The *Siddhārtha-saṁhitā* enumerates twenty-four forms. First I shall tell, according to it, how They hold the disc and the rest.

Anubhāṣya.

The twenty-four forms: 1) Vāsudeva, 2) Saṅkarṣaṇa, 3) Pradyumna, 4) Aniruddha, 5) Keśava, 6) Nārāyaṇa, 7) Mādhava, 8) Govinda, 9) Viṣṇu, 10) Madhusūdana, 11) Trivikrama, 12) Vāmana, 13) Śrīdhara, 14) Hṛṣīkeśa, 15) Padmanābha, 16) Dāmodara, 17) Puruṣottama, 18) Acyuta, 19) Nṛsiṁha, 20) Janārdana, 21) Hari, 22) Kṛṣṇa, 23) Adhokṣaja and 24) Upendra.

The difference in the weapons of the second catur-vyūha in Paravyoma —

বাসুদেব — গদাশঙ্খচক্রপদ্মধর ।
সঙ্কর্ষণ — গদাশঙ্খপদ্মচক্রকর ॥ ২২৪ ॥

vāsudeva — gadā-śaṅkha-cakra-padma-dhara
Vāsudeva mace conch disc lotus holding
saṅkarṣaṇa — gadā-śaṅkha-padma-cakra-kara
Saṅkarṣaṇa mace conch lotus disc in His hands

224 Vāsudeva holds the mace, conch, disc and lotus; Saṅkarṣaṇa, the mace, conch, lotus and disc.

প্রদ্যুম্ন — চক্রশঙ্খগদাপদ্মধর ।
অনিরুদ্ধ — চক্রগদাশঙ্খপদ্মকর ॥ ২২৫ ॥

pradyumna — cakra-śaṅkha-gadā-padma-dhara
Pradyumna disc conch mace lotus holding
aniruddha — cakra-gadā-śaṅkha-padma-kara
Aniruddha disc mace conch lotus in His hands

225 Pradyumna holds the disc, conch, mace and lotus; Aniruddha, the disc, mace, conch and lotus.

পরব্যোমে বাসুদেবাদি — নিজ নিজ অস্ত্রধর ।
তাঁর মত কহি যে-সব অস্ত্রকর ॥ ২২৬ ॥

paravyome vāsudevādi — nija nija astra-dhara
in the paravyoma Vāsudeva and the others own own weapons holding
tāṁra mata kahi ye-saba astra-kara
its view I tell which weapons in hand

226 In the spiritual sky Vāsudeva and the others each hold Their own weapons; following that scripture, I shall tell which weapons each of Them holds.

A description of the differences in the weapons of the remaining 20 forms in Paravyoma —

শ্রীকেশব — পদ্মশঙ্খচক্রগদাধর ।
নারায়ণ — শঙ্খপদ্মগদাচক্রধর ॥ ২২৭ ॥

śrī-keśava — padma-śaṅkha-cakra-gadā-dhara
Śrī Keśava lotus conch disc mace holding
nārāyaṇa — śaṅkha-padma-gadā-cakra-dhara
Nārāyaṇa conch lotus mace disc holding

227 Śrī Keśava holds the lotus, conch, disc and mace; Nārāyaṇa, the conch, lotus, mace and disc.

শ্রীমাধব — গদাচক্রশঙ্খপদ্মকর ।
শ্রীগোবিন্দ — চক্রগদাপদ্মশঙ্খধর ॥ ২২৮ ॥

śrī-mādhava — gadā-cakra-śaṅkha-padma-kara
Śrī Mādhava mace disc conch lotus in His hands
śrī-govinda — cakra-gadā-padma-śaṅkha-dhara
Śrī Govinda disc mace lotus conch holding

228 Śrī Mādhava holds the mace, disc, conch and lotus; Śrī Govinda, the disc, mace, lotus and conch.

বিষ্ণুমূর্ত্তি — গদাপদ্মশঙ্খচক্রকর ।
মধুসূদন — চক্রশঙ্খপদ্মগদাধর ॥ ২২৯ ॥

viṣṇu-mūrti — gadā-padma-śaṅkha-cakra-kara
the form of Viṣṇu mace lotus conch disc in His hands
madhusūdana — cakra-śaṅkha-padma-gadā-dhara
Madhusūdana disc conch lotus mace holding

229 The form of Viṣṇu holds the mace, lotus, conch and disc; Madhusūdana, the disc, conch, lotus and mace.

ত্রিবিক্রম — পদ্মগদাচক্রশঙ্খকর ।
শ্রীবামন — শঙ্খচক্রগদাপদ্মধর ॥ ২৩০ ॥

trivikrama — padma-gadā-cakra-śaṅkha-kara
Trivikrama lotus mace disc conch in His hands
śrī-vāmana — śaṅkha-cakra-gadā-padma-dhara
Śrī Vāmana conch disc mace lotus holding

230 Trivikrama holds the lotus, mace, disc and conch; Śrī Vāmana, the conch, disc, mace and lotus.

শ্রীধর — পদ্মচক্রগদাশঙ্খকর ।
হৃষীকেশ — গদাচক্রপদ্মশঙ্খধর ॥ ২৩১ ॥

śrīdhara — padma-cakra-gadā-śaṅkha-kara
Śrīdhara lotus disc mace conch in His hands
hṛṣīkeśa — gadā-cakra-padma-śaṅkha-dhara
Hṛṣīkeśa mace disc lotus conch holding

231 Śrīdhara holds the lotus, disc, mace and conch; Hṛṣīkeśa, the mace, disc, lotus and conch.

পদ্মনাভ — শঙ্খপদ্মচক্রগদাকর ।
দামোদর — পদ্মচক্রগদাশঙ্খধর ॥ ২৩২ ॥

padmanābha — śaṅkha-padma-cakra-gadā-kara
Padmanābha conch lotus disc mace in His hands
dāmodara — padma-cakra-gadā-śaṅkha-dhara
Dāmodara lotus disc mace conch holding

232 Padmanābha holds the conch, lotus, disc and mace; Dāmodara, the lotus, disc, mace and conch.

পুরুষোত্তম — চক্রপদ্মশঙ্খগদাধর ।
শ্রীঅচ্যুত — গদাপদ্মচক্রশঙ্খধর ॥ ২৩৩ ॥

puruṣottama — cakra-padma-śaṅkha-gadā-dhara
Puruṣottama disc lotus conch mace holding
śrī-acyuta — gadā-padma-cakra-śaṅkha-dhara
Śrī Acyuta mace lotus disc conch holding

233 Puruṣottama holds the disc, lotus, conch and mace; Śrī Acyuta, the mace, lotus, disc and conch.

শ্রীনৃসিংহ — চক্রপদ্মগদাশঙ্খধর ।
জনার্দ্দন — পদ্মচক্রশঙ্খগদাকর ॥ ২৩৪ ॥

śrī-nṛsiṁha — cakra-padma-gadā-śaṅkha-dhara
Śrī Nṛsiṁha disc lotus mace conch holding
janārdana — padma-cakra-śaṅkha-gadā-kara
Janārdana lotus disc conch mace in His hands

234 Śrī Nṛsiṁha holds the disc, lotus, mace and conch; Janārdana, the lotus, disc, conch and mace.

শ্রীহরি — শঙ্খচক্রপদ্মগদাকর ।
শ্রীকৃষ্ণ — শঙ্খগদাপদ্মচক্রকর ॥ ২৩৫ ॥

śrī-hari — śaṅkha-cakra-padma-gadā-kara
Śrī Hari conch disc lotus mace in His hands
śrī-kṛṣṇa — śaṅkha-gadā-padma-cakra-kara
Śrī Kṛṣṇa conch mace lotus disc in His hands

235 Śrī Hari holds the conch, disc, lotus and mace; Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the conch, mace, lotus and disc.

অধোক্ষজ — পদ্মগদাশঙ্খচক্রকর ।
উপেন্দ্র — শঙ্খগদাচক্রপদ্মকর ॥ ২৩৬ ॥

adhokṣaja — padma-gadā-śaṅkha-cakra-kara
Adhokṣaja lotus mace conch disc in His hands
upendra — śaṅkha-gadā-cakra-padma-kara
Upendra conch mace disc lotus in His hands

236 Adhokṣaja holds the lotus, mace, conch and disc; Upendra, the conch, mace, disc and lotus.

Anubhāṣya.
In the *Siddhārtha-saṁhitā* (*Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* 5.176–177): “Vāsudeva is held to bear the mace, conch, disc and lotus. Keśava carries the lotus, the conch, and also the disc and mace. Nārāyaṇa always holds the conch, lotus, mace and disc. Mādhava carries the mace, the disc, and also the conch and lotus. Puruṣottama — the disc, the lotus, and also the conch and mace. Adhokṣaja holds the lotus, Kaumodakī, the conch and the disc. Saṅkarṣaṇa is known as the bearer of the mace, conch, lotus and disc. Govinda holds in His hands the disc, mace, lotus and conch. Viṣṇu bears the mace, the lotus, and also the conch and disc. Madhusūdana — the disc, the conch, and also the lotus and mace. Acyuta always holds the mace, lotus, disc and conch. Upendra carries the conch, Kaumodakī, the disc and the lotus. Pradyumna is called the bearer of the disc, conch, mace and lotus. Trivikrama holds the lotus, Kaumodakī, the disc and the conch. Vāmana always carries the conch, disc, mace and lotus. Śrīdhara carries in His hands the lotus, disc, mace and conch. Narasiṁha bears the disc, lotus, mace and conch. Janārdana holds the lotus, Sudarśana, the conch and the mace. In the hands of Aniruddha shine the disc,

mace, conch and lotus. Hṛṣīkeśa holds the mace, disc, lotus and conch. Padmanābha carries the conch, the lotus, and also the disc and mace. Dāmodara always holds the lotus, disc, mace and conch. Hari carries the conch, disc, lotus and mace. Kṛṣṇa bears the conch, Kaumodakī, the lotus and the disc. These forms are to be understood by the order of the hands, beginning with the lower right."

The differences in the weapons of the 16 forms named in the Hayaśīrṣa-pañcarātra —

হয়শীর্ষ পঞ্চরাত্রে কহে ষোলজন ।
তাঁর মতে কহি এবে চক্রাদি-ধারণ ॥ ২৩৭ ॥

hayaśīrṣa pañcarātre kahe ṣola-jana
in the Hayaśīrṣa Pañcarātra speaks of sixteen persons
tāṁra mate kahi ebe cakrādi-dhāraṇa
its in the view I tell now of the disc and the rest the holding

237 The *Hayaśīrṣa Pañcarātra* speaks of sixteen forms. Now I shall tell, according to it, how They hold the disc and the rest.

Anubhāṣya.
The sixteen: 1) Vāsudeva, 2) Saṅkarṣaṇa, 3) Pradyumna, 4) Aniruddha, 5) Keśava, 6) Nārāyaṇa, 7) Mādhava, 8) Govinda, 9) Viṣṇu, 10) Madhusūdana, 11) Trivikrama, 12) Vāmana, 13) Śrīdhara, 14) Hṛṣīkeśa, 15) Padmanābha and 16) Dāmodara.

কেশব-ভেদে পদ্মশঙ্খগদাচক্রধর ।
মাধব-ভেদে চক্রগদাশঙ্খপদ্মকর ॥ ২৩৮ ॥

keśava-bhede padma-śaṅkha-gadā-cakra-dhara
in the form of Keśava lotus conch mace disc holding
mādhava-bhede cakra-gadā-śaṅkha-padma-kara
in the form of Mādhava disc mace conch lotus in His hands

238 There Keśava holds the lotus, conch, mace and disc, and Mādhava the disc, mace, conch and lotus.

নারায়ণ-ভেদে নানা অস্ত্র-ভেদ-ধর ।
ইত্যাদিক ভেদ এই সব অস্ত্রকর ॥ ২৩৯ ॥

nārāyaṇa-bhede nānā astra-bheda-dhara
in the form of Nārāyaṇa various weapons in different order holding
ityādika bheda ei saba astra-kara
such differences these all weapons in hand

239 Nārāyaṇa and the others hold Their weapons in various other ways; such are the differences in the weapons They hold.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Hayaśīrṣa-pañcarātra* (*Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* 5.168–175): "The original form is Vāsudeva; then He brought forth Saṅkarṣaṇa… The fourfold form is called the highest; each form divides threefold, and by the division into Keśava and the others the forms are said to be twelve. He who has the lotus on the right, and above it the Pāñcajanya, the mace at the upper left and the disc below — this form of the original form is called Keśava. And where the same is done with lower and upper reversed, that form is named Nārāyaṇa; once installed, He grants enjoyment and liberation. He who has the lotus at the lower left and above it the Pāñcajanya, the mace at the upper right and the disc below — this form of the original form is called Mādhava. He who has the disc at the lower right, the mace above it, the lotus at the upper left and the conch below — this form of Saṅkarṣaṇa is called Govinda. The lotus at the upper right and the mace below: this form of Saṅkarṣaṇa is called Viṣṇu. At the upper right the conch, and below is seen the disc; at the upper left the lotus, and below is seen the mace: this form of Saṅkarṣaṇa bears the name Madhusūdana. At the upper left the disc, and below is seen the conch; the left foot reaches the limits of the universe, the right rests on the back of Śeṣa; the form is connected with the deceiving of Bali, and Vāmana stands below.[34] He who has Kaumodakī at the upper left, the lotus below, the thousand-spoked disc at the upper right and the Pāñcajanya below is Vāmana; He should always be made seven *tālas* in height. Above on the right the disc, below the lotus; at His left side stands Padmā with a lotus in her hand; standing or seated, full of love and playful — this form of Pradyumna is called Śrīdhara. At the upper right the great disc, below it Kaumodakī, at the upper left the lotus, and below shines the conch: know Him to be Hṛṣīkeśa; once installed, He fulfils all desires. At the upper right the lotus and below the Pāñcajanya; at the upper left the disc, below it Kaumodakī: this form is

called Padmanābha; once installed, He grants liberation. At the upper right Kaumodakī, and below the king of weapons (the disc): this form of Aniruddha is known as Dāmodara. Beside them two auspicious consorts should be made, holding a lotus and a *vīṇā*." Thus, in order, the twelve — Keśava and the others — are the lords of the months, beginning with Mārgaśīrṣa.

The two names of the son of the King of Vraja —

'স্বয়ং ভগবান্', আর 'লীলা-পুরুষোত্তম' ।
এই দুই নাম ধরে ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ॥ ২৪০ ॥

'svayaṁ bhagavān', āra 'līlā-puruṣottama'
Svayaṁ Bhagavān and Līlā-puruṣottama
ei dui nāma dhare vrajendra-nandana
these two names bears the son of Vraja's king

240 The son of the king of Vraja bears these two names: 'Svayaṁ Bhagavān' and 'Līlā-puruṣottama.'

The nava-vyūha — the surrounding circle (āvaraṇa) of Mathurā and Dvārakā —

পুরীর আবরণরূপে পুরীর নবদেশে ।
নবব্যূহরূপে নবমূর্ত্তি পরকাশে ॥ ২৪১ ॥

purīra āvaraṇa-rūpe purīra nava-deśe
of the city as the enclosure of the city in nine places
nava-vyūha-rūpe nava-mūrti parakāśe
as the nava-vyūha nine forms are manifest

241 Nine forms, the *nava-vyūha*, are manifest in nine places around the city as its enclosure (*āvaraṇa*).

Anubhāṣya.

It should be noted here that although Varāha and Hayagrīva, who belong to this *nava-vyūha*, are avatāras "in the state of *vaibhava*" (*vaibhavāvastha*), they are equal to those in the state of *para* (*parāvastha*).

An introduction to the nava-vyūha — (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Pūrva-khaṇḍa, the account of the nava-vyūha: Śrī Rūpa's words) —

চত্বারো বাসুদেবাদ্যা নারায়ণনৃসিংহকৌ ৷
হয়গ্রীবো বরাহশ্চ ব্রহ্মা চেতি নবোদিতাঃ ॥ ২৪২ ॥

catvāro vāsudevādyā
the four Vāsudeva and the others
nārāyaṇa-nṛsiṁhakau
Nārāyaṇa and Nṛsiṁha
hayagrīvo varāhaś ca
Hayagrīva Varāha and
brahmā ceti navoditāḥ
Brahmā and thus nine are declared

242 "The four — Vāsudeva and the others — Nārāyaṇa and Nṛsiṁha, Hayagrīva, Varāha and Brahmā: these are declared to be the nine." (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 1.451)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The four — Vāsudeva and the others — and Nārāyaṇa, Nṛsiṁha, Hayagrīva, Varāha and Brahmā: these are the nine.

Anubhāṣya.
vāsudevādyāḥ (Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha) **catvāraḥ** (the second *vyūha*), **nārāyaṇa-nṛsiṁhakau** (the two, Nārāyaṇa and Nṛsiṁha), **hayagrīvaḥ**, **varāhaḥ ca**, **brahmā ca iti nava** (nine forms, *vyūhas*) **uditāḥ** (are named: "By Brahmā here Hari is to be understood, by the rule stated before." By the rule stated in the words of the *Padma Purāṇa*,[35] "In some great *kalpa* even a jīva becomes Brahmā by his worship; and somewhere here Mahā-Viṣṇu takes the position of Brahmā," Brahmā here is to be understood as belonging to the category of the Lord).

So far the vilāsas of the two kinds of prakāśa — prābhava and vaibhava — which belong to the six kinds of vilāsa of Kṛṣṇa's form, have been described;

now the avatāras of two kinds, svāṁśa and śaktyāveśa, will be described —

প্রকাশ-বিলাসের এই কৈলুঁ বিবরণ ।
স্বাংশের ভেদ এবে শুন, সনাতন ॥ ২৪৩ ॥

prakāśa-vilāsera ei kailuṁ vivaraṇa
of prakāśa and vilāsa this I have made the description
svāṁśera bheda ebe śuna, sanātana
of the svāṁśa the divisions now hear Sanātana

243 Thus I have described the *prakāśas* and *vilāsas*. Now hear, Sanātana, the divisions of the *svāṁśa*.

The svāṁśa is chiefly of two kinds: (1) He who presides over prakṛti and moves it, and (2) the many avatāras who protect the saintly and destroy the wicked —

সঙ্কর্ষণ, মৎস্যাদিক, — দুই ভেদ তাঁর ।
সঙ্কর্ষণ — পুরুষাবতার, মৎস্যাদি লীলাবতার ॥ ২৪৪ ॥

saṅkarṣaṇa, matsyādika, — dui bheda tāṁra
Saṅkarṣaṇa Matsya and the rest two divisions its
saṅkarṣaṇa — puruṣāvatāra, matsyādi līlāvatāra
Saṅkarṣaṇa the puruṣa-avatāra Matsya and the rest the līlā-avatāras

244 It has two divisions: Saṅkarṣaṇa, and Matsya and the rest. Saṅkarṣaṇa is the *puruṣa-avatāra*; Matsya and the rest are the *līlā-avatāras*.

The six kinds of avatāras —

অবতার হয় কৃষ্ণের ষড়্বিধ প্রকার ।
পুরুষাবতার এক, লীলাবতার আর ॥ ২৪৫ ॥

avatāra haya kṛṣṇera ṣaḍ-vidha prakāra
the avatāras are of Kṛṣṇa of six kinds
puruṣāvatāra eka, līlāvatāra āra
the puruṣa-avatāras one the līlā-avatāras another

245 Kṛṣṇa's avatāras are of six kinds: the *puruṣa-avatāras*, the *līlā-avatāras*,

Anubhāṣya.

The *puruṣa-avatāras*: from Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa come Kāraṇodakaśāyī (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.4.3), Garbhodakaśāyī (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.2–3) and Kṣīrodakaśāyī (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.18.21, 2.2.8, 2.8.16, 10.88.5) — these three forms.

The *līlā-avatāras* (see *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 1, Chapter 3): 1) the Catuḥsana, 2) Nārada, 3) Varāha, 4) Matsya, 5) Yajña, 6) Nara-Nārāyaṇa, 7) Kapila, the son of Kardama, 8) Datta (the son of Atri — *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.7.4), 9) Hayaśīrṣa (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.7.11), 10) Haṁsa (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.7.19), 11) Dhruvapriya, or Pṛśnigarbha (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.7.8), 12) Ṛṣabha, 13) Pṛthu, 14) Nṛsiṁha, 15) Kūrma, 16) Dhanvantari, 17) Mohinī, 18) Vāmana, 19) Bhārgava Paraśurāma, 20) Rāghavendra, 21) Vyāsa, 22) Balarāma, the enemy of Pralamba, 23) Kṛṣṇa, 24) Buddha, 25) Kalki. These 25 forms are the *līlā-avatāras*. They appear in almost every *kalpa* (one day of Brahmā is called a *kalpa*), and so they are also called *kalpa-avatāras*. Of them, Haṁsa and Mohinī are avatāras in the state of *prābhava* who remain only briefly and are not very well known. Kapila, Dattātreya, Ṛṣabha, Dhanvantari and Vyāsa — these five forms are also avatāras in the state of *prābhava*: they remain long, their fame is wide, and they act as sages (*munis*). And Kūrma, Matsya, Nārāyaṇa, Varāha, Hayagrīva, Pṛśnigarbha and Baladeva, the slayer of Pralamba, are avatāras in the state of *vaibhava*.

গুণাবতার, আর মন্বন্তরাবতার ।
যুগাবতার, আর শক্ত্যাবেশাবতার ॥ ২৪৬ ॥

guṇāvatāra, āra manvantarāvatāra
the guṇa-avatāras and the manvantara-avatāras
yugāvatāra, āra śaktyāveśāvatāra
the yuga-avatāras and the śaktyāveśa-avatāras

246 the *guṇa-avatāras*, the *manvantara-avatāras*, the *yuga-avatāras* and the *śaktyāveśa-avatāras*.

Anubhāṣya.

The *guṇa-avatāras* are Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.88.3): these three forms.

The *manvantara-avatāras* (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 8, Chapters 1, 5 and 13): 1) Yajña, 2) Vibhu, 3) Satyasena, 4) Hari, 5) Vaikuṇṭha, 6) Ajita, 7) Vāmana, 8)

Sārvabhauma, 9) Ṛṣabha, 10) Viṣvaksena, 11) Dharmasetu, 12) Sudhāmā, 13) Yogeśvara, 14) Bṛhadbhānu. Of these fourteen forms, Yajña and Vāmana are also *līlā-avatāras*, so the *manvantara-avatāras* are 12 forms. These fourteen *manvantara-avatāras* are also said to be avatāras "in the state of *vaibhava*."

The *yuga-avatāras*: (1) in Satya, "white" (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.21); (2) in Tretā, "red" (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.24); (3) in Dvāpara, "dark" (*śyāma*; *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.27); (4) in an ordinary Kali, "black in colour" (*kṛṣṇa-varṇa*), and in a special Kali, "golden in colour" (*pīta-varṇa*) (see *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.32 and 10.8.13).

The *śaktyāveśa-avatāras*: (a) *bhagavad-āveśa* — Kapila and Ṛṣabhadeva; (b) *śaktyāveśa* — 1) Śeṣa in Vaikuṇṭha (the potency of serving the Lord Himself), 2) Ananta (the potency of bearing the earth), 3) Brahmā (the potency of creation), 4) the Catuḥ-sana (the potency of knowledge), 5) Nārada (the potency of *bhakti*), 6) Pṛthu (the potency of maintenance), 7) Paraśurāma (the potency of subduing the wicked) — these seven forms.

Among the six kinds of vilāsa of the youthful Kṛṣṇa, two kinds of vilāsa, or pastimes, according to the qualities of age —

বাল্য, পৌগণ্ড হয় বিগ্রহের ধর্ম্ম ।
এতরূপে লীলা করেন ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ॥ ২৪৭ ॥

bālya, paugaṇḍa haya vigrahera dharma
childhood boyhood are of the form the characteristics
eta-rūpe līlā karena vrajendra-nandana
in these forms pastimes reveals the son of Vraja's king

247 Childhood (*bālya*) and boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*) are characteristics of His form; as a child and as a boy the son of the king of Vraja reveals His pastimes.

The countless avatāras of Kṛṣṇa —

অনন্ত অবতার কৃষ্ণের, নাহিক গণন ।
শাখা-চন্দ্র-ন্যায় করি দিগ্‌দরশন ॥ ২৪৮ ॥

ananta avatāra kṛṣṇera, nāhika gaṇana
countless avatāras of Kṛṣṇa there is no counting
śākhā-candra-nyāya kari dig-daraśana
of the branch and the moon by the logic I make an indication

248 Kṛṣṇa's avatāras are countless; there is no counting them. As one shows the moon by pointing to a branch, I shall give only an indication.

Anubhāṣya.
Śākhā-candra-nyāya (the maxim of the moon on the branch): just as on level ground one points to the branch of a tree to show the place of the moon in the sky, this is only an indication of direction. Although the avatāras come within the range of worldly sight, they are not "mundane" (*māyika*). Their transcendental pastimes can be known only by a jīva who follows them submissively by the positive way (*anvaya*); they cannot be grasped by the mundane senses of people who follow the path of logic.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.3.26) —

অবতারা হ্যসংখ্যেয়া হরেঃ সত্ত্বনিধের্দ্বিজাঃ ।
যথাবিদাসিনঃ কুল্যাঃ সরসঃ স্যুঃ সহস্রশঃ ॥ ২৪৯ ॥

avatārā hy asaṁkhyeyā
the avatāras indeed are innumerable
hareḥ sattva-nidher dvijāḥ
of Hari of the treasure-house of goodness O brāhmaṇas
yathā vidāsinaḥ kulyāḥ
as of an inexhaustible rivulets
sarasaḥ syuḥ sahasraśaḥ
from a lake there are by thousands

249 "O brāhmaṇas, the avatāras of Hari, the treasure-house of goodness (*sattva*), are innumerable, like the thousands of rivulets that flow from an inexhaustible lake." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.26)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O twice-born, just as thousands upon thousands of small pools flow out of a vast reservoir, so the avatāras of Hari, the ocean of goodness (*sattva*), are countless.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Sūta Gosvāmī, having described to the sages headed by Śaunaka the countless avatāras of Śrī Hari, speaks of their being beyond number:

he dvijāḥ, **avidāsinaḥ** (undiminishing) **sarasaḥ** (from a lake) **yathā kulyāḥ** (small streams) **sahasraśaḥ syuḥ** (arise), **hi** (so too) **sattva-nidheḥ** (of the shelter of all *sattva*, the treasury of pure *sattva*) **hareḥ asaṅkhyeyāḥ** (innumerable) **avatārāḥ**.

(a) First of all, the three puruṣa-avatāras: those who lie on the Causal Ocean, the Garbha Ocean and the Milk Ocean —

প্রথমেই করে কৃষ্ণ ‘পুরুষাবতার’ ।
সেই ত’ পুরুষ হয় ত্রিবিধ প্রকার ॥ ২৫০ ॥

prathamei kare kṛṣṇa ‘puruṣāvatāra’
first of all makes Kṛṣṇa the puruṣa-avatāra
sei ta’ puruṣa haya trividha prakāra
that indeed Puruṣa is of three kinds

250 First of all Kṛṣṇa manifests the *puruṣa-avatāra*, and that Puruṣa is of three kinds.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Up to the words “That Puruṣa is of three kinds,” Kṛṣṇa’s many forms have been examined. Now Kṛṣṇa’s potencies will be examined.

(The words of the Sātvata-tantra) —

বিষ্ণোস্তু ত্রীণি রূপাণি পুরুষাখ্যান্যথো বিদুঃ ।
একন্তু মহতঃ স্রষ্টৃ দ্বিতীয়ং ত্বণ্ডসংস্থিতম্ ।
তৃতীয়ং সর্ব্বভূতস্থং তানি জ্ঞাত্বা বিমুচ্যতে ॥ ২৫১ ॥

viṣṇos tu trīṇi rūpāṇi
of Viṣṇu but three forms
puruṣākhyāny atho viduḥ
called Puruṣas then they know
ekaṁ tu mahataḥ sraṣṭṛ
one but of the mahat the creator
dvitīyaṁ tv aṇḍa-saṁsthitam
the second but in the universe abiding
tṛtīyaṁ sarva-bhūta-sthaṁ
the third in all beings abiding
tāni jñātvā vimucyate
them knowing one is liberated

251 "Viṣṇu has three forms called Puruṣas: the first creates the mahat, the second abides within the universe, and the third dwells in all beings. Knowing Them, one is set free." (Sātvata-tantra; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Pūrva-khaṇḍa, 2.9)[19]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 5.77.

One Kṛṣṇa is the presiding Lord of the three kinds of svarūpa-śakti —

অনন্তশক্তি-মধ্যে কৃষ্ণের তিন শক্তি প্রধান ।
'ইচ্ছাশক্তি', 'জ্ঞানশক্তি', 'ক্রিয়াশক্তি' নাম ॥ ২৫২ ॥

ananta-śakti-madhye kṛṣṇera tina śakti pradhāna
among the infinite potencies of Kṛṣṇa three potencies chief
'icchā-śakti', 'jñāna-śakti', 'kriyā-śakti' nāma
icchā-śakti jñāna-śakti kriyā-śakti by name

252 Among Kṛṣṇa's infinite potencies three are chief, named *icchā-śakti*, *jñāna-śakti* and *kriyā-śakti* — the potencies of will, knowledge and action.

Kṛṣṇa Himself is the presiding Lord of the icchā, that is, the ānanda-śakti, and among the catur-vyūha (1) in the form of Vāsudeva He is the Lord of the

saṁvit-śakti —

ইচ্ছাশক্তিপ্রধান কৃষ্ণ — ইচ্ছায় সর্ব্বকর্ত্তা ।
জ্ঞানশক্তিপ্রধান বাসুদেব চিত্ত-অধিষ্ঠাতা ॥ ২৫৩ ॥

icchā-śakti-pradhāna kṛṣṇa — icchāya sarva-kartā
in whom the potency of will predominates Kṛṣṇa by His will of all the doer
jñāna-śakti-pradhāna vāsudeva citta-adhiṣṭhātā
in whom the potency of knowledge predominates Vāsudeva of the citta the presiding Lord

253 Kṛṣṇa, in whom the potency of will predominates, is by His will the doer of all. Vāsudeva, in whom the potency of knowledge predominates, is the presiding Lord of the *citta*, consciousness.

ইচ্ছা-জ্ঞান-ক্রিয়া বিনা না হয় সৃজন ।
তিনের তিন শক্তি মেলি' প্রপঞ্চ-রচন ॥ ২৫৪ ॥

icchā-jñāna-kriyā vinā nā haya sṛjana
will knowledge action without not is creation
tinera tina śakti meli' prapañca-racana
of the three the three potencies joining of the world the making

254 Without will, knowledge and action there is no creation; the world is fashioned when these three join Their three potencies.

He again, in the form of Balarāma, or Saṅkarṣaṇa, is the Lord of the sandhinī-śakti; through the three kinds of potency the spiritual and nonspiritual worlds become manifest —

ক্রিয়াশক্তিপ্রধান সঙ্কর্ষণ বলরাম ।
প্রাকৃতাপ্রাকৃত-সৃষ্টি করেন নির্ম্মাণ ॥ ২৫৫ ॥

kriyā-śakti-pradhāna saṅkarṣaṇa balarāma
in whom the potency of action predominates Saṅkarṣaṇa Balarāma
prākṛtāprākṛta-sṛṣṭi karena nirmāṇa
of the material and the spiritual creation performs the making

255 Saṅkarṣaṇa Balarāma, in whom the potency of action predominates, brings about both the material and the spiritual creation.

Saṅkarṣaṇa is the cause of the existence of the original Puruṣa, that is, Kāraṇaśāyī, and of the spiritual glory —

অহঙ্কারের অধিষ্ঠাতা কৃষ্ণের ইচ্ছায় ।
গোলোক, বৈকুণ্ঠ সৃজে চিচ্ছক্তিদ্বারায় ॥ ২৫৬ ॥

ahaṅkārera adhiṣṭhātā kṛṣṇera icchāya
of ahaṅkāra the presiding Lord of Kṛṣṇa by the will
goloka, vaikuṇṭha sṛje cic-chakti-dvārāya
Goloka Vaikuṇṭha creates through the spiritual potency

256 As the presiding Lord of *ahaṅkāra*, He creates Goloka and Vaikuṇṭha by Kṛṣṇa's will, through the spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa, the nondual Truth, has unlimited potencies; among them, every action bears three distinguishing marks: *icchā-śakti*, *jñāna-śakti* and *kriyā-śakti*. He in whom *icchā-śakti* predominates is "Kṛṣṇa," by whose will everything takes place. He in whom *jñāna-śakti* predominates is "Vāsudeva," and He in whom *kriyā-śakti* predominates is "Saṅkarṣaṇa." These three, with Their three potencies, have created, or manifested, the material and the transcendental worlds. "Saṅkarṣaṇa," the presiding Lord of *ahaṅkāra*, by Kṛṣṇa's will and through the *cit-śakti* has manifested the abodes Goloka, Vaikuṇṭha and the others, the display (*vilāsa*) of the *cit-śakti*.

The vilāsa of the cit-śakti, the glory of that form, is manifest from Saṅkarṣaṇa —

যদ্যপি অসৃজ্য নিত্য চিচ্ছক্তিবিলাস ।
তথাপি সঙ্কর্ষণ-ইচ্ছায় তাঁহার প্রকাশ ॥ ২৫৭ ॥

yadyapi asṛjya nitya cic-chakti-vilāsa
although uncreatable eternal of the spiritual potency the display
tathāpi saṅkarṣaṇa-icchāya tāṁhāra prakāśa
still of Saṅkarṣaṇa by the will its manifestation

257 Although the display of the spiritual potency is eternal and uncreated, it is manifest by the will of Saṅkarṣaṇa.

From Saṅkarṣaṇa in the form of Ananta the abode of Goloka becomes manifest — (Brahma-saṁhitā 5.2) —

সহস্রপত্রং কমলং গোকুলাখ্যং মহৎপদম্ ।
তৎকর্ণিকারং তদ্ধাম তদনন্তাংশসম্ভবম্ ॥ ২৫৮ ॥

sahasra-patraṁ kamalaṁ
thousand-petalled lotus
gokulākhyaṁ mahat padam
called Gokula the great abode
tat-karṇikāraṁ tad-dhāma
its whorl His abode
tad anantāṁśa-sambhavam
that of Ananta from a portion arisen

258 "The great abode called Gokula is a lotus with a thousand petals; its whorl is His abode, and it has arisen from a portion of Ananta." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The great abode (*mahat-pada*) called Gokula is a lotus with a thousand petals; its whorl is His abode; and all of it is born of a part of Ananta.

Anubhāṣya.
gokulākhyaṁ mahat padam (the best of the abodes where the glory of His form is displayed) **sahasra-patraṁ kamalam** (is like a thousand-petaled lotus); **tat-karṇikāraṁ** (the very centre of that lotus flower) **tad-dhāma** (His, Kṛṣṇa's, abode); **tat** — **anantāṁśa-sambhavam** (born of a part of Baladeva).

The refutation of the Sāṅkhya doctrine: inert māyā, agitated by the power of Saṅkarṣaṇa's glance, becomes active and creates the universe —

মায়া-দ্বারে সৃজে তিঁহো ব্রহ্মাণ্ডের গণ ।
জড়রূপা প্রকৃতি নহে ব্রহ্মাণ্ড-কারণ ॥ ২৫৯ ॥

māyā-dvāre sṛje tiṁho brahmāṇḍera gaṇa
through māyā creates He of universes the host
jaḍa-rūpā prakṛti nahe brahmāṇḍa-kāraṇa
inert prakṛti is not of the universe the cause

259 Through māyā He creates the host of universes; inert *prakṛti* is not the cause of the universe.

জড় হৈতে সৃষ্টি নহে ঈশ্বরশক্তি বিনে ।
তাহাতেই সঙ্কর্ষণ করে শক্তির আধানে ॥ ২৬০ ॥

jaḍa haite sṛṣṭi nahe īśvara-śakti vine
from the inert creation is not the Lord's potency without
tāhātei saṅkarṣaṇa kare śaktira ādhāne
into it Saṅkarṣaṇa makes of potency the infusion

260 Without the Lord's potency, creation cannot come from what is inert; therefore Saṅkarṣaṇa infuses potency into it.

A comparison —

ঈশ্বরের শক্ত্যে সৃষ্টি করয়ে প্রকৃতি ।
লৌহ যেন অগ্নিশক্ত্যে পায় দাহ-শক্তি ॥ ২৬১ ॥

īśvarera śaktye sṛṣṭi karaye prakṛti
by the Lord's potency creation performs prakṛti
lauha yena agni-śaktye pāya dāha-śakti
iron as by fire's potency obtains the power to burn

261 By the Lord's potency *prakṛti* creates, just as iron obtains the power to burn by the potency of fire.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 5.60–64.

Rāma and Kṛṣṇa alone are the one Father and Controller of the universe —

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.46.31) —

এতৌ হি বিশ্বস্য চ বীজযোনী
রামো মুকুন্দঃ পুরুষঃ প্রধানম্ ।
অন্বীয় ভূতেষু বিলক্ষণস্য
জ্ঞানস্য চেশাত ইমৌ পুরাণৌ ॥ ২৬২ ॥

etau hi viśvasya ca bīja-yonī
these two indeed of the universe and the seed and the womb
rāmo mukundaḥ puruṣaḥ pradhānam
Rāma Mukunda the Puruṣa pradhāna
anvīya bhūteṣu vilakṣaṇasya
having entered into beings of the diverse
jñānasya ceśāta imau purāṇau
of the knower (the jīva) and rule these two primeval

262 "Rāma and Mukunda are the seed and the womb of the universe — the Puruṣa and *pradhāna*. Having entered into all beings, these two primeval Lords rule over the diverse jīvas." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.46.31)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

These two, Rāma and Kṛṣṇa, are the source of the jīvas of this world (*jīva-yoni*). Both of Them have entered all beings and have produced in them the knowledge of difference from one another.

Anubhāṣya.

At Kṛṣṇa's request the great soul Uddhava came to Vraja to relieve the grief of the residents of Vraja, born of separation from Kṛṣṇa. When he had rested, Nanda asked him about Kṛṣṇa, and Uddhava describes Kṛṣṇa's glory to Nanda and Yaśodā:

rāmaḥ mukundaḥ ca iti etau — viśvasya bīja-yonī (the efficient and the material cause), **puruṣaḥ** (the part), **pradhānam** (the potency; that is, Pradhāna and Puruṣa too are these two: thus They are said to be the Fathers [of the world]); **imau — purāṇau** (beginningless, eternal; therefore) **bhūteṣu anvīya** (having entered — both the beings and what is conditioned by them) **vilakṣaṇasya** (manifold) **jñānasya** (the *jīva*) **ca īśāte** (rule; thus They are said to be the Controllers as well).

An avatāra is a manifestation, that is, a descent, out of mercy into the material world from the abode beyond the material world —

সৃষ্টি-হেতু যেই মূর্ত্তি প্রপঞ্চে অবতরে ।
সেই ঈশ্বরমূর্ত্তি ‘অবতার’ নাম ধরে ॥ ২৬৩ ॥

sṛṣṭi-hetu yei mūrti prapañce avatare
for creation which form into the world descends
sei īśvara-mūrti ‘avatāra’ nāma dhare
that the Lord’s form avatāra the name bears

263 The form of the Lord that descends into the world for creation bears the name avatāra.

মায়াতীত পরব্যোমে সবার অবস্থান ।
বিশ্বে অবতরি’ ধরে ‘অবতার’ নাম ॥ ২৬৪ ॥

māyātīta paravyome sabāra avasthāna
beyond māyā in the paravyoma of all the dwelling
viśve avatari’ dhare ‘avatāra’ nāma
into the world descending bear avatāra the name

264 All of Them dwell in the spiritual sky beyond māyā; when They descend into the world, They are called avatāras.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 5.81.

Saṅkarṣaṇa is the original puruṣa-avatāra, who glances at prakṛti and sows the seed in her —

সেই মায়া অবলোকিতে শ্রীসঙ্কর্ষণ ।
পুরুষরূপে অবতীর্ণ হইলা প্রথম ॥ ২৬৫ ॥

sei māyā avalokite śrī-saṅkarṣaṇa
that māyā to glance at Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa
puruṣa-rūpe avatīrṇa hailā prathama
in the form of the Puruṣa descended became first

265 To glance at that māyā, Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa first descended in the form of the Puruṣa.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.3.1) —

জগৃহে পৌরুষং রূপং ভগবান্মহদাদিভিঃ ।
সম্ভূতং ষোড়শকলমাদৌ লোকসিসৃক্ষয়া ॥ ২৬৬ ॥

jagṛhe pauruṣaṁ rūpaṁ
accepted of the Puruṣa form
bhagavān mahad-ādibhiḥ
Bhagavān with the mahat and the rest
sambhūtaṁ ṣoḍaśa-kalam
composed of sixteen parts
ādau loka-sisṛkṣayā
in the beginning the worlds desiring to create

266 "In the beginning, desiring to create the worlds, Bhagavān accepted the form of the Puruṣa, joined with the mahat and the other principles and possessed of sixteen potencies (*kalā*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.1)[20]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 5.84.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.6.42) —

আদ্যোঽবতারঃ পুরুষঃ পরস্য
কালঃ স্বভাবঃ সদসন্মনশ্চ ।
দ্রব্যং বিকারো গুণ ইন্দ্রিয়াণি
বিরাট্ স্বরাট্ স্থাস্নু চরিষ্ণু ভূম্নঃ ॥ ২৬৭ ॥

ādyo 'vatāraḥ puruṣaḥ parasya
the first avatāra the Puruṣa of the Supreme
kālaḥ svabhāvaḥ sad-asan manaś ca
time nature cause and effect the mind and
dravyaṁ vikāro guṇa indriyāṇi
the elements false ego the guṇas the senses
virāṭ svarāṭ sthāsnu cariṣṇu bhūmnaḥ
the universal body the self-luminous the unmoving the moving of the Great One

267 "The Puruṣa is the first avatāra of the Supreme. Time, nature, prakṛti as cause and effect, the mind, the elements, false ego, the guṇas, the senses, the universal body (*virāṭ*) and the Vairāja (*svarāṭ*), and all beings, moving and unmoving — all these are the splendour of the Great One." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.6.42)[21]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 5.83.

(1) Lying on the couch of Śeṣa in His own Vaikuṇṭha, resting on the Kāraṇārṇava, or Virajā, the indwelling Lord of prakṛti, the creator of the cause of the universes —

সেই পুরুষ বিরজাতে করেন শয়ন ।
'কারণাব্ধিশায়ী' নাম জগৎকারণ ॥ ২৬৮ ॥

sei puruṣa virajāte karena śayana
that Puruṣa in the Virajā does lying
'kāraṇābdhiśāyī' nāma jagat-kāraṇa
Kāraṇābdhiśāyī by name of the world the cause

268 That Puruṣa lies upon the Virajā. He is named Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, the cause of the world.

On one shore of the Virajā, or Kāraṇābdhi, is the turīya Paravyoma, that is, Vaikuṇṭha, the glory of spirit; on the other shore, the realm of māyā (māyā-

vilāsa), that is, the mundane Devī-dhāma, the glory of the nonspiritual —

কারণাব্ধি-পারে মায়ার নিত্য অবস্থিতি ।
বিরজার পারে পরব্যোমে নাহি গতি ॥ ২৬৯ ॥

kāraṇābdhi-pāre māyāra nitya avasthiti
on the shore of the Causal Ocean māyā's eternal abiding
virajāra pāre paravyome nāhi gati
of the Virajā beyond into the paravyoma there is no access

269 Māyā abides eternally on the shore of the Causal Ocean; she has no access beyond the Virajā into the spiritual sky.

The glory of Vaikuṇṭha — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.9.10) —

প্রবর্ত্ততে যত্র রজস্তমস্তয়োঃ
সত্ত্বঞ্চ মিশ্রং ন চ কালবিক্রমঃ ।
ন যত্র মায়া কিমুতাপরে হরে-
রনুব্রতা যত্র সুরাসুরার্চ্চিতাঃ ॥ ২৭০ ॥

pravartate yatra rajas tamas tayoḥ
operate where passion ignorance with them
sattvañ ca miśraṁ na ca kāla-vikramaḥ
goodness and mixed not and of time the might
na yatra māyā kim utāpare harer
not where māyā what to speak of the others of Hari
anuvratā yatra surāsurārcitāḥ
the followers where by gods and asuras worshipped

270 "There neither passion nor ignorance operates, nor goodness mixed with them, nor the might of time; there even māyā has no place — what to speak of the rest. There dwell the followers of Hari, worshipped by gods and *asuras* alike." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.10)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In that Vaikuṇṭha there is neither *rajas* nor *tamas*, nor *sattva* mixed with them, nor the might of time; even māyā is not there — what to speak of the rest. There live

the associates, the devotees faithful to Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who are worshipped by gods and *asuras* alike.

Anubhāṣya.

"How does the pure *jīva*-soul come into relation with a body?" — Śrī Śukadeva answers this question of King Parīkṣit. Before telling how Bhagavān proclaimed to Brahmā the knowledge of the truth contained in the *Catuḥ-ślokī*, he describes the abode of Vaikuṇṭha that Bhagavān showed Brahmā at the beginning of creation, as the fruit of Brahmā's austerity of a thousand divine years for the sake of seeing Bhagavān.

yatra (in Vaikuṇṭha) **rajaḥ**, **tamaḥ**, **tayoḥ miśraṁ** (mixed with them) **sattvaṁ ca** (do not operate — only pure *sattva* operates), **kāla-vikramaḥ** (and destruction does not operate); **yatra** (in Vaikuṇṭha) **māyā na pravartate** (is not), **apare** (passion, greed and the rest, connected with *māyā*) **na** (exist — thus) **kim uta** (what need be said?); **yatra** (in Vaikuṇṭha) **surāsurārcitāḥ** (worshipped by all, by the gods and the *daityas*) **hareḥ anuvratāḥ** (the associates abide).

Māyā in her two forms has two functions: (a) the work of prakṛti and (b) the work of pradhāna —

মায়ার যে দুই বৃত্তি — 'মায়া' আর 'প্রধান' ।
'মায়া' নিমিত্ত হেতু, বিশ্বের উপাদান 'প্রধান' ॥ ২৭১ ॥

māyāra ye dui vṛtti — 'māyā' āra 'pradhāna'
of māyā which two functions māyā and pradhāna
'māyā' nimitta hetu, viśvera upādāna 'pradhāna'
māyā the efficient cause of the universe the material cause pradhāna

271 Māyā has two functions, called māyā and *pradhāna*. Māyā is the efficient cause of the universe, and *pradhāna* is its material cause.

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 5.58.

Kāraṇodaśāyī's glance at prakṛti —

সেই পুরুষ মায়া-পানে করে অবধান ।
প্রকৃতি ক্ষোভিত করি' করে বীর্য্যের আধান ॥ ২৭২ ॥

sei puruṣa māyā-pāne kare avadhāna
that Puruṣa towards māyā directs His glance
prakṛti kṣobhita kari' kare vīryera ādhāna
prakṛti agitated making makes of the seed the placing

272 That Puruṣa turns His glance towards māyā. Agitating *prakṛti*, He deposits the seed in her.

Though Himself pure, He seems as if impure: by His mere will He touches prakṛti and places in the womb of prakṛti the jīva-śakti — the countless atomic particles of spirit abiding in the pores of His body —

স্বাঙ্গ-বিশেষাভাসরূপে প্রকৃতি স্পর্শন ।
জীব-রূপ 'বীজ' তাতে কৈলা সমর্পণ ॥ ২৭৩ ॥

svāṅga-viśeṣābhāsa-rūpe prakṛti sparśana
of His own body of a particular part of the reflection in the form prakṛti touching
jīva-rūpa 'bīja' tāte kailā samarpaṇa
in the form of the jīvas the seed into her He made the offering

273 He touches *prakṛti* only through a reflection of a particular part of His own body, and places in her the seed, which is the countless jīvas.

Anubhāṣya.
See *Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.10–13.

How the jīva and the twenty-seven tattvas that house his enjoyment came to be; the cause of the origin of the mahat-tattva, the first transformation of prakṛti

and the sprout of the universe in the form of citta — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 3.26.19)

দৈবাৎ ক্ষুভিতধর্ম্মিণ্যাং স্বস্যাং যোনৌ পরঃ পুমান্ ।
আধত্ত বীর্য্যং সাসূত মহত্তত্ত্বং হিরণ্ময়ম্ ॥ ২৭৪ ॥

daivāt kṣubhita-dharmiṇyāṁ
by time in her whose qualities were agitated
svasyāṁ yonau paraḥ pumān
in His own womb the Supreme Person
ādhatta vīryaṁ sāsūta
placed the seed she gave birth to
mahat-tattvaṁ hiraṇmayam
the mahat-tattva golden

274 "When by time (*daiva*) the qualities of nature were stirred, the Supreme Person placed the seed in the womb of His own nature, and she gave birth to the golden *mahat-tattva*." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.26.19)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

That Supreme Person placed His own seed in His own māyā, whose properties (*dharmas*) had been agitated by destiny (*daiva*). Then māyā gave birth to the golden *mahat-tattva*.

Anubhāṣya.

Devahūti asked about the characteristics of *puruṣa* and *prakṛti*. In reply Bhagavān Kapiladeva describes to her the twenty-eight *tattvas*, beginning with the *mahat*, and then Bhagavān, the *puruṣa-avatāra* who is their master, and how the jīvas become manifest from Him.

daivāt (by time) **kṣubhita-dharmiṇyāṁ** (in her whose properties, the *guṇas*, are agitated) (in His own) **yonau** (in the womb, in *prakṛti*, the place of manifestation) **paraḥ pumān** (the Supreme Person, Bhagavān Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī) **vīryaṁ** (the *jīva-śakti*) **ādhatta** (placed); **sā** (*prakṛti*) **hiraṇmayaṁ** (full of light) **mahat-tattvaṁ asūta** (gave birth to).

The history of the manifestation of the jīva-śakti — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam

3.5.26)

কালবৃত্ত্যা তু মায়ায়াং গুণময়্যামধোক্ষজঃ ৷
পুরুষেণাত্মভূতেন বীর্য্যমাধত্ত বীর্য্যবান্ ॥ ২৭৫ ॥

kāla-vṛttyā tu māyāyāṁ
by the action of time indeed in māyā
guṇa-mayyām adhokṣajaḥ
consisting of the guṇas Adhokṣaja
puruṣeṇātma-bhūtena
through the Puruṣa His own part
vīryam ādhatta vīryavān
the seed placed the potent One

275 "By the working of time the potent Adhokṣaja, through the Puruṣa, His own part, placed the seed in māyā, which is made of the *guṇas*." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.5.26)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Adhokṣaja (the Lord of Mahā-Vaikuṇṭha), who possesses the seed (that is, the *cit-śakti*), through the Puruṣa who is His own part — that is, the original Puruṣa, the master of *prakṛti* — by the power of time (*kāla-vṛtti*) placed the seed (the *jīva-śakti*, a mass of atomic particles of spirit) in māyā, made of the *guṇas* (and agitated).

Anubhāṣya.

The great soul Vidura asked the sage Śrī Maitreya about Śrī Hari's pastimes as the *puruṣa-avatāras*. Maitreya describes how the *puruṣa-avatāra* creates the world through māyā, and then how the jīvas are born from Him.

vīryavān (possessing the *cit-śakti*) **adhokṣajaḥ** (Bhagavān beyond the senses, the Lord of Mahā-Vaikuṇṭha) **ātma-bhūtena** (by His own part) **puruṣeṇa** (in the form of the master of *prakṛti*, Kāraṇābdhiśāyī) **kāla-vṛttyā** (by the potency of time, the efficient cause) **guṇa-mayyāṁ** (in her whose *guṇas* are agitated) **māyāyāṁ vīryam** (the potency called the jīva, a reflection of spirit) **ādhatta** (placed).

From the mahat-tattva, the constituents of the universe — the "three

ahaṅkāras” —

তবে মহত্তত্ত্ব হৈতে ত্রিবিধ অহঙ্কার ।
যাহা হৈতে দেবতেন্দ্রিয়ভূতের প্রচার ॥ ২৭৬ ॥

tabe mahat-tattva haite trividha ahaṅkāra
then the mahat-tattva from threefold ego
yāhā haite devatendriya-bhūtera pracāra
which from of the gods senses and elements the spreading forth

276 Then from the *mahat-tattva* came the threefold ego (*ahaṅkāra*), from which the gods, the senses and the elements spread forth.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The three kinds of *ahaṅkāra* (ego) are *vaikārika*, *taijasa* and *tāmasa*.

Anubhāṣya.
The *mahat-tattva* exists as *citta* (consciousness); its presiding deity is Vāsudeva (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.26.21). From the transformation of the *mahat-tattva* arise: (1) the *vaikārika*, that is, the *sāttvika ahaṅkāra*, and from it the eleventh sense, the mind, whose presiding deity is Aniruddha (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.26.27–28); (2) from the *taijasa*, that is, the *rājasika ahaṅkāra*, the intelligence (*buddhi*), whose presiding deity is Pradyumna, and the senses (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.26.30–31); (3) from the *tāmasa ahaṅkāra*, the sound *tanmātra*, and from it ether, the sense of hearing and the rest (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.26.32). The presiding deity of these three *ahaṅkāras* is Saṅkarṣaṇa (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.26.25). The *Sāṅkhya-kārikā* says: “From the *vaikṛta ahaṅkāra* proceeds the sāttvika group of eleven; from the *bhūtādi*, the *tanmātras*, which are *tāmasa*; from the *taijasa*, both.”[36]

The creation of countless universes from the twenty-eight tattvas —

সর্ব্বতত্ত্ব মিলি’ সৃজিল ব্রহ্মাণ্ডের গণ ।
অনন্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ড, তার নাহিক গণন ॥ ২৭৭ ॥

sarva tattva mili’ sṛjila brahmāṇḍera gaṇa
all the elements combining created of universes the multitudes
ananta brahmāṇḍa, tāra nāhika gaṇana
endless universes their there is no counting

277 All the elements combined and created multitudes of universes — endless universes, beyond all counting.

He is Mahā-Viṣṇu, the creator of the mahat-tattva; in the pores of His body are the countless jīvas, atomic particles of spirit —

ইঁহো মহৎস্রষ্টা পুরুষ — 'মহাবিষ্ণু' নাম ।
অনন্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ড তাঁর লোমকূপে ধাম ॥ ২৭৮ ॥

iṁho mahat-sraṣṭā puruṣa — 'mahā-viṣṇu' nāma
He of the mahat the creator Puruṣa Mahā-Viṣṇu by name
ananta brahmāṇḍa tāṁra loma-kūpe dhāma
endless universes His in the pores of the skin abode

278 This Puruṣa, the creator of the *mahat*, is named Mahā-Viṣṇu. Countless universes dwell in the pores of His skin.

Anubhāṣya.
The original *puruṣa-avatāra*, the creator of the *mahat-tattva*, is called "Mahā-Viṣṇu." Countless universes rest in the pores of Mahā-Viṣṇu's body.

With His exhalation, the "creation" of the universes; with His inhalation, their "dissolution" —

গবাক্ষে উড়িয়া যৈছে রেণু আসে যায় ।
পুরুষ-নিশ্বাস-সহ ব্রহ্মাণ্ড বাহিরায় ॥ ২৭৯ ॥

gavākṣe uḍiyā yaiche reṇu āse yāya
through a lattice window flying as specks of dust come go
puruṣa-niśvāsa-saha brahmāṇḍa bāhirāya
the Puruṣa's breath with the universes come out

279 As specks of dust fly in and out through a lattice window, so the universes come out with the Puruṣa's breath.

He Himself is the tattva who is the master of māyā —

পুনরপি নিশ্বাস-সহ যায় অভ্যন্তর ।
অনন্ত ঐশ্বর্য্য তাঁর, সব — মায়া-পার ॥ ২৮০ ॥

punarapi niśvāsa-saha yāya abhyantara
again with the breath go inside
ananta aiśvarya tāṁra, saba — māyā-pāra
endless majesty His all beyond māyā

280 And with His breath they go back inside again. His majesty is endless, and all of it lies beyond māyā.

(Brahma-saṁhitā 5.48)

যস্যৈক-নিশ্বসিতকালমথাবলম্ব্য
জীবন্তি লোমবিলজা জগদণ্ডনাথাঃ ।
বিষ্ণুর্মহান্ স ইহ যস্য কলাবিশেষো
গোবিন্দমাদিপুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ২৮১ ॥

yasyaika-niśvasita-kālam athāvalambya
whose one exhalation's span then depending on
jīvanti loma-vila-jā jagad-aṇḍa-nāthāḥ
live from the pores born of the universes the lords
viṣṇur mahān sa iha yasya kalā-viśeṣo
Viṣṇu the Great He here whose kalā particular
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

281 "The lords of the universes, born from His pores, abide for the span of one of His breaths. That Mahā-Viṣṇu is a particular kalā of Govinda, the original Person, whom I worship." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.48)[22]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 5.71.

The original creator of countless millions of abodes —

সমস্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ডগণের ইঁহো অন্তর্য্যামী ।
কারণাব্ধিশায়ী — সব জগতের স্বামী ॥ ২৮২ ॥

samasta brahmāṇḍa-gaṇera iṁho antaryāmī
of all the universes the multitudes He the indwelling Lord
kāraṇābdhiśāyī — saba jagatera svāmī
Kāraṇābdhiśāyī of all the worlds the master

282 He is the indwelling Lord of all the multitudes of universes. Kāraṇābdhiśāyī is the master of all the worlds.

(2) A description of the second puruṣa-avatāra, Garbhodaśāyī, who is Pradyumna —

এইত কহিলুঁ প্রথম পুরুষের তত্ত্ব ।
দ্বিতীয় পুরুষের এবে শুনহ মহত্ত্ব ॥ ২৮৩ ॥

eita kahiluṁ prathama puruṣera tattva
thus I have told of the first Puruṣa the truth
dvitīya puruṣera ebe śunaha mahattva
of the second Puruṣa now hear the greatness

283 Thus I have told you the truth about the first Puruṣa. Now hear of the greatness of the second Puruṣa.

Kāraṇodaśāyī Himself is Garbhodaśāyī, who abides within the universe —

সেই পুরুষ অনন্ত-কোটি ব্রহ্মাণ্ড সৃজিয়া ।
একৈক-মূর্ত্ত্যে প্রবেশিলা বহু মূর্ত্তি হঞা ॥ ২৮৪ ॥

sei puruṣa ananta-koṭi brahmāṇḍa sṛjiyā
that Puruṣa endless millions of universes having created
ekaika-mūrtye praveśilā bahu mūrti hañā
in each one with a form entered many forms becoming

284 Having created endless millions of universes, that Puruṣa became many forms and entered each universe in a form of His own.

প্রবেশ করিয়া দেখে, সব — অন্ধকার ।
রহিতে নাহিক স্থান, করিলা বিচার ॥ ২৮৫ ॥

praveśa kariyā dekhe, saba — andhakāra
entering He sees everything darkness
rahite nāhika sthāna, karilā vicāra
to stay there is no place He made deliberation

285 Entering, He saw that all was darkness and there was no place to stay, and He reflected.

The appearance of the waters of Garbha; there, in Vaikuṇṭha, He lies on the bed of Śeṣa —

নিজাঙ্গ-স্বেদজলে ব্রহ্মাণ্ডার্দ্ধ ভরিল ।
সেই জলে শেষ-শয়্যায় শয়ন করিল ॥ ২৮৬ ॥

nijāṅga-sveda-jale brahmāṇḍārdha bharila
with the water of His own body's perspiration half the universe He filled
sei jale śeṣa-śayyāya śayana karila
in that water on Śeṣa as a bed lying down He did

286 With the water of His own body's perspiration He filled half the universe, and on those waters He lay down on the bed of Śeṣa.

From Garbhodaśāyī, the indwelling Lord of the four-headed one, the guṇa-avatāras appear; (a) the birth of Brahmā, the creator of the world —

তাঁর নাভিপদ্ম হৈতে উঠিল এক পদ্ম ।
সেই পদ্মে হইল ব্রহ্মার জন্ম-সদ্ম ॥ ২৮৭ ॥

tāṁra nābhi-padma haite uṭhila eka padma
His from the navel-lotus arose one lotus
sei padme haila brahmāra janma-sadma
that lotus became of Brahmā birth the abode

287 From His navel-lotus a lotus arose, and that lotus became the birthplace of Brahmā.

Anubhāṣya.

sadma — house, dwelling, abode.

সেই পদ্মনালে হৈল চৌদ্দ ভুবন ।
তিঁহো 'ব্রহ্মা' হঞা সৃষ্টি করিলা সৃজন ॥ ২৮৮ ॥

sei padma-nāle haila caudda bhuvana
in that lotus stem came to be the fourteen worlds
tiṁho 'brahmā' hañā sṛṣṭi karilā sṛjana
He Brahmā becoming creation made bringing forth

288 In the stem of that lotus the fourteen worlds came to be, and He, becoming Brahmā, brought forth the creation.

(b) The manifestation of Viṣṇu, the maintainer of the world: though He is the presiding deity of sattva, He Himself is beyond the guṇas and māyā —

'বিষ্ণু'-রূপ হঞা করে জগৎ পালনে ।
গুণাতীত বিষ্ণু — স্পর্শ নাহি মায়া-সনে ॥ ২৮৯ ॥

'viṣṇu'-rūpa hañā kare jagat pālane
Viṣṇu's form taking makes of the world maintenance
guṇātīta viṣṇu — sparśa nāhi māyā-sane
beyond the guṇas Viṣṇu touch there is no with māyā

289 Taking the form of Viṣṇu, He maintains the world. Viṣṇu is beyond the *guṇas*; He has no contact with māyā.

Anubhāṣya.

Viṣṇu's māyā cannot cover Viṣṇu as it covers Brahmā and Śiva. Viṣṇu is the Reality beyond the *guṇas*, and so the *guṇas* of māyā cannot touch Him. The *guṇa-avatāras* Brahmā and Śiva are subject to māyā, but Viṣṇu is not, for the Lord is the master of māyā and the jīva is subject to māyā — this is the difference between them.[37]

(c) The appearance of Rudra, the destroyer of the world —

'রুদ্র'-রূপ ধরি' করে জগৎ সংহার ।
সৃষ্টি, স্থিতি, প্রলয় হয় ইচ্ছায় যাঁহার ॥ ২৯০ ॥

'rudra'-rūpa dhari' kare jagat saṁhāra
Rudra's form assuming makes of the world destruction
sṛṣṭi, sthiti, pralaya haya icchāya yāṁhāra
creation maintenance dissolution take place by the will of whom

290 Assuming the form of Rudra, He destroys the world. Creation, maintenance and dissolution all take place by His will.

Three kinds of authority are entrusted to the three guṇa-avatāras —

ব্রহ্মা, বিষ্ণু, শিব — তাঁর 'গুণাবতার' ।
সৃষ্টি-স্থিতি-প্রলয়ের তিনের অধিকার ॥ ২৯১ ॥

brahmā, viṣṇu, śiva — tāṁra 'guṇāvatāra'
Brahmā Viṣṇu Śiva His guṇa-avatāras
sṛṣṭi-sthiti-pralayera tinera adhikāra
of creation maintenance and dissolution of the three the charge

291 Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva are His *guṇa-avatāras*. The three are in charge of creation, maintenance and dissolution.

This Garbhodaśāyī, the indwelling Lord of Hiraṇyagarbha, the aggregate jīva, is praised by the hymn of the Ṛg-veda —

হিরণ্যগর্ভ-অন্তর্য্যামী — গর্ভোদকশায়ী ।
'সহস্রশীর্ষাদি' করি' বেদে যাঁরে গাই ॥ ২৯২ ॥

hiraṇyagarbha-antaryāmī — garbhodakaśāyī
of Hiraṇyagarbha the indwelling Lord Garbhodakaśāyī
'sahasra-śīrṣādi' kari' vede yāṁre gāi
'thousand-headed' and so on calling in the Vedas whom they sing

292 Garbhodakaśāyī is the indwelling Lord of Hiraṇyagarbha. The Vedas sing of Him in the hymn that begins "thousand-headed" (*sahasra-śīrṣā*) and

in others.

Anubhāṣya.

"The Puruṣa has a thousand heads, a thousand eyes, a thousand feet…" and so on — the hymn of the *Ṛg-veda*.[38]

He too is Himself the tattva who is the master of māyā —

এই ত' দ্বিতীয়-পুরুষ — ব্রহ্মাণ্ডের ঈশ্বর ।
মায়ার 'আশ্রয়' হয়, তবু মায়া-পার ॥ ২৯৩ ॥

ei ta' dvitīya-puruṣa — brahmāṇḍera īśvara
this indeed the second Puruṣa of the universe the Lord
māyāra 'āśraya' haya, tabu māyā-pāra
of māyā the shelter He is yet beyond māyā

293 This second Puruṣa is the Lord of the universe. He is the shelter of māyā, yet He is beyond māyā.

(3) The third puruṣa-avatāra, Kṣīrodaśāyī, who is Aniruddha, or the guṇa-avatāra Viṣṇu —

তৃতীয়-পুরুষ বিষ্ণু — 'গুণ-অবতার' ।
দুই অবতার-ভিতর গণনা তাঁহার ॥ ২৯৪ ॥

tṛtīya-puruṣa viṣṇu — 'guṇa-avatāra'
the third Puruṣa Viṣṇu a guṇa-avatāra
dui avatāra-bhitara gaṇanā tāṁhāra
two avatāras among the counting of Him

294 The third Puruṣa, Viṣṇu, is also a *guṇa-avatāra*: He is counted among both kinds of avatāras.

He abides in all beings; that is, He is the indwelling Lord and maintainer of the Virāṭ, or of the individual jīva —

বিরাট্ ব্যষ্টি-জীবের তিঁহো অন্তর্য্যামী ।
ক্ষীরোদকশায়ী তিঁহো — পালনকর্ত্তা, স্বামী ॥ ২৯৫ ॥

virāṭ vyaṣṭi-jīvera tiṁho antaryāmī
of the virāṭ of the individual jīvas He the indwelling Lord
kṣīrodakaśāyī tiṁho — pālana-kartā, svāmī
Kṣīrodakaśāyī He the maintainer the master

295 He is the indwelling Lord of the *virāṭ* and of the individual jīvas. He is Kṣīrodakaśāyī, the maintainer and master.

(b) A description of the līlā-avatāras —

পুরুষাবতারের এই কৈলুঁ নিরূপণ ।
লীলাবতার এবে শুন, সনাতন ॥ ২৯৬ ॥

puruṣāvatārera ei kailuṁ nirūpaṇa
of the puruṣa-avatāras this I have made the description
līlāvatāra ebe śuna, sanātana
the līlā-avatāras now hear Sanātana

296 Thus I have described the *puruṣa-avatāras*. Now, Sanātana, hear about the *līlā-avatāras*.

Of the countless līlā-avatāras, twenty-five forms are the principal ones —

লীলাবতার কৃষ্ণের না যায় গণন ।
প্রধান করিয়া কহি দিগ্‌দরশন ॥ ২৯৭ ॥

līlāvatāra kṛṣṇera nā yāya gaṇana
the līlā-avatāras of Kṛṣṇa not can be counted
pradhāna kariyā kahi dig-daraśana
the chief taking I tell a glimpse

297 Kṛṣṇa's *līlā-avatāras* cannot be counted. I shall give only a glimpse, naming the chief ones.

The names of some of them —

মৎস্য, কূর্ম্ম, রঘুনাথ, নৃসিংহ, বামন ।
বরাহাদি — লেখা যাঁর না যায় গণন ॥ ২৯৮ ॥

matsya, kūrma, raghunātha, nṛsiṁha, vāmana
Matsya Kūrma Raghunātha Nṛsiṁha Vāmana
varāhādi — lekhā yāṁra nā yāya gaṇana
Varāha and others writing of whom not can be counted

298 Matsya, Kūrma, Raghunātha, Nṛsiṁha, Vāmana, Varāha and others — they are too many to write down and count.

The evidence of scripture — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.2.40)

মৎস্যাশ্বকচ্ছপনৃসিংহ-বরাহ-হংস-
রাজন্যবিপ্রবিবুধেষু কৃতাবতারঃ ৷
ত্বং পাসি নস্ত্রিভুবনঞ্চ তথাধুনেশ
ভারং ভুবো হর যদূত্তম বন্দনং তে ॥ ২৯৯ ॥

matsyāśva-kacchapa-nṛsiṁha-varāha-haṁsa-
as the Fish the Horse the Tortoise Nṛsiṁha the Boar the Swan
rājanya-vipra-vibudheṣu kṛtāvatāraḥ
among kings brāhmaṇas and gods who has descended
tvaṁ pāsi nas tri-bhuvanañ ca tathādhuneśa
You protect us the three worlds and so now O Lord
bhāraṁ bhuvo hara yadūttama vandanaṁ te
the burden of the earth remove O best of the Yadus obeisance to You

299 "O Lord, descending as the Fish, the Horse, the Tortoise, Nṛsiṁha, the Boar and the Swan, and among kings, brāhmaṇas and gods, You protect us and the three worlds. So now, O best of the Yadus, remove the burden of the earth. We bow down to You." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.2.40)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

You become various avatāras — in the forms of Matsya, Aśvagrīva, Kacchapa, Nṛsiṁha, Varāha, Haṁsa, Dāśarathi, Paraśurāma, Vāmana and others — and protect us and the three worlds. O best of the Yadus, we bow down to You. O Lord, now remove the burden of this earth.

Anubhāṣya.

Together with the devas, Brahmā offers a prayer for the destruction of the *asuras* to Bhagavān Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who is in the womb of Devakī, confined in Kaṁsa's prison.

he īśa, **tvaṁ matsyāśva-kacchapa-varāha-nṛsiṁha-haṁsa-rājanya-vipra-vibudheṣu** (in the forms of Matsya, Hayagrīva, Kūrma, Varāha, Nṛsiṁha, Haṁsa, Dāśarathi, Paraśurāma, Vāmana and others, as *kalās*) **kṛtāvatāraḥ san** (manifesting forms, revealing avatāras, having descended) **naḥ** (us, the devas) **tribhuvanaṁ** (*bhūr*, *bhuvaḥ* and *svaḥ* — the heavenly, earthly and lower worlds, or the three worlds) **ca** (as at other times) **pāsi** (You protect), **tathā adhunā** (now too) **bhuvaḥ** (of the earth) **bhāraṁ** (irreligion) **hara** (destroy — that is, protect us); (therefore) **he yadūttama** (best of the Yadu dynasty), **te** (to You) **vandanaṁ** (*kurmaḥ* — all of us bow our heads to You).

(c) A description of the three guṇa-avatāras —

লীলাবতারের কৈলুঁ দিগ্‌দরশন ।
গুণাবতারের এবে শুন বিবরণ ॥ ৩০০ ॥

līlāvatārera kailuṁ dig-daraśana
of the līlā-avatāras I have given a glimpse
guṇāvatārera ebe śuna vivaraṇa
of the guṇa-avatāras now hear the account

300 I have given you a glimpse of the *līlā-avatāras*. Now hear the account of the *guṇa-avatāras*.

The three persons who carry out the three tasks —

ব্রহ্মা, বিষ্ণু, শিব, — তিন গুণ-অবতার ।
ত্রিগুণ অঙ্গীকরি' করে সৃষ্ট্যাদি ব্যবহার ॥ ৩০১ ॥

brahmā, viṣṇu, śiva, — tina guṇa-avatāra
Brahmā Viṣṇu Śiva three guṇa-avatāras
tri-guṇa aṅgīkari' kare sṛṣṭy-ādi vyavahāra
the three guṇas accepting they carry out creation and so on the business

301 Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva are the three *guṇa-avatāras*. Accepting the three *guṇas*, they carry out creation and the rest.

Anubhāṣya.

"Accepting the three *guṇas*" — that is, taking up the three *guṇas*, *rajas*, *sattva* and *tamas*, for the creation, maintenance, dissolution and other dealings of the world, Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva are the three *guṇa-avatāras*.

(1) Brahmā in rajo-guṇa: sometimes the greatest jīva holds the post of Vairāja Brahmā; sometimes, when there is none, Garbhodaśāyī Himself becomes Hiraṇyagarbha Brahmā —

ভক্তিমিশ্রকৃত-পুণ্যে কোন জীবোত্তম ।
রজোগুণে বিভাবিত করি' তাঁর মন ॥ ৩০২ ॥

bhakti-miśra-kṛta-puṇye kona jīvottama
with devotion mixed performed through piety some excellent jīva
rajo-guṇe vibhāvita kari' tāṁra mana
with rajo-guṇa imbued making his mind

302 Through piety mixed with devotion, some excellent jīva has his mind imbued with *rajo-guṇa*,

গর্ভোদকশায়ীদ্বারা শক্তি সঞ্চারি' ।
ব্যষ্টি সৃষ্টি করে কৃষ্ণ ব্রহ্মা-রূপ ধরি' ॥ ৩০৩ ॥

garbhodakaśāyī-dvārā śakti sañcāri'
Garbhodakaśāyī through power infusing
vyaṣṭi sṛṣṭi kare kṛṣṇa brahmā-rūpa dhari'
the individual creation makes Kṛṣṇa Brahmā's form assuming

303 and, infusing His power into him through Garbhodakaśāyī, Kṛṣṇa assumes the form of Brahmā and brings forth the individual creation.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
This Garbhodaśāyī, the *puruṣa-avatāra* Viṣṇu, taking up the *guṇas* of *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*, manifests the three *guṇa-avatāras* — Viṣṇu, Brahmā and Śiva. Among them, by virtue of piety mixed with devotion, He imbues some excellent jīva with *rajo-guṇa*, infuses His own *śakti* into him, and "in the form of Brahmā" carries out the individual creation.

(Brahma-saṁhitā 5.49)

ভাস্বান্ যথাশ্মসকলেষু নিজেষু তেজঃ
স্বীয়ং কিয়ৎ প্রকটয়ত্যপি তদ্বদত্র ৷
ব্রহ্মা য এষ জগদণ্ডবিধানকর্ত্তা
গোবিন্দমাদিপুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ৩০৪ ॥

bhāsvān yathāśma-sakaleṣu nijeṣu tejaḥ
the sun as in stones its own radiance
svīyaṁ kiyat prakaṭayaty api tadvad atra
its own some manifests also likewise here
brahmā ya eṣa jagad-aṇḍa-vidhāna-kartā
Brahmā who this of the universe of the ordering the maker
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

304 "As the sun displays something of its own radiance in certain gems that are its own, so here He becomes Brahmā, who orders the universe. I worship Govinda, that original Person." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.49)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The sun displays its brilliance in small measure in various separate stones. So too the original Person Govinda places His own *śakti* in some jīva, becomes "Brahmā," and arranges the universe. Him I worship.

Anubhāṣya.

yathā bhāsvān (the sun) **nijeṣu** (in those eternally known as its own) **aśma-sakaleṣu api** (in the stones called *sūrya-kānta*) **svīyaṁ kiyat tejaḥ** (some measure of its power) **prakaṭayati**, **tadvat yaḥ eṣaḥ puruṣaḥ** (Garbhodaśāyī) **atra** (in the universe) **brahmā** (being) **jagad-aṇḍa-vidhāna-kartā** (the maker of the individual creation of the universe), **tam ādi-puruṣaṁ govindam ahaṁ bhajāmi**.

কোন কল্পে যদি যোগ্য জীব নাহি পায় ৷
আপনে ঈশ্বর তবে অংশে 'ব্রহ্মা' হয় ॥ ৩০৫ ॥

kona kalpe yadi yogya jīva nāhi pāya
in some kalpa if a qualified jīva not is found
āpane īśvara tabe aṁśe 'brahmā' haya
Himself the Lord then by a part Brahmā becomes

305 If in some *kalpa* no qualified jīva is found, then the Lord Himself becomes Brahmā by His part.

Anubhāṣya.
Kalpa: the lifespan of Brahmā, the duration of his hundred years. One day of Brahmā, that is, a thousand *catur-yugas*, is 4,320,000,000 solar years; for human beings this is a "*kalpa*," that is, a day of Brahmā. Three hundred sixty such days make a year of Brahmā, and a hundred such years are Brahmā's lifespan.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.68.37)

যস্যাঙ্ঘ্রিপঙ্কজরজোঽখিললোক-পালৈ-
র্মৌল্যুত্তমৈর্ধৃতমুপাসিত-তীর্থতীর্থম্ ।
ব্রহ্মা ভবোঽহমপি যস্য কলাঃ কলায়াঃ
শ্রীশ্চোদ্বহেম চিরমস্য নৃপাসনং ক্ব ॥ ৩০৬ ॥

yasyāṅghri-paṅkaja-rajo 'khila-loka-pālair
whose feet lotus the dust of all the worlds by the guardians
mauly-uttamair dhṛtam upāsita-tīrtha-tīrtham
on heads best borne the worshipped of holy places the holy place
brahmā bhavo 'ham api yasya kalāḥ kalāyāḥ
Brahmā Śiva I also whose parts of a part
śrīś codvahema ciram asya nṛpāsanaṁ kva
Śrī and we bear ever His royal throne what

306 (Baladeva said:) "The guardians of all the worlds bear on their crowned heads the dust of His lotus feet, the holiest of holy places; and Brahmā, Śiva, Lakṣmī and I Myself, mere parts of His part, carry it on our heads forever. What then is a king's throne to Him?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.68.37)[23]

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 5.141.

(2) Rudra in tamo-guṇa: Garbhodaśāyī Himself, in a form joined with māyā, becomes Rudra —

নিজাংশ-কলায় কৃষ্ণ তমো-গুণ অঙ্গীকারে ।
সংহারার্থে মায়াসঙ্গে রুদ্র-রূপ ধরে ॥ ৩০৭ ॥

nijāṁśa-kalāya kṛṣṇa tamo-guṇa aṅgīkāre
of His own part by a kalā Kṛṣṇa tamo-guṇa accepts
saṁhārārthe māyā-saṅge rudra-rūpa dhare
for destruction in association with māyā Rudra's form assumes

307 By a *kalā* of His own part Kṛṣṇa accepts *tamo-guṇa*; and to destroy the universe He joins with māyā and assumes the form of Rudra.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa, as Mahā-Viṣṇu Garbhodakaśāyī — the *kalā* of Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī, who is a part of His own Saṅkarṣaṇa form — takes up *tamo-guṇa* and, to destroy the world, assumes the form of the *guṇa-avatāra* Rudra. Though Viṣṇu is acknowledged as presiding over *sattva-guṇa*, He cannot become subject to māyā. Where Viṣṇu's nature is absent, there is the nature of Śiva or of Brahmā, and in it there is a connection with māyā. The nature of Śiva and the nature of Brahmā are subject to the influence of Viṣṇu's māyā.

As Kṛṣṇa's svāṁśa, Rudra is in truth a non-separated part of the īśvara category; yet as the destroyer of the world, through the transformation caused by contact with māyā, He is a separated part, a jīva —

মায়াসঙ্গ-বিকারে রুদ্র — ভিন্নাভিন্ন রূপ ।
জীবতত্ত্ব হয়, নহে কৃষ্ণের 'স্বরূপ' ॥ ৩০৮ ॥

māyā-saṅga-vikāre rudra — bhinnābhinna rūpa
of association with māyā through the transformation Rudra different and non-different a form
jīva-tattva haya, nahe kṛṣṇera 'svarūpa'
jīva-tattva is not Kṛṣṇa's svarūpa

308 Through the change wrought by contact with māyā, Rudra's form is both different and not different from Kṛṣṇa; he is counted as *jīva-tattva*, not as Kṛṣṇa's own form (*svarūpa*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Taking up *tamo-guṇa* through His own *aṁśa-kalā*, for the sake of destruction He assumes the form of "Rudra" in association with māyā. Because of the transformation caused by association with māyā, Rudra is a *tattva* manifest as both different and non-different. Therefore He is counted within the *jīva-tattva* and is not Kṛṣṇa's "*svarūpa*."

An analogy for Rudra's manifestation as different and non-different — the example of milk and yogurt —

দুগ্ধ যেন অম্লযোগে দধিরূপ ধরে ।
দুগ্ধান্তর বস্তু নহে, দুগ্ধ হৈতে নারে ॥ ৩০৯ ॥

dugdha yena amla-yoge dadhi-rūpa dhare
milk as through contact with a sour agent of curd the form takes
dugdhāntara vastu nahe, dugdha haite nāre
other than milk a thing is not milk to be cannot

309 When milk meets something sour, it takes the form of curd. Curd is nothing other than milk, yet it cannot be milk.

Anubhāṣya.

Rudra is a *tattva* both different and non-different from Viṣṇu. He undergoes transformation in association with māyā, and so He is "different" from Viṣṇu, while in truth He is non-different from Viṣṇu. Viṣṇu is never different from Viṣṇu; but Śiva, Brahmā and others, under the sway of māyā, are different from Viṣṇu. Viṣṇu is never subject to transformation. Where a transformation of māyā is seen in the nature of the Lord, that is a form different from Viṣṇu — Śiva or Brahmā, called *guṇa-avatāras*. Thus Rudra, endowed with transformation and manifest as different and non-different, is *jīva-tattva*: by His intrinsic nature He is not *viṣṇu-tattva*, Kṛṣṇa's own form, but the *tattva* of a Vaiṣṇava. The Lord is the milk. Through contact with a sour substance — māyā — it passes from the state of milk into a transformation of milk, yogurt. Therefore yogurt, though born of milk, can never present itself as milk.

(Brahma-saṁhitā 5.45)

ক্ষীরং যথা দধি বিকারবিশেষযোগাৎ
সংজায়তে ন তু ততঃ পৃথগস্তি হেতোঃ ৷
যঃ শম্ভুতামপি তথা সমুপৈতি কার্য্যাদ্-
গোবিন্দমাদিপুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ৩১০ ॥

kṣīraṁ yathā dadhi vikāra-viśeṣa-yogāt
milk as curd of a particular change through contact
saṁjāyate na tu tataḥ pṛthag asti hetoḥ
becomes not yet from that separate is cause
yaḥ śambhutām api tathā samupaiti kāryād
who the state of Śambhu also likewise attains for a purpose
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

310 "As milk becomes curd through contact with a particular agent of change, yet the curd is not separate from its cause, so He, for a particular task, assumes the state of Śambhu (Śiva). I worship Govinda, that original Person." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.45)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Through contact with a particular transforming agent, milk (*kṣīra*) becomes yogurt, and there is no other cause in it besides that transformation. So too the original Person Govinda, for the sake of a task, accepts the nature of Śambhu. Him I worship.

Anubhāṣya.
kṣīraṁ (milk) **yathā vikāra-viśeṣa-yogāt** (through contact with a sour substance) **dadhi saṁjāyate** (is transformed into yogurt), **tataḥ hetoḥ** (from the milk, however) **na pṛthak** (different) **asti**; **tathā kāryāt** (because of the transformation born of contact with *guṇa-māyā*, for the sake of destroying the material universe) **yaḥ puruṣaḥ** (Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu) **śambhutām** (the nature of Rudra) **api samupaiti** (accepts), **tam ādi-puruṣaṁ govindam ahaṁ bhajāmi**.

The difference between Rudra and Viṣṇu —

'শিব' — মায়াশক্তিসঙ্গী, তমোগুণাবেশ ।
মায়াতীত, গুণাতীত 'বিষ্ণু' — পরমেশ ॥ ৩১১ ॥

'śiva' — māyā-śakti-saṅgī, tamo-guṇāveśa
Śiva of māyā-śakti the companion absorbed in tamo-guṇa
māyātīta, guṇātīta 'viṣṇu' — parameśa
beyond māyā beyond the guṇas Viṣṇu the Supreme Lord

311 Śiva is the companion of *māyā-śakti* and is absorbed in *tamo-guṇa*, whereas Viṣṇu, the Supreme Lord, is beyond māyā and beyond the *guṇas*.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān Viṣṇu is the independent Supreme Lord, beyond the three *guṇas* and untouched by the influence of His own māyā. Śiva by his intrinsic nature is a *bhāgavata* (devotee); yet, becoming the lord of *tamo-guṇa*, one of the three *guṇas*, he is joined with māyā, and by force of association with *māyā-śakti* he is involved in it. In Bhagavān Viṣṇu māyā has no existence; Śiva's existence, however, lies in experiencing the existence of māyā. Therefore Rudra is not *viṣṇu-tattva* but a particular *tattva* in contact with māyā. When, experiencing his own existence as a *bhāgavata*, Śiva gives up the idea that he is the lord of māyā or the enjoyer of māyā, his nature as a servant of Hari becomes manifest.

In his dealings Rudra is always joined with guṇa-māyā — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.88.3 and 5)

শিবঃ শক্তিযুক্তঃ শশ্বৎ ত্রিলিঙ্গো গুণসংবৃতঃ ।
বৈকারিকস্তৈজসশ্চ তামসশ্চেত্যহং ত্রিধা ॥ ৩১২ ॥

śivaḥ śakti-yuktaḥ śaśvat
Śiva with śakti united eternally
tri-liṅgo guṇa-saṁvṛtaḥ
with three marks by the guṇas covered
vaikārikas taijasaś ca
vaikārika taijasa and
tāmasaś cety ahaṁ tridhā
tāmasa and thus the ego threefold

312 "Śiva is eternally united with *śakti*. Covered by the *guṇas*, he bears three marks: he is the threefold ego — *vaikārika*, *taijasa* and *tāmasa*." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.88.3)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *tattva* covered by the three kinds of *ahaṅkāra* — *vaikārika*, *taijasa* and *tāmasa* — and always joined with *māyā-śakti* is "Śiva."

Anubhāṣya.

Parīkṣit asked about the opposite destinations of those who worship Rudra and those who worship Viṣṇu. In reply Śrī Śukadeva spoke to him the following two verses.

śivaḥ śaśvat (eternally) **śakti-yutaḥ** (joined with *māyā-śakti*, accepted of his own will in its state of the *guṇas'* equilibrium) **vaikārikaḥ** (*sāttvika*) **taijasaḥ** (*rājasika*) **tāmasaḥ ca iti ahaṁ** (the *tattva* of *ahaṅkāra*) — **tridhā** (threefold, for when [the *guṇas*] suppress one another, *tamas* becomes threefold) **tri-liṅgaḥ** (marked by the designations of the three *guṇas*) **guṇa-saṁvṛtaḥ** (covered from afar by those *guṇas*, manifest and existing, as their presiding lord).

Viṣṇu is beyond the guṇas and māyā; He is Adhokṣaja —

হরির্হি নির্গুণঃ সাক্ষাৎ পুরুষঃ প্রকৃতেঃ পরঃ ।
স সর্ব্বদৃগুপদ্রষ্টা তং ভজন্নির্গুণো ভবেৎ ॥ ৩১৩ ॥

harir hi nirguṇaḥ sākṣāt
Hari indeed beyond the guṇas directly
puruṣaḥ prakṛteḥ paraḥ
the Person to prakṛti transcendent
sa sarva-dṛg upadraṣṭā
He all-seeing the witness
taṁ bhajan nirguṇo bhavet
Him worshipping free of the guṇas one becomes

313 "Hari is directly beyond the *guṇas*: He is the Person transcendent to *prakṛti*. He sees all and witnesses all. One who worships Him becomes free of the *guṇas*." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.88.5)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Hari is directly the Person beyond the *guṇas*, transcendent to *prakṛti*. He sees all and is the witness of all. By worshipping Him, the jīva becomes free from the *guṇas*.

Anubhāṣya.

hariḥ hi (indeed) **prakṛteḥ paraḥ** (not mixed with the material *guṇas*, as Brahmā, Śiva and others are, for He is Adhokṣaja) **sākṣāt** (uncovered) **nirguṇaḥ** (for *sattva* acts by His mere will) **puruṣaḥ** (Puruṣottama); **saḥ** (Hari) **sarva-dṛk** (the seer for all — for Brahmā, Śiva and the rest: He from whom comes the knowledge that leads to liberation; or, He who sees everything; therefore) **upadraṣṭā** (He sees the liberated near Him and is attainable by the liberated; or, He is the original witness; therefore) **taṁ** (Hari) **bhajan nirguṇaḥ** (established in one's own true nature) **bhavet**.

(3) Viṣṇu in sattva-guṇa — a vilāsa of Garbhodaśāyī Himself, a kalā of Kṛṣṇa

—

পালনার্থ স্বাংশ বিষ্ণুরূপে অবতার ।
সত্ত্বগুণ-দ্রষ্টা, তাতে গুণমায়া-পার ॥ ৩১৪ ॥

pālanārtha svāṁśa viṣṇu-rūpe avatāra
for maintenance His own part in the form of Viṣṇu descent
sattva-guṇa-draṣṭā, tāte guṇa-māyā-pāra
of sattva-guṇa the overseer therefore the guṇa-māyā beyond

314 For maintenance He descends as His own part (*svāṁśa*) in the form of Viṣṇu. He is the overseer of *sattva-guṇa*, and therefore He is beyond the māyā of the *guṇas*.

স্বরূপ — ঐশ্বর্য্যপূর্ণ, কৃষ্ণসম প্রায় ।
কৃষ্ণ অংশী, তিঁহো অংশ, বেদে হেন গায় ॥ ৩১৫ ॥

svarūpa — aiśvarya-pūrṇa, kṛṣṇa-sama prāya
His nature full of majesty equal to Kṛṣṇa almost
kṛṣṇa aṁśī, tiṁho aṁśa, vede hena gāya
Kṛṣṇa the whole He a part in the Vedas so they sing

315 By nature He is full of majesty, almost equal to Kṛṣṇa. Kṛṣṇa is the whole (*aṁśī*), and He is a part (*aṁśa*) — so the Vedas sing.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Brahmā is a *śaktyāveśa*, yet he is a *guṇa-avatāra*. Rudra is both different and non-different, yet He too is a *guṇa-avatāra*. Viṣṇu, however, though a *guṇa-avatāra* as a *svāṁśa*, must be called beyond the *guṇas* of māyā, for in Him pure *sattva* (*śuddha-sattva*) is seen. Viṣṇu is the part (*aṁśa*); Kṛṣṇa is His whole (*aṁśī*). Therefore Viṣṇu, like Kṛṣṇa, is full of the majesty of His own nature.

The example of a lamp — (Brahma-saṁhitā 5.46)

দীপার্চ্চিরেব হি দশান্তরমভ্যুপেত্য
দীপায়তে বিবৃতহেতুসমানধর্ম্মা ।
যস্তাদৃগেব হি চ বিষ্ণুতয়া বিভাতি
গোবিন্দমাদি পুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ৩১৬ ॥

dīpārcir eva hi daśāntaram abhyupetya
the flame of a lamp indeed surely another wick having reached
dīpāyate vivṛta-hetu-samāna-dharmā
shines as a lamp with its manifest cause of the same qualities
yas tādṛg eva hi ca viṣṇutayā vibhāti
who just so indeed and as Viṣṇu shines forth
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

316 "As the flame of one lamp, passing to another wick, shines as a lamp with the same qualities as the lamp it came from, so He shines forth as Viṣṇu. I worship Govinda, that original Person." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.46)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The flame of a lamp, in another vessel, acts as a separate lamp; that is, it has the same properties as the first lamp. So too the original Person Govinda manifests as "Viṣṇu." Him I worship.

Anubhāṣya.

(**yataḥ** — since) **hi dīpārciḥ** (the flame of a lamp) **eva daśāntaram** (another lamp, lit in succession from the great lamp) **abhyupetya vivṛta-hetu-samāna-dharmā**

(having the same properties as the original lamp that caused its appearance — that is, equal to it in being light) (shines), **dīpāyate** (acts as a lamp), **tādṛk eva yaḥ puruṣaḥ hi viṣṇutayā** (as Kṣīrodaśāyī, the *vilāsa* form of Garbhodaśāyī) **ca vibhāti** (shines brightly), **tam ādi-puruṣaṁ govindam ahaṁ bhajāmi**.

The true nature of Viṣṇu, Brahmā and Śiva: Brahmā and Śiva are subordinate tattvas, different in form from Kṛṣṇa; Viṣṇu is the īśa-tattva, alike in form to Kṛṣṇa —

ব্রহ্মা, শিব — আজ্ঞাকারী ভক্ত-অবতার ।
পালনার্থে বিষ্ণু — কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ-আকার ॥ ৩১৭ ॥

brahmā, śiva — ājñā-kārī bhakta-avatāra
Brahmā Śiva orders carrying out bhakta-avatāras
pālanārthe viṣṇu — kṛṣṇera svarūpa-ākāra
for maintenance Viṣṇu Kṛṣṇa's own form

317 Brahmā and Śiva are *bhakta-avatāras* who carry out His orders, while Viṣṇu, who maintains the world, is Kṛṣṇa's own form (*svarūpa*).

Anubhāṣya.
Viṣṇu, who holds the power of maintenance, is no one other than Kṛṣṇa: He is Kṛṣṇa's very own form. Brahmā or Śiva, however, are His obedient (carrying out His will, following His command) servants, *bhakta-avatāras*.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.6.32)

সৃজামি তন্নিয়ুক্তোঽহং হরো হরতি তদ্বশঃ ।
বিশ্বং পুরুষরূপেণ পরিপাতি ত্রিশক্তিধৃক্ ॥ ৩১৮ ॥

sṛjāmi tan-niyukto 'haṁ
I create by Him appointed I
haro harati tad-vaśaḥ
Hara destroys under His control
viśvaṁ puruṣa-rūpeṇa
the universe in the form of the Puruṣa
paripāti tri-śakti-dhṛk
maintains three potencies the bearer of

318 "Appointed by Him, I create; under His control Hara (Śiva) destroys; and He, the bearer of the three potencies, maintains the universe in the form of the Puruṣa." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.6.32)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Brahmā said: "Only by Hari's appointment do I create; by His command Śiva destroys. And this very Hari, the holder of the three *śaktis*, maintains the universe in the form of the Puruṣa."

Anubhāṣya.

Devarṣi Nārada wished to learn from his own guru Brahmā about the Paramātmā Śrī Hari, the highest *tattva*, worshipped even by them. Then Brahmā, after describing to him the universal form of Bhagavān, glorifies the supreme lordship of Viṣṇu, the nondual Knowledge.

ahaṁ (Brahmā) **tan-niyuktaḥ** (appointed by Him — by the permission of that Hari, [I create] the universe) **sṛjāmi**; **haraḥ** (Śiva) **tad-vaśaḥ** (appointed by Him — by the permission of that Hari, the universe) **harati** (destroys); **tri-śakti-dhṛk** (the three *śaktis* — the *māyā-śakti* of three *guṇas*, or the internal, external and marginal *śaktis*; He who holds them, that Lord Himself) **puruṣa-rūpeṇa** (in the form of Kṣīrodaśāyī Viṣṇu) **paripāti** (maintains).

(d) A description of the manvantara-avatāras —

মন্বন্তরাবতার এবে শুন, সনাতন ।
অসংখ্য গণন তাঁর, শুনহ কারণ ॥ ৩১৯ ॥

manvantarāvatāra ebe śuna, sanātana
the manvantara-avatāras now hear Sanātana
asaṅkhya gaṇana tāṁra, śunaha kāraṇa
countless the number of them hear the reason

319 Now, Sanātana, hear about the *manvantara-avatāras*. Their number is countless — hear the reason.

Anubhāṣya.

On the *manvantara-avatāras*, see the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* on Ādi 2.97, the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 3.7–9 and the *Anubhāṣya* on Madhya 20.167.[40]

The time of the manvantara-avatāras —

ব্রহ্মার একদিনে হয় চৌদ্দ মন্বন্তর ।
এ চৌদ্দ অবতার তাঁহা করেন ঈশ্বর ॥ ৩২০ ॥

brahmāra eka-dine haya caudda manvantara
Brahmā's in one day there are fourteen manvantaras
e caudda avatāra tāṁhā karena īśvara
these fourteen avatāras there makes the Lord

320 In one day of Brahmā there are fourteen *manvantaras*, and in them the Lord brings forth these fourteen avatāras.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *manvantara-avatāras*: in one day of Brahmā there are fourteen *manvantaras*, and in them fourteen avatāras. In one month of Brahmā there are 420, and in one year (of 360 days) 5,040 avatāras; in Brahmā's lifetime, 504,000 *manvantara-avatāras*.

The reckoning of the periods —

চৌদ্দ এক দিনে, মাসে চারিশত বিশ ।
ব্রহ্মার বৎসরে পঞ্চসহস্র চল্লিশ ॥ ৩২১ ॥

caudda eka dine, māse cāri-śata biśa
fourteen in one day in a month four hundred twenty
brahmāra vatsare pañca-sahasra calliśa
Brahmā's in a year five thousand forty

321 Fourteen in one day, four hundred and twenty in a month, and five thousand and forty in a year of Brahmā.

শতেক বৎসর হয় 'জীবন' ব্রহ্মার ।
পঞ্চলক্ষ চারিসহস্র মন্বন্তরাবতার ॥ ৩২২ ॥

śateka vatsara haya 'jīvana' brahmāra
a hundred years is the life of Brahmā
pañca-lakṣa cāri-sahasra manvantarāvatāra
five hundred thousand four thousand manvantara-avatāras

322 Brahmā's life lasts a hundred years; so there are 504,000 *manvantara-avatāras*.

The lifespan of Brahmā — from Kāraṇābdhiśāyī's exhalation until He breathes in —

অনন্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ডে ঐছে করহ গণন ।
মহাবিষ্ণুর একশ্বাসে ব্রহ্মার জীবন ॥ ৩২৩ ॥

ananta brahmāṇḍe aiche karaha gaṇana
in the endless universes thus make the count
mahā-viṣṇura eka-śvāse brahmāra jīvana
of Mahā-Viṣṇu in one breath of Brahmā the life

323 Count them in this way in the endless universes — and Brahmā's whole life lasts but one breath of Mahā-Viṣṇu.

মহাবিষ্ণুর নিশ্বাসের নাহিক পর্য্যন্ত ।
এক মন্বন্তরাবতারের দেখ লেখার অন্ত ॥ ৩২৪ ॥

mahā-viṣṇura niśvāsera nāhika paryanta
of Mahā-Viṣṇu of the breaths there is no limit
eka manvantarāvatārera dekha lekhāra anta
of the manvantara-avatāras alone see of the writing the end

324 There is no limit to Mahā-Viṣṇu's breaths. How, then, could one ever finish writing of the *manvantara-avatāras* alone?

The names of the fourteen manvantara-avatāras —

স্বায়ম্ভুবে 'যজ্ঞ', স্বারোচিষে 'বিভু' নাম ।
উত্তমে 'সত্যসেন', তামসে 'হরি' অভিধান ॥ ৩২৫ ॥

svāyambhuve 'yajña', svārociṣe 'vibhu' nāma
in Svāyambhuva Yajña in Svārociṣa Vibhu by name
uttame 'satyasena', tāmase 'hari' abhidhāna
in Uttama Satyasena in Tāmasa Hari the name

325 In the Svāyambhuva *manvantara* the avatāra is named Yajña; in the Svārociṣa, Vibhu; in the Uttama, Satyasena; and in the Tāmasa, Hari.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"In Svāyambhuva": in the *manvantara* of Svāyambhuva, the avatāra Yajña; in the *manvantara* of Svārociṣa, "Vibhu," and so on — in fourteen *manvantaras*, fourteen avatāras.

রৈবতে 'বৈকুণ্ঠ', চাক্ষুষে 'অজিত', বৈবস্বতে 'বামন' ৷
সাবর্ণ্যে 'সার্ব্বভৌম', দক্ষসাবর্ণ্যে 'ঋষভ' গণন ॥ ৩২৬ ॥

raivate 'vaikuṇṭha', cākṣuṣe 'ajita', vaivasvate 'vāmana'
in Raivata Vaikuṇṭha in Cākṣuṣa Ajita in Vaivasvata Vāmana
sāvarṇye 'sārvabhauma', dakṣa-sāvarṇye 'ṛṣabha' gaṇana
in Sāvarṇya Sārvabhauma in Dakṣa-sāvarṇya Ṛṣabha is counted

326 In the Raivata, Vaikuṇṭha; in the Cākṣuṣa, Ajita; in the Vaivasvata, Vāmana; in the Sāvarṇya, Sārvabhauma; and in the Dakṣa-sāvarṇya, Ṛṣabha is counted.

ব্রহ্মসাবর্ণ্যে 'বিষ্বক্সেন', 'ধর্ম্মসেতু' ধর্ম্মসাবর্ণ্যে ৷
রুদ্রসাবর্ণ্যে 'সুধামা', 'যোগেশ্বর' দেবসাবর্ণ্যে ॥ ৩২৭ ॥

brahma-sāvarṇye 'viṣvaksena', 'dharmasetu' dharma-sāvarṇye
in Brahma-sāvarṇya Viṣvaksena Dharmasetu in Dharma-sāvarṇya
rudra-sāvarṇye 'sudhāmā', 'yogeśvara' deva-sāvarṇye
in Rudra-sāvarṇya Sudhāmā Yogeśvara in Deva-sāvarṇya

327 In the Brahma-sāvarṇya, Viṣvaksena; in the Dharma-sāvarṇya, Dharmasetu; in the Rudra-sāvarṇya, Sudhāmā; and in the Deva-sāvarṇya, Yogeśvara.

ইন্দ্রসাবর্ণ্যে ‘বৃহদ্ভানু’ অভিধান ।
এই চৌদ্দ মন্বন্তরে চৌদ্দ ‘অবতার’ নাম ॥ ৩২৮ ॥

indra-sāvarṇye ‘bṛhadbhānu’ abhidhāna
in Indra-sāvarṇya Bṛhadbhānu the name
ei caudda manvantare caudda ‘avatāra’ nāma
these in the fourteen manvantaras of the fourteen avatāras the names

328 In the Indra-sāvarṇya the name is Bṛhadbhānu. These are the names of the fourteen avatāras in the fourteen *manvantaras*.

Anubhāṣya.
The Manus are: (1) Svāyambhuva, the son of Brahmā Svayambhū; (2) Svārociṣa, the son of Svarocis, or Agni; (3) Uttama, the son of Priyavrata; (4) Tāmasa, the brother of Uttama; (5) Raivata, the uterine brother of Tāmasa; (6) Cākṣuṣa, the son of Cakṣu; (7) Vaivasvata, the son of Vivasvān, the sun; (8) Sāvarṇi, the son born of the Sun in the womb of Chāyā; (9) Dakṣa-sāvarṇi, the son of Varuṇa; (10) Brahma-sāvarṇi, the son of Upaśloka; (11–14) Rudra-sāvarṇi, Dharma-sāvarṇi, Deva-sāvarṇi and Indra-sāvarṇi, otherwise named Rudraputra, Raucya, the son of Satyasahā, and Bhautyaka.

(e) A description of the yuga-avatāras —

যুগাবতার এবে শুন, সনাতন ।
সত্য-ত্রেতা-দ্বাপর-কলি যুগের গণন ॥ ৩২৯ ॥

yugāvatāra ebe śuna, sanātana
the yuga-avatāras now hear Sanātana
satya-tretā-dvāpara-kali yugera gaṇana
Satya Tretā Dvāpara Kali of the yugas the counting

329 Now, Sanātana, hear about the *yuga-avatāras*. The *yugas* are counted as Satya, Tretā, Dvāpara and Kali.

In the four yugas, avatāras of four colours —

শুক্ল-রক্ত কৃষ্ণ-পীত — ক্রমে চারি বর্ণ ।
চারি বর্ণ ধরি’ কৃষ্ণ করেন যুগধর্ম্ম ॥ ৩৩০ ॥

śukla-rakta kṛṣṇa-pīta — krame cāri varṇa
white red black yellow in turn four colours
cāri varṇa dhari' kṛṣṇa karena yuga-dharma
four colours assuming Kṛṣṇa establishes the dharma of the age

330 White, red, black and yellow — these are the four colours in turn. Assuming these four colours, Kṛṣṇa establishes the dharma of each age.

Anubhāṣya.
In Satya-yuga, the white *yuga-avatāra*; in Tretā-yuga, the red *yuga-avatāra*; in Dvāpara-yuga, the black *yuga-avatāra*; and in Kali-yuga, the golden *yuga-avatāra*. Assuming these four colours, Kṛṣṇa as the *yuga-avatāra* upholds dharma.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.8.13)

আসন্ বর্ণাস্ত্রয়ো হ্যস্য গৃহ্ণতোঽনুযুগং তনূঃ ।
শুক্লো রক্তস্তথা পীত ইদানীং কৃষ্ণতাং গতঃ ॥ ৩৩১ ॥

āsan varṇās trayo hy asya
there were colours three indeed of Him
gṛhṇato 'nu-yugaṁ tanūḥ
accepting in each age bodies
śuklo raktas tathā pīta
white red likewise yellow
idānīṁ kṛṣṇatāṁ gataḥ
now blackness has attained

331 "Your son, who accepts a body in every age, has appeared in three colours — white, red and yellow; now He has become dark (*kṛṣṇa*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.8.13)[24]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.36.

In Satya-yuga Bhagavān is white, four-armed, dressed as a brahmacārī —

সত্যযুগে ধ্যান-ধর্ম্ম করায় 'শুক্লমূর্ত্তি ধরি' ।
কর্দ্দমকে বর দিলা যিঁহো কৃপা করি' ॥ ৩৩২ ॥

satya-yuge dhyāna-dharma karāya 'śukla-mūrti dhari'
in Satya-yuga the dharma of meditation He causes to practise a white form assuming

kardamake vara dilā yiṁho kṛpā kari'
to Kardama a boon gave who mercy showing

332 In Satya-yuga, assuming a white form, He has people practise the dharma of meditation. It was He who mercifully gave Kardama a boon.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kardama is the *prajāpati* who married Devahūti, the daughter of Manu, and whose son is Kapiladeva. Pleased with his austerities, Bhagavān gave him darśana in a white form.

Anubhāṣya.

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.21): "In Kṛta-yuga He is white and four-armed, with matted locks, clothed in bark; He bears a black antelope skin, a sacred thread, prayer beads, a staff and a water pot." See also *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.21.16, 35, 51; 3.22.19; 3.23.23; 5.10.16.

In Tretā-yuga Bhagavān is red, four-armed —

কৃষ্ণ-'ধ্যান' করে লোক জ্ঞান-অধিকারী ।
ত্রেতার ধর্ম্ম 'যজ্ঞ' করায় 'রক্ত'-বর্ণ ধরি' ॥ ৩৩৩ ॥

kṛṣṇa-'dhyāna' kare loka jñāna-adhikārī
on Kṛṣṇa meditation perform people qualified for knowledge

tretāra dharma 'yajña' karāya 'rakta'-varṇa dhari'
of Tretā the dharma sacrifice He causes to perform red colour assuming

333 People qualified for knowledge meditate on Kṛṣṇa. Assuming a red colour, He has people perform sacrifice (*yajña*), the dharma of Tretā.

Anubhāṣya.

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.24): "In Tretā-yuga He is red in colour and four-armed, girded with a triple belt, golden-haired; His self is the three Vedas, and He is marked by the sacrificial ladle, spoon and so on." See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.26.

In Dvāpara Bhagavān is dark (śyāma) and two-armed —

'কৃষ্ণপদার্চ্চন' হয় দ্বাপরের ধর্ম্ম ।
'কৃষ্ণ'-বর্ণে করায় লোকে কৃষ্ণার্চ্চন-কর্ম্ম ॥ ৩৩৪ ॥

'kṛṣṇa-padārcana' haya dvāparera dharma
the worship of Kṛṣṇa's feet is of Dvāpara the dharma
'kṛṣṇa'-varṇe karāya loke kṛṣṇārcana-karma
in the dark colour He causes to perform the people of Kṛṣṇa's worship the activity

334 The worship of Kṛṣṇa's feet is the dharma of Dvāpara. In a dark (*kṛṣṇa*) colour He has people perform the worship of Kṛṣṇa.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.5.27)

দ্বাপরে ভগবান্ শ্যামঃ পীতবাসা নিজায়ুধঃ ।
শ্রীবৎসাদিভিরঙ্কৈশ্চ লক্ষণৈরুপলক্ষিতঃ ॥ ৩৩৫ ॥

dvāpare bhagavān śyāmaḥ
in Dvāpara the Lord dark
pīta-vāsā nijāyudhaḥ
in yellow garments with His own weapons
śrī-vatsādibhir aṅkaiś ca
by Śrīvatsa and the rest by marks and
lakṣaṇair upalakṣitaḥ
by characteristics distinguished

335 "In Dvāpara the Lord is dark, clad in yellow and bearing His own weapons, and He is known by the Śrīvatsa and other marks and characteristics." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.27)[25]

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 3.39. *Śyāma*: a colour like that of the *atasī* flower. Not in every Dvāpara does the Svayaṁ-rūpa descend in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. In the other Dvāpara-yugas before the avatāra of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān descended by His part, assuming the colour of a parrot's feathers — that is, green and the like. This is told in the *Śrī Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, the *Śrī Harivaṁśa*, the *Mahābhārata* and other works.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.5.29)

নমস্তে বাসুদেবায় নমঃ সঙ্কর্ষণায় চ ৷
প্রদ্যুম্নায়ানিরুদ্ধায় তুভ্যং ভগবতে নমঃ ॥ ৩৩৬ ॥

namas te vāsudevāya
obeisance to You to Vāsudeva
namaḥ saṅkarṣaṇāya ca
obeisance to Saṅkarṣaṇa and
pradyumnāyāniruddhāya
to Pradyumna to Aniruddha
tubhyaṁ bhagavate namaḥ
to You to Bhagavān obeisance

336 "Obeisance to You, Vāsudeva, and obeisance to Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha — to You, Bhagavān, obeisance." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.29)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Obeisances to Bhagavān Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha.

Anubhāṣya.
Nimi, the king of Videha, asked: "In which *yuga*, assuming which colour, and by what method is Bhagavān worshipped?" In reply Karabhājana Ṛṣi, one of the nine Yogendras, speaks the mantra of obeisance to the avatāra of Dvāpara-yuga.

(He names Bhagavān in the form of the four *vyūhas* —) **te** (to You) **bhagavate vāsudevāya namaḥ**; (to You) **saṅkarṣaṇāya namaḥ**; (to You) **pradyumnāya aniruddhāya ca namaḥ**.

এই মন্ত্রে দ্বাপরে করে কৃষ্ণার্চ্চন ৷
'কৃষ্ণনামসংকীর্ত্তন' — কলিযুগের ধর্ম্ম ॥ ৩৩৭ ॥

ei mantre dvāpare kare kṛṣṇārcana
with this mantra in Dvāpara they perform the worship of Kṛṣṇa
'kṛṣṇa-nāma-saṁkīrtana' — kali-yugera dharma
of Kṛṣṇa's name the congregational chanting of Kali-yuga the dharma

337 With this mantra people worship Kṛṣṇa in Dvāpara. The congregational chanting of Kṛṣṇa's name (*saṅkīrtana*) is the dharma of Kali-yuga.

In Kali-yuga Bhagavān is golden and two-armed, the preacher of the Name and prema —

'পীত'-বর্ণ ধরি' তবে কৈলা প্রবর্ত্তন ।
প্রেমভক্তি দিলা লোকে লঞা ভক্তগণ ॥ ৩৩৮ ॥

'pīta'-varṇa dhari' tabe kailā pravartana
yellow colour assuming then He established
prema-bhakti dilā loke lañā bhakta-gaṇa
loving devotion He gave to people taking along His devotees

338 Then, assuming a yellow colour, He established it, and with His devotees He gave people loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*).

Anubhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa, assuming a golden colour, established the dharma of Kali-yuga — the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name — and together with the devotees bestowed on the people prema-bhakti for Kṛṣṇa.

In Kali, Kṛṣṇa Himself descends in the form of the source of the avatāras —

ধর্ম্ম প্রবর্ত্তন করে ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ।
প্রেমে গায় নাচে লোক করে সঙ্কীর্ত্তন ॥ ৩৩৯ ॥

dharma pravartana kare vrajendra-nandana
dharma establishing makes the son of the king of Vraja
preme gāya nāce loka kare saṅkīrtana
in love sing dance the people perform saṅkīrtana

339 The son of the king of Vraja establishes the dharma, and in love the people sing and dance and perform saṅkīrtana.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.5.32)

কৃষ্ণবর্ণং ত্বিষাঽকৃষ্ণং সাঙ্গোপাঙ্গাস্ত্রপার্ষদম্ ।
যজ্ঞৈঃ সঙ্কীর্ত্তন-প্রায়ৈর্যজন্তি হি সুমেধসঃ ॥ ৩৪০ ॥

kṛṣṇa-varṇaṁ tviṣā 'kṛṣṇaṁ
Kṛṣṇa describing (or: with the syllables 'Kṛṣ-ṇa') by lustre not dark
sāṅgopāṅgāstra-pārṣadam
with limbs, sub-limbs, weapons and associates
yajñaiḥ saṅkīrtana-prāyair
by sacrifices in which saṅkīrtana predominates
yajanti hi su-medhasaḥ
they worship indeed the intelligent

340 "With sacrifices in which congregational chanting predominates, the wise worship the Lord who ever sings of Kṛṣṇa and whose lustre is not dark. He is always surrounded by His intimate companions (*aṅga*), His devotees (*upāṅga*), His weapons and His associates (*pārṣada*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.32)[26]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.51.

The dharma of Kali-yuga — the glory of nāma-kīrtana —

আর তিনযুগে ধ্যানাদিতে যেই ফল হয় ।
কলিযুগে কৃষ্ণনামে সেই ফল পায় ॥ ৩৪১ ॥

āra tina-yuge dhyānādite yei phala haya
in the other three yugas by meditation and the rest whatever fruit comes
kali-yuge kṛṣṇa-nāme sei phala pāya
in Kali-yuga by Kṛṣṇa's name that fruit one obtains

341 Whatever fruit comes in the other three *yugas* through meditation and the rest, that same fruit is obtained in Kali-yuga through Kṛṣṇa's name.

In praise of Kali-yuga — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 12.3.51–52)

কলের্দোষনিধে রাজন্নস্তি হ্যেকো মহান্ গুণঃ ।
কীর্ত্তনাদেব কৃষ্ণস্য মুক্তবন্ধঃ পরং ব্রজেৎ ॥ ৩৪২ ॥

kaler doṣa-nidhe rājann
of Kali of faults in the ocean O king
asti hy eko mahān guṇaḥ
there is indeed one great quality
kīrtanād eva kṛṣṇasya
by chanting alone of Kṛṣṇa
mukta-bandhaḥ paraṁ vrajet
freed from bondage the Supreme one attains

342 "O king, Kali is an ocean of faults, yet it has one great quality: simply by singing the glories of Kṛṣṇa one is freed from bondage and attains the Supreme." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 12.3.51)

Anubhāṣya.

Parīkṣit asked about the dharma of human beings in the sinful Kali-yuga and the means of destroying *anarthas*. Śrī Śukadeva described the dharma of Satya, Tretā and Dvāpara, named the countless faults of Kali-yuga, and at the end of the chapter glorifies its quality.

he rājan doṣa-nidheḥ (even of the abode of faults) **kaleḥ** (of Kali-yuga) **ekaḥ mahān guṇaḥ asti**; **hi** (for) **kṛṣṇasya kīrtanāt** (by chanting the names, form, qualities and pastimes of Śrī Hari and of what is His) **eva mukta-saṅgaḥ** (free from other desires and uncovered by jñāna, karma and the like) **paraṁ** (the fifth goal of life, *kṛṣṇa-prema*) **vrajet** (attains).

কৃতে যদ্ধ্যায়তো বিষ্ণুং ত্রেতায়াং যজতো মখৈঃ ।
দ্বাপরে পরিচর্য্যায়াং কলৌ তদ্ধরিকীর্ত্তনাৎ ॥ ৩৪৩ ॥

kṛte yad dhyāyato viṣṇuṁ
in Kṛta what by one meditating on Viṣṇu
tretāyāṁ yajato makhaiḥ
in Tretā by one worshipping with sacrifices
dvāpare paricaryāyāṁ
in Dvāpara by serving the Deity
kalau tad dhari-kīrtanāt
in Kali that from the chanting of Hari

343 "Whatever was attained in Kṛta by meditating on Viṣṇu, in Tretā by worshipping with sacrifices and in Dvāpara by serving the Deity, is attained in Kali by glorifying Hari." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 12.3.52)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O King, Kali, the treasury of faults, has one great quality: in Kali-yuga, by kīrtana of Kṛṣṇa alone, the jīva is freed from the tightest bondage. The fruit that was gained by meditating on Viṣṇu in Satya-yuga, by worshipping with sacrifices in Tretā-yuga and by serving the Deity in Dvāpara-yuga — in the age of Kali all those fruits are gained through *hari-kīrtana*.

Anubhāṣya.
kṛte (in Satya-yuga) **viṣṇuṁ dhyāyataḥ** (of a person devoted to meditation on Hari), **tretāyāṁ makhaiḥ** (by sacrifices and the like) **yajataḥ** (of a person performing rites by Vedic injunction), **dvāpare paricaryāyāṁ** (in worship by the rules of the *pañcarātra*) **yat** (the fruit obtained), **tat** (all of it) **kalau hari-kīrtanāt eva** (one obtains).

(Viṣṇu Purāṇa 6.2.17)

ধ্যায়ন্ কৃতে যজন্ যজ্ঞৈস্ত্রেতায়াং দ্বাপরেঽর্চ্চয়ন্ ।
যদাপ্নোতি তদাপ্নোতি কলৌ সঙ্কীর্ত্ত্য কেশবম্ ॥ ৩৪৪ ॥

dhyāyan kṛte yajan yajñais
meditating in Kṛta worshipping with sacrifices
tretāyāṁ dvāpare 'rcayan
in Tretā in Dvāpara worshipping the Deity
yad āpnoti tad āpnoti
what one attains that one attains
kalau saṅkīrtya keśavam
in Kali by chanting together Keśava

344 "What one attains by meditating in Kṛta, by worshipping with sacrifices in Tretā and by worshipping the Deity in Dvāpara, one attains in Kali by chanting together the names of Keśava." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 6.2.17)

Anubhāṣya.
kṛte (in Satya-yuga) **dhyāyan** (by performing meditation), **tretāyāṁ yajñaiḥ yajan** (by satisfying the Lord of sacrifice with sacrifices), **dvāpare arcayan** (by worshipping the Deity and the like) **yat** (the fruit) **āpnoti** (one obtains), **kalau keśavaṁ saṅkīrtya** (by chanting together with many) **tat** (all of it — the fruit that is Bhagavān's satisfaction) **āpnoti**.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.5.36)

কলিং সভাজয়ন্ত্যার্য্যা গুণজ্ঞাঃ সারভাগিনঃ ।
যত্র সঙ্কীর্ত্তনেনৈব সর্ব্বস্বার্থোঽভিলভ্যতে ॥ ৩৪৫ ॥

kaliṁ sabhājayanty āryā
Kali honour the noble
guṇa-jñāḥ sāra-bhāginaḥ
knowing its merit taking the essence
yatra saṅkīrtanenaiva
in which by saṅkīrtana alone
sarva-svārtho 'bhilabhyate
every goal is attained

345 "The noble, who know its merit and take the essence, honour the age of Kali, for in it every goal of life is attained by saṅkīrtana alone." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.36)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Āryans who know merit and grasp the essence call Kali "blessed" precisely because in the age of Kali every goal is attained by saṅkīrtana alone.

Anubhāṣya.

Nimi, the king of Videha, asked: "In which *yuga*, assuming which colour, and by what methods is Śrī Bhagavān worshipped?" In reply Karabhājana Ṛṣi, one of the nine Yogendras, bows down to Śrī Gaurasundara — the source of the avatāras, who will appear in Kali-yuga — and glorifies the quality and greatness of Kali-yuga.

yatra (in Kali) **saṅkīrtanena** (by the practice of devotion called *kīrtana*) **eva sarvaḥ svārthaḥ** (every goal of life) **abhilabhyate** (is attained in full; therefore) **guṇa-jñāḥ** (those who know the merit of Kali) **āryāḥ** (great souls) **sāra-bhāginaḥ** (who take the share of merit) **taṁ** (that Kali) **sabhājayanti** (honour).

পূর্ব্ববৎ লিখি যবে গুণাবতারগণ ।
অসংখ্য সংখ্যা তাঁর, না হয় গণন ॥ ৩৪৬ ॥

pūrvavat likhi yabe guṇāvatāra-gaṇa
as before I write when the guṇa-avatāras the hosts
asaṅkhya saṅkhyā tāṁra, nā haya gaṇana
countless the number of them not there is counting

346 When I write of the hosts of *guṇa-avatāras* as before, their number is countless; they cannot be counted.

Sanātana, who knows the truth of Gaura's pastimes and is expert in the worship of Kṛṣṇa —

চারিযুগাবতারের এই ত' গণন ।
শুনি' ভঙ্গি করি' তাঁরে পুছে সনাতন ॥ ৩৪৭ ॥

cāri-yugāvatārera ei ta' gaṇana
of the four yugas of the avatāras this indeed the counting
śuni' bhaṅgi kari' tāṁre puche sanātana
hearing with a hint Him asks Sanātana

347 Such is the account of the avatāras of the four *yugas*." Hearing it, Sanātana questioned Him with a hidden intent (*bhaṅgi*).

The wise one to the Wise One —

রাজমন্ত্রী সনাতন — বুদ্ধ্যে বৃহস্পতি ।
প্রভুর কৃপাতে পুছে অসঙ্কোচ-মতি ॥ ৩৪৮ ॥

rāja-mantrī sanātana — buddhye bṛhaspati
the king's minister Sanātana in intelligence Bṛhaspati
prabhura kṛpāte puche asaṅkoca-mati
of the Lord by the mercy asks with mind free of hesitation

348 Sanātana had been the king's minister, a Bṛhaspati in intelligence. By the Lord's mercy he asked without hesitation:

A question, to learn from the Lord's own holy lips about His avatāra —

অতি ক্ষুদ্র জীব মুঞি নীচ, নীচাচার ।
কেমনে জানিব কলিতে কোন্ অবতার ? ॥ ৩৪৯ ॥

ati kṣudra jīva muñi nīca, nīcācāra
very insignificant jīva I low of low conduct
kemane jāniba kalite kon avatāra?
how shall I know in Kali which avatāra

349 "I am a very insignificant jīva, low and of low conduct. How shall I know who the avatāra in Kali is?"

The Lord indicates the marks of the yuga-avatāra of Kali —

প্রভু কহে, — অন্যাবতার শাস্ত্র-দ্বারে জানি ।
কলিতে অবতার তৈছে শাস্ত্রদ্বারা মানি ॥ ৩৫০ ॥

prabhu kahe, — "anyāvatāra śāstra-dvāre jāni
the Lord said the other avatāras through the scriptures we know
kalite avatāra taiche śāstra-dvārā māni
in Kali the avatāra likewise through the scriptures we accept

350 The Lord said, "We know the other avatāras through the scriptures; in the same way we accept the avatāra in Kali through the scriptures.

Knowledge of Bhagavān is gained only by the light of scripture —

সর্ব্বজ্ঞ মুনির বাক্য — শাস্ত্র-'প্রমাণ' ।
আমা-সবা জীবের হয় শাস্ত্রদ্বারা 'জ্ঞান' ॥ ৩৫১ ॥

sarvajña munira vākya — śāstra-'pramāṇa'
of the omniscient sage the words the evidence of scripture
āmā-sabā jīvera haya śāstra-dvārā 'jñāna'
of us all jīvas comes through the scriptures knowledge

351 The words of an omniscient sage are the evidence of scripture (*pramāṇa*). For all of us jīvas, knowledge comes through the scriptures.

Indirect speech is dear to the avatāras; the knowers of truth point to the Reality by its characteristics —

অবতার নাহি কহে — 'আমি অবতার' ।
মুনি সব জানি' করে লক্ষণ-বিচার ॥ ৩৫২ ॥

avatāra nāhi kahe — 'āmi avatāra'
an avatāra does not say I am an avatāra
muni saba jāni' kare lakṣaṇa-vicāra
the sages all knowing make of the signs examination

352 An avatāra does not say, 'I am an avatāra.' Knowing this, the sages examine His signs.

Viṣṇu is recognised by power unattainable for the jīva and immeasurable — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.10.34)

যস্যাবতারা জ্ঞায়ন্তে শরীরেষ্বশরীরিণঃ ।
তৈস্তৈরতুল্যাতিশয়ৈর্বীর্য্যৈর্দেহিষ্বসঙ্গতৈঃ ॥ ৩৫৩ ॥

yasyāvatārā jñāyante
whose avatāras are known
śarīreṣv aśarīriṇaḥ
among the embodied of the One without a material body
tais tair atulyātiśayair
by those various incomparable unsurpassed
vīryair dehiṣv asaṅgataiḥ
by powers among the embodied impossible

353 "The avatāras of You, who have no material body, are known among embodied beings by those incomparable, unsurpassed powers that no embodied being can possess." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.10.34)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Supreme Lord has no material body; His body is transcendental, and so the truth of His avatāras is hard for the jīva to grasp. Your avatāras are known to some extent by the matchless, surpassing and unearthly power (*vīrya*) they display.

Anubhāṣya.
When Kṛṣṇa, showing mercy, broke the two *yamala-arjuna* trees, Kuvera's two sons, Nalakūvara and Maṇigrīva, offer prayers to Kṛṣṇa.

dehiṣu (among the *jīvas*) **asaṅgataiḥ** (unattainable) **atulyātiśayaiḥ** (that have no equal or superior) **taiḥ taiḥ vīryaiḥ** (by displays of power) **śarīriṣu** (in the world, among the embodied *jīvas*) **aśarīriṇaḥ** (though You have no material body) **yasya** (Your) **avatārāḥ jñāyante**.

The definition of the svarūpa- and taṭastha-lakṣaṇa —

'স্বরূপ'-লক্ষণ, আর 'তটস্থ-লক্ষণ' ।
এই দুই লক্ষণে 'বস্তু' জানে মুনিগণ ॥ ৩৫৪ ॥

'svarūpa'-lakṣaṇa, āra 'taṭastha-lakṣaṇa'
the svarūpa characteristic and the taṭastha characteristic
ei dui lakṣaṇe 'vastu' jāne muni-gaṇa
by these two characteristics a reality know the sages

354 By two kinds of characteristics — those of the essential nature (*svarūpa-lakṣaṇa*) and the marginal ones (*taṭastha-lakṣaṇa*) — the sages

know a reality (*vastu*).

আকৃতি, প্রকৃতি, স্বরূপ, — স্বরূপ-লক্ষণ ।
কার্য্যদ্বারা জ্ঞান, — এই তটস্থ-লক্ষণ ॥ ৩৫৫ ॥

ākṛti, prakṛti, svarūpa, — svarūpa-lakṣaṇa
form nature essential identity the svarūpa-lakṣaṇa
kārya-dvārā jñāna, — ei taṭastha-lakṣaṇa
through deeds knowledge this the taṭastha-lakṣaṇa

355 Form, nature and essential identity are the *svarūpa-lakṣaṇa*; knowledge gained through deeds is the *taṭastha-lakṣaṇa*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Ākṛti: shape; *prakṛti*: nature; *svarūpa*: form (*mūrti*); *svarūpa-lakṣaṇa*: the activity of that form (*vigraha*); *taṭastha-lakṣaṇa*: knowing by deeds.

Anubhāṣya.
Ākṛti, *prakṛti* and *svarūpa* — these three are the "*svarūpa*," or "principal" (*mukhya*), characteristic. Knowing by deeds is the "*taṭastha*," or "secondary" (*gauṇa*), characteristic.

In the maṅgalācaraṇa at the beginning of the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (1.1.1) the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa is defined by His svarūpa- and taṭastha-lakṣaṇas —

ভাগবতারম্ভে ব্যাস মঙ্গলাচরণে ।
'পরমেশ্বর' নিরূপিল এই দুই লক্ষণে ॥ ৩৫৬ ॥

bhāgavatārambhe vyāsa maṅgalācaraṇe
at the beginning of the Bhāgavatam Vyāsa in the auspicious invocation
'parameśvara' nirūpila ei dui lakṣaṇe
the Supreme Lord defined by these two characteristics

356 At the beginning of the *Bhāgavatam*, in the auspicious invocation (*maṅgalācaraṇa*), Vyāsa defined the Supreme Lord by these two characteristics.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Bhāgavatam* verse *janmādy asya*, the two words *satyam* and *param* give the characteristic of His true nature (*svarūpa-lakṣaṇa*). The creation, maintenance and dissolution of the universe, the revealing of knowledge of the Reality in Brahmā's heart, His knowing every purpose (*arthābhijñatā*) and the like are the *taṭastha-lakṣaṇa*. By expressing both, [Vyāsa] defined the Supreme Lord.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.1.1)

জন্মাদ্যস্য যতোঽন্বয়াদিতরতশ্চার্থেষ্বভিজ্ঞঃ স্বরাট্
তেনে ব্রহ্ম হৃদা য আদিকবয়ে মুহ্যন্তি যৎ সূরয়ঃ ।
তেজো বারিমৃদাং যথা বিনিময়ো যত্র ত্রিসর্গোঽমৃষা
ধাম্না স্বেন সদা নিরস্তকুহকং সত্যং পরং ধীমহি ॥ ৩৫৭ ॥

janmādy asya yato 'nvayād itarataś cārtheṣv abhijñaḥ sva-rāṭ
birth and so on of this from whom directly indirectly and in all purposes fully aware self-luminous

tene brahma hṛdā ya ādi-kavaye muhyanti yat sūrayaḥ
revealed the Veda through the heart who to the first poet are bewildered about whom the wise

tejo vāri-mṛdāṁ yathā vinimayo yatra tri-sargo 'mṛṣā
of fire water earth as the interchange in whom the threefold creation real

dhāmnā svena sadā nirasta-kuhakaṁ satyaṁ paraṁ dhīmahi
by power His own always free of all deception the truth supreme let us meditate on

357 "Let us meditate on the Supreme Truth, from whom, directly and indirectly, this universe arises, endures and dissolves; who is fully aware of all purposes and shines by Himself (*svarāṭ*); who revealed the Veda through the heart to the first poet, Brahmā; about whom even the wise are bewildered; in whom, as fire, water and earth pass into one another, the threefold creation is real; and who by His own power is ever free of all deception." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.1)[27]

Anubhāṣya.

See Madhya 8.266.[39]

In this first verse — (1) the characteristic of the Supreme Lord's true nature —

এই শ্লোকে 'পরং'-শব্দে 'কৃষ্ণ'-নিরূপণ ।
'সত্যং' শব্দে কহে তাঁর স্বরূপ-লক্ষণ ॥ ৩৫৮ ॥

ei śloke 'paraṁ'-śabde 'kṛṣṇa'-nirūpaṇa
in this verse by the word 'param' Kṛṣṇa the defining
'satyaṁ' śabde kahe tāṁra svarūpa-lakṣaṇa
by the word 'satyam' it tells His svarūpa-lakṣaṇa

358 In this verse the word *param* defines Kṛṣṇa, and the word *satyam* states His *svarūpa-lakṣaṇa*.

(2) The taṭastha-lakṣaṇa —

বিশ্বসৃষ্ট্যাদি কৈল, বেদ ব্রহ্মাকে পড়াইল ।
অর্থাভিজ্ঞতা, স্বরূপশক্ত্যে মায়া দূর কৈল ॥ ৩৫৯ ॥

viśva-sṛṣṭy-ādi kaila, veda brahmāke paḍāila
of the universe creation and so on He made the Veda to Brahmā He taught
arthābhijñatā, svarūpa-śaktye māyā dūra kaila
knowledge of all purposes by His own potency māyā far He drove

359 From Him come the creation, maintenance and dissolution of the universe, and He taught the Veda to Brahmā; He knows all purposes, and by His own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) He drives māyā far away.

এইসব কার্য্য — তাঁর তটস্থ-লক্ষণ ।
অন্য অবতার ঐছে জানে মুনিগণ ॥ ৩৬০ ॥

ei-saba kārya — tāṁra taṭastha-lakṣaṇa
these all activities His taṭastha-lakṣaṇa
anya avatāra aiche jāne muni-gaṇa
other avatāras likewise know the sages

360 All these activities are His *taṭastha-lakṣaṇa*. In the same way the sages know the other avatāras.

All avatāras are identified precisely by these two characteristics named by the teachers (deśikas) —

অবতার-কালে হয় জগতের গোচর ।
এই দুই লক্ষণে কেহ জানেন ঈশ্বর ॥ ৩৬১ ॥

avatāra-kāle haya jagatera gocara
of the avatāra at the time He becomes to the world perceptible
ei dui lakṣaṇe keha jānena īśvara
by these two characteristics some know the Lord

361 At the time of His descent He becomes perceptible to the world, and by these two characteristics some recognise the Lord."

Before a devotee expert in worship, the hidden nature of Bhagavān is revealed —

সনাতন কহে, — যাতে ঈশ্বর-লক্ষণ ।
পীতবর্ণ, — কার্য্য — প্রেমদান-সঙ্কীর্ত্তন ॥ ৩৬২ ॥

sanātana kahe, — "yāte īśvara-lakṣaṇa
Sanātana said in whom the Lord's characteristics
pīta-varṇa, — kārya — prema-dāna-saṅkīrtana
golden colour the activity the giving of prema saṅkīrtana

362 Sanātana said, "He in whom the Lord's characteristics are found — a golden colour, and the work of giving prema and of saṅkīrtana —

Anubhāṣya.
In the age of Kali, the *svarūpa-lakṣaṇa* of the *yuga-avatāra* is His form of golden colour, and His *taṭastha-lakṣaṇa* is the work of giving prema and of saṅkīrtana.

The desire to hear from the Lord Himself the explanation of His pastimes —

কলিকালে সেই 'কৃষ্ণাবতার' নিশ্চয় ।
সুদৃঢ় করিয়া কহ, যাউক সংশয় ॥ ৩৬৩ ॥

kali-kāle sei 'kṛṣṇāvatāra' niścaya
in the age of Kali He Kṛṣṇa's avatāra certainly
sudṛḍha kariyā kaha, yāuka saṁśaya
firmly making it tell me let it go the doubt

363 is certainly Kṛṣṇa's avatāra in the age of Kali. Tell me this for certain, so that my doubt may go."

The devotee's victory, Bhagavān's defeat —

প্রভু কহে, — চতুরালি ছাড়, সনাতন ।
শক্ত্যাবেশাবতারের শুন বিবরণ ॥ ৩৬৪ ॥

prabhu kahe, — caturāli chāḍa, sanātana
the Lord said cleverness give up Sanātana
śaktyāveśāvatārera śuna vivaraṇa
of the śaktyāveśa-avatāras hear the account

364 The Lord said, "Give up your cleverness, Sanātana. Hear the account of the *śaktyāveśa-avatāras*.

Anubhāṣya.
Caturāli: skilfully establishing one's inner intention, displaying cleverness, showing intelligence.

One of Kṛṣṇa's six kinds of vilāsa and three kinds of forms — (c) a description of the śaktyāveśa-avatāras —

শক্ত্যাবেশাবতার কৃষ্ণের অসংখ্য গণন ।
দিগ্‌দরশন করি মুখ্য মুখ্য জন ॥ ৩৬৫ ॥

śaktyāveśāvatāra kṛṣṇera asaṅkhya gaṇana
the śaktyāveśa-avatāras of Kṛṣṇa countless the number
dig-daraśana kari mukhya mukhya jana
a glimpse I give the chief the chief persons

365 Kṛṣṇa's *śaktyāveśa-avatāras* are countless. I shall give a glimpse, naming the chief among them.

Two kinds of śaktyāveśa: one invested with the śakti itself is the principal, an "avatāra"; one invested with a reflection of the śakti is the secondary, called a "vibhūti" —

শক্ত্যাবেশ দুইরূপ — 'মুখ্য', 'গৌণ' দেখি ।
সাক্ষাৎশক্ত্যে 'অবতার', আভাসে 'বিভূতি' লিখি ॥ ৩৬৬ ॥

śaktyāveśa dui-rūpa — 'mukhya', 'gauṇa' dekhi
śaktyāveśa of two kinds primary secondary we see
sākṣāt-śaktye 'avatāra', ābhāse 'vibhūti' likhi
with direct potency avatāra with a reflection vibhūti I write

366 *Śaktyāveśa* is of two kinds, primary and secondary. One endowed with the potency itself I call an avatāra; one endowed only with its reflection, a *vibhūti*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śaktyāveśa is of two kinds, secondary and principal. One in whom the *śakti* itself descends is a principal *śaktyāveśa-avatāra*. Where the *śakti* is seen only as a reflection, in the form of *vibhūti*, there is a secondary *śaktyāveśa-avatāra*.

(1) The names of the principal āveśa-avatāras —

'সনকাদি', 'নারদ', 'পৃথু', 'পরশুরাম' ।
জীবরূপ 'ব্রহ্মার' আবেশাবতার-নাম ॥ ৩৬৭ ॥

'sanakādi', 'nārada', 'pṛthu', 'paraśurāma'
Sanaka and the others Nārada Pṛthu Paraśurāma
jīva-rūpa 'brahmāra' āveśāvatāra-nāma
in the form of a jīva Brahmā āveśa-avatāras the name

367 Sanaka and his brothers, Nārada, Pṛthu, Paraśurāma, and Brahmā, who is a jīva, are called *āveśa-avatāras*.

বৈকুণ্ঠে 'শেষ' — ধরা ধরয়ে 'অনন্ত' ।
এই মুখ্যাবেশাবতার — বিস্তারে নাহি অন্ত ॥ ৩৬৮ ॥

vaikuṇṭhe 'śeṣa' — dharā dharaye 'ananta'
in Vaikuṇṭha Śeṣa the earth holds Ananta
ei mukhyāveśāvatāra — vistāre nāhi anta
these primary āveśa-avatāras in detail there is no end

368 Śeṣa in Vaikuṇṭha, and Ananta, who holds up the earth — these are primary *āveśa-avatāras*. To describe them in detail would have no end.

The principal āveśa-avatāras, distinguished by their chief śakti —

সনকাদ্যে 'জ্ঞান'-শক্তি, নারদে শক্তি 'ভক্তি' ।
ব্রহ্মায় 'সৃষ্টি'-শক্তি, অনন্তে 'ভূ-ধারণ'-শক্তি ॥ ৩৬৯ ॥

sanakādye 'jñāna'-śakti, nārade śakti 'bhakti'
in Sanaka and the others of knowledge the potency in Nārada the potency of devotion
brahmāya 'sṛṣṭi'-śakti, anante 'bhū-dhāraṇa'-śakti
in Brahmā of creation the potency in Ananta of holding the earth the potency

369 In Sanaka and his brothers is the potency of knowledge, in Nārada the potency of devotion, in Brahmā the potency of creation, and in Ananta the potency of holding up the earth.

শেষে 'স্ব-সেবন'-শক্তি, পৃথুতে 'পালন' ।
পরশুরামে 'দুষ্টনাশক-বীর্য্যসঞ্চারণ' ॥ ৩৭০ ॥

śeṣe 'sva-sevana'-śakti, pṛthute 'pālana'
in Śeṣa of serving Himself the potency in Pṛthu maintenance
paraśurāme 'duṣṭa-nāśaka-vīrya-sañcāraṇa'
in Paraśurāma destroying the wicked of prowess the infusion

370 In Śeṣa is the potency of serving the Lord Himself; in Pṛthu, the potency of maintaining the world; and in Paraśurāma, an infusion of prowess that destroys the wicked.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"In Śeṣa, the *śakti* of serving Himself": in the avatāra of Bhagavān in the form of Śeṣa is invested the *śakti* that consists in serving Him.

The definition of the āveśa-avatāras — (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Pūrva-khaṇḍa, the section on āveśa, 18)

জ্ঞানশক্ত্যাদিকলয়া যত্রাবিষ্টো জনার্দ্দনঃ ।
ত আবেশা নিগদ্যন্তে জীবা এব মহত্তমাঃ ॥ ৩৭১ ॥

jñāna-śakty-ādi-kalayā
of knowledge potency and so on by a portion
yatrāviṣṭo janārdanaḥ
in whom has entered Janārdana
ta āveśā nigadyante
they āveśa are called
jīvā eva mahattamāḥ
jīvas indeed the greatest

371 "Those into whom Janārdana has entered with a portion of His potency of knowledge and the rest are called *āveśa-avatāras*; they are in fact the greatest of jīvas." (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 1.18)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Where Bhagavān enters by a *kalā* of the *jñāna-śakti* and other *śaktis*, those greatest jīvas are counted as "*āveśa-avatāras*."

Anubhāṣya.
yatra (in the greatest *jīvas*) **jñāna-śakty-ādi-kalayā** (by a portion of knowledge, devotion, creation, service, maintenance, sustaining, destruction and the like) **janārdanaḥ āviṣṭaḥ**, **te mahattamāḥ jīvāḥ eva āveśāḥ** (*āveśa-avatāras*) **nigadyante** (are called).

(2) A description of the vibhūtis of the Gītā —

'বিভূতি' কহিয়ে যৈছে গীতা-একাদশে ।
জগৎ ব্যাপিল কৃষ্ণশক্ত্যাভাসাবেশে ॥ ৩৭২ ॥

'vibhūti' kahiye yaiche gītā-ekādaśe
vibhūti we call as in the Gītā in the Eleventh
jagat vyāpila kṛṣṇa-śakty-ābhāsāveśe
the world pervaded of Kṛṣṇa's potency of the reflection by the investing

372 Those I call *vibhūtis* are described in the *Gītā* and in the Eleventh Canto: Kṛṣṇa pervades the world by investing beings with a reflection of His potency.[28]

Anubhāṣya.
On the nature of the *vibhūtis* of māyā, see *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.7.39.

(Śrīmad Bhagavad-gītā 10.41–42)

যদ্যদ্বিভূতিমৎ সত্ত্বং শ্রীমদূর্জ্জিতমেব বা ৷
তত্তদেবাবগচ্ছ ত্বং মম তেজোঽংশসম্ভবম্ ॥ ৩৭৩ ॥

yad yad vibhūtimat sattvaṁ
whatever whatever possessed of opulence being
śrīmad ūrjitam eva vā
beautiful mighty indeed or
tat tad evāvagaccha tvaṁ
that that alone know you
mama tejo-'ṁśa-sambhavam
of My splendour from a part born

373 "Whatever being is possessed of opulence, beauty or might — know that it is born from a part of My splendour." (Bhagavad-gītā, 10.41)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Those jīvas who are endowed with *vibhūti* and splendour (*śrī*) — know them as born of a portion of My radiance.

Anubhāṣya.
vibhūtimat (endowed with majesty) **śrīmat** (endowed with wealth) **ūrjitam** (surpassing in qualities such as strength and influence) **yat yat sattvaṁ** (material being) **bhavati**, **tat tat eva mama tejo-'ṁśa-sambhavam** (arising from a portion of influence — that is, born of a part of influence) **tvam avagaccha** (know).

অথবা বহুনৈতেন কিং জ্ঞাতেন তবার্জ্জুন ৷
বিষ্টভ্যাহমিদং কৃৎস্নমেকাংশেন স্থিতো জগৎ ॥ ৩৭৪ ॥

atha vā bahunaitena
but or with much this
kiṁ jñātena tavārjuna
what (use) by knowing for you Arjuna
viṣṭabhyāham idaṁ kṛtsnam
pervading I this entire
ekāṁśena sthito jagat
by one portion I stand the universe

374 "But what need have you, Arjuna, of all this detailed knowledge? By one portion of Myself I pervade and support this entire universe." (Bhagavad-gītā, 10.42)[29]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.20.

The last of the six kinds of vilāsa of Kṛṣṇa's own form — His pastimes as the possessor of two ages —

এইত কহিলুঁ শক্ত্যাবেশ-অবতার ।
বাল্য-পৌগণ্ড-ধর্ম্মের শুনহ বিচার ॥ ৩৭৫ ॥

eita kahiluṁ śakty-āveśa-avatāra
thus I have told the śaktyāveśa avatāras
bālya-paugaṇḍa-dharmera śunaha vicāra
of childhood boyhood of the characteristics hear the consideration

375 Thus I have told you about the *śaktyāveśa-avatāras*. Now hear about the characteristics of His childhood (*bālya*) and boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*).

Before Kṛṣṇa Himself reveals His pastimes, His servants in the form of His elders appear —

কিশোরশেখর-ধর্ম্মী ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ।
প্রকটলীলা করিবারে যবে করে মন ॥ ৩৭৬ ॥

kiśora-śekhara-dharmī vrajendra-nandana
of kaiśora the crown possessing the nature the son of the king of Vraja
prakaṭa-līlā karibāre yabe kare mana
manifest pastimes to perform when makes up His mind

376 When the son of the king of Vraja, whose nature is the crown of youth (*kaiśora*), resolves to perform His manifest pastimes,

আদৌ প্রকট করায় মাতা-পিতা-ভক্তগণে ।
পাছে প্রকট হয় জন্মাদিক-লীলাক্রমে ॥ ৩৭৭ ॥

ādau prakaṭa karāya mātā-pitā-bhakta-gaṇe
first manifest He causes mother father the devotees
pāche prakaṭa haya janmādika-līlā-krame
afterwards manifest He becomes birth and the rest of the pastimes in the sequence

377 He first causes His mother, His father and His devotees to appear, and afterwards He Himself appears in the sequence of pastimes that begins with His birth.

(Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga, Vibhāva-laharī, 63)

বয়সো বিবিধত্বেঽপি সর্ব্বভক্তিরসাশ্রয়ঃ ।
ধর্ম্মী কিশোর এবাত্র নিত্যলীলা-বিলাসবান্ ॥ ৩৭৮ ॥

vayaso vividhatve 'pi
of age in the variety even
sarva-bhakti-rasāśrayaḥ
of all devotion the rasas the shelter
dharmī kiśora evātra
possessing all qualities kiśora alone here
nitya-līlā-vilāsavān
eternal pastimes enjoying

378 "Though He has many ages, it is as a *kiśora*, in His youth, that He possesses all qualities; He is the shelter of all the rasas of devotion and ever enjoys His eternal pastimes." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.63)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa, the possessor of eternal pastimes (*vilāsa*), the shelter of all the *rasas* of devotion, has various ages, yet the best of them is *kiśora*.

Anubhāṣya.

vayasaḥ vividhatve (amid the variety of ages — childhood, boyhood, youth and the rest) **api atra sarva-bhakti-rasāśrayaḥ nitya-līlā-vilāsavān kiśoraḥ eva dharmī** (endowed with the qualities of every age, the most complete).

In every universe, at every moment, that same wonderful, ever-new spiritual pastime —

পূতনা-বধাদি যত লীলা ক্ষণে ক্ষণে ।
সব লীলা নিত্য প্রকট করে অনুক্রমে ॥ ৩৭৯ ॥

pūtanā-vadhādi yata līlā kṣaṇe kṣaṇe
Pūtanā's killing and the rest all pastimes moment by moment
saba līlā nitya prakaṭa kare anukrame
all pastimes eternally manifest He makes in sequence

379 All His pastimes, beginning with the killing of Pūtanā, He eternally manifests moment by moment, one after another.

অনন্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ড, তার নাহিক গণন ।
কোন লীলা কোন ব্রহ্মাণ্ডে হয় প্রকটন ॥ ৩৮০ ॥

ananta brahmāṇḍa, tāra nāhika gaṇana
endless universes their there is no counting
kona līlā kona brahmāṇḍe haya prakaṭana
some pastime in some universe is manifested

380 The universes are endless, beyond counting, and in one universe or another some pastime is being manifested.

An example for the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa's avatāra — the unbroken stream of the

Gaṅgā —

এইমত সব লীলা — যেন গঙ্গাধার ।
সে সে লীলা প্রকট করে ব্রজেন্দ্রকুমার ॥ ৩৮১ ॥

ei-mata saba līlā — yena gaṅgā-dhāra
in this way all pastimes like the Gaṅgā' stream
se se līlā prakaṭa kare vrajendra-kumāra
those those pastimes manifests the prince of Vraja

381 In this way all the pastimes flow like the stream of the Gaṅgā, and the prince of Vraja manifests each of them.

The pastimes in Vraja are those of Kṛṣṇa in His youth (kiśora) —

ক্রমে বাল্য পৌগণ্ড-কৈশোরতা-প্রাপ্তি ।
রাস-আদি লীলা করে, কৈশোরে নিত্যস্থিতি ॥ ৩৮২ ॥

krame bālya paugaṇḍa-kaiśoratā-prāpti
gradually childhood boyhood of youth the attainment
rāsa-ādi līlā kare, kaiśore nitya-sthiti
the rāsa and other pastimes He performs in kaiśora eternal abiding

382 Gradually He passes through childhood and boyhood and attains youth (*kaiśora*). He performs the rāsa and other pastimes, and in *kaiśora* He abides eternally.

An explanation of the eternity of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes —

'নিত্যলীলা' কৃষ্ণের সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রে কয় ।
বুঝিতে না পারে লীলা কেমনে 'নিত্য' হয় ॥ ৩৮৩ ॥

'nitya-līlā' kṛṣṇera sarva-śāstre kaya
eternal pastimes of Kṛṣṇa in all the scriptures is said
bujhite nā pāre līlā kemane 'nitya' haya
to understand not are able a pastime how eternal is

383 All the scriptures declare that Kṛṣṇa's pastimes are eternal, but people cannot understand how a pastime can be eternal.

The example of the circle of the heavenly bodies —

দৃষ্টান্ত দিয়া কহি যদি, তবে লোক জানে ।
কৃষ্ণলীলা — নিত্য, জ্যোতিশ্চক্র-প্রমাণে ॥ ৩৮৪ ॥

dṛṣṭānta diyā kahi yadi, tabe loka jāne
an example giving I tell if then people understand
kṛṣṇa-līlā — nitya, jyotiścakra-pramāṇe
Kṛṣṇa's pastimes eternal by the evidence of the circle of luminaries

384 I shall give an example, so that people may understand: Kṛṣṇa's pastimes are eternal, as the circle of the luminaries shows.

জ্যোতিশ্চক্রে সূর্য্য যেন ফিরে রাত্রি-দিনে ।
সপ্তদ্বীপাম্বুধি লঙ্ঘি' ফিরে ক্রমে ক্রমে ॥ ৩৮৫ ॥

jyotiścakre sūrya yena phire rātri-dine
in the circle of luminaries the sun as moves night and day
sapta-dvīpāmbudhi laṅghi' phire krame krame
the seven islands and oceans crossing moves step by step

385 The sun moves night and day through the circle of the luminaries, crossing the seven islands and their oceans step by step.

রাত্রি-দিনে হয় ষষ্টিদণ্ড-পরিমাণ ।
তিনসহস্র ছয়শত 'পল' তার মান ॥ ৩৮৬ ॥

rātri-dine haya ṣaṣṭi-daṇḍa-parimāṇa
night and day amount to of sixty daṇḍas the measure
tina-sahasra chaya-śata 'pala' tāra māna
three thousand six hundred palas its measure

386 A night and a day measure sixty *daṇḍas*, or three thousand six hundred *palas*.

সূর্য্যোদয় হৈতে ষষ্টিপল-ক্রমোদয় ।
সেই এক দণ্ড, অষ্ট দণ্ডে 'প্রহর' হয় ॥ ৩৮৭ ॥

sūryodaya haite ṣaṣṭi-pala-kramodaya
from sunrise sixty palas of gradual rising
sei eka daṇḍa, aṣṭa daṇḍe 'prahara' haya
that one daṇḍa in eight daṇḍas a prahara is

387 From sunrise the sun climbs step by step through sixty *palas*; that is one *daṇḍa*, and eight *daṇḍas* make a *prahara*.

এক-দুই-তিন-চারি প্রহরে অস্তহয় ।
চারিপ্রহর রাত্রি গেলে পুনঃ সূর্য্যোদয় ॥ ৩৮৮ ॥

eka-dui-tina-cāri prahare asta haya
one two three four in praharas setting occurs
cāri-prahara rātri gele punaḥ sūryodaya
four praharas of night having passed again sunrise

388 Through one, two, three and four *praharas* it moves on to its setting, and when the four *praharas* of night have passed, the sun rises again.

The pastimes of the avatāra in all the universes over the fourteen manvantaras
—

ঐছে কৃষ্ণের লীলা-মণ্ডল চৌদ্দ মন্বন্তরে ।
ব্রহ্মাণ্ডমণ্ডল ব্যাপি' ক্রমে ক্রমে ফিরে ॥ ৩৮৯ ॥

aiche kṛṣṇera līlā-maṇḍala caudda manvantare
likewise Kṛṣṇa's of pastimes the circle in fourteen manvantaras
brahmāṇḍa-maṇḍala vyāpi' krame krame phire
of the universes the circle pervading step by step revolves

389 In the same way, over fourteen *manvantaras* the circle of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes revolves step by step through the circle of the universes.

The span of Kṛṣṇa's manifest pastimes —

সওয়াশত বৎসর কৃষ্ণের প্রকট-প্রকাশ ।
তাহা যৈছে ব্রজ-পুরে করিলা বিলাস ॥ ৩৯০ ॥

saoyāśata vatsara kṛṣṇera prakaṭa-prakāśa
a hundred and twenty-five years Kṛṣṇa's manifest presence
tāhā yaiche vraja-pure karilā vilāsa
there as in Vraja and the cities He performed pastimes

390 Kṛṣṇa's manifest presence lasts a hundred and twenty-five years, and during it He enjoys His pastimes in Vraja and in the cities, just as He did here.

An analogy for the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa's avatāra — the whirling of a firebrand wheel (alāta-cakra) —

অলাতচক্রপ্রায় সেই লীলাচক্র ফিরে ।
সব লীলা সব ব্রহ্মাণ্ডে ক্রমে উদয় করে ॥ ৩৯১ ॥

alāta-cakra-prāya sei līlā-cakra phire
a whirling firebrand like that of pastimes the wheel revolves
saba līlā saba brahmāṇḍe krame udaya kare
all pastimes in all universes in turn rising make

391 Like a whirling firebrand, that wheel of pastimes revolves, and all the pastimes rise in turn in all the universes.

The pastimes from His birth to the Mauṣala —

জন্ম, বাল্য, পৌগণ্ড, কৈশোর-প্রকাশ ।
পূতনা-বধাদি করি' মৌষলান্ত বিলাস ॥ ৩৯২ ॥

janma, bālya, paugaṇḍa, kaiśora-prakāśa
birth childhood boyhood the manifestation of youth
pūtanā-vadhādi kari' mauṣalānta vilāsa
Pūtanā's killing beginning with ending with the Mauṣala the pastimes

392 Birth, childhood, boyhood and youth are manifested in turn, with pastimes that begin with the killing of Pūtanā and end with the Mauṣala episode.

In one or another of countless millions of universes some pastime is always present; hence the pastimes are "eternal" —

কোন ব্রহ্মাণ্ডে কোন লীলার হয় অবস্থান ।
তাতে লীলা 'নিত্য' কহে নিগম-পুরাণ ॥ ৩৯৩ ॥

kona brahmāṇḍe kona līlāra haya avasthāna
in some universe of some pastime there is the presence
tāte līlā 'nitya' kahe nigama-purāṇa
therefore the pastimes eternal call the Vedas the Purāṇas

393 In one universe or another some pastime is always present; therefore the Vedas and Purāṇas call the pastimes eternal.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura, in the second section (*prakāśa*) of his *Rāga-vartma-candrikā*, in the commentary on the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* verse *tad-bhāva-baddha-rāgā ye janās te*, writes: "Here *anurāga* means intense longing for *rāgānugā* worship, not *anurāga* as a *sthāyi-bhāva*, for *anurāga* cannot arise in the body of a *sādhaka*. When [Kṛṣṇa] descends in Vraja at the time of His avatāra, His eternal beloveds and others appear; in the same way the *sādhana-siddhas* (those perfected through practice) also appear from the wombs of gopīs. And then, in the bodies of gopīs, [*sneha*, *māna*, *praṇaya*, *rāga*, *anurāga* and *mahābhāva*] arise in them, for in their previous birth, in the body of a *sādhaka*, these cannot arise. * * At the very moment the *sādhaka's* body falls away, to that loving devotee * * a gopī's body made of consciousness and bliss is given. That very body Yogamāyā brings forth from the womb of a gopī when Kṛṣṇa's associates appear in the manifest manifestation of Vṛndāvana. Here there is not even a trace of delay in time, for even in the manifest pastimes there is no break. In whichever universe the pastimes of Vṛndāvana are manifest at that time, there, in that very land of Vraja, [that body too appears]. Therefore even at the very time the body of the loving *sādhaka* devotee [departs], the appearance of Śrī Kṛṣṇa with His associates is always present. So, O devotees full of great *anurāga* and longing, do not fear, stand firm; may all be well with you!"

All the abodes of Viṣṇu, the spiritual splendour of Saṅkarṣaṇa, are equal to

Viṣṇu and descend into the world together with Hari —

গোলোক, গোকুল-ধাম — 'বিভু' কৃষ্ণসম ।
কৃষ্ণেচ্ছায় ব্রহ্মাণ্ডগণে তাহার সংক্রম ॥ ৩৯৪ ॥

goloka, gokula-dhāma — 'vibhu' kṛṣṇa-sama
Goloka the abode of Gokula all-pervading equal to Kṛṣṇa
kṛṣṇecchāya brahmāṇḍa-gaṇe tāhāra saṅkrama
by Kṛṣṇa's will into the universes its passing

394 Goloka, the abode of Gokula, is all-pervading (*vibhu*), equal to Kṛṣṇa, and by Kṛṣṇa's will it descends into the universes.

Together with the source of the avatāras, His own abode, Goloka, also descends into the universes —

অতএব গোলোকস্থানে নিত্য বিহার ।
ব্রহ্মাণ্ডগণে ক্রমে প্রকট তাহার ॥ ৩৯৫ ॥

ataeva goloka-sthāne nitya vihāra
therefore in Goloka eternal pastimes
brahmāṇḍa-gaṇe krame prakaṭa tāhāra
in the universes in turn the manifestation of them

395 Thus His pastimes go on eternally in Goloka, and in turn they become manifest in the universes.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa's pastimes are eternally manifest. In the countless universes, from time to time and one after another, the eternal pastimes become manifest. In one universe, beginning with the pastime of Kṛṣṇa's birth, the pastimes are manifest for one hundred twenty-five years, up to the pastime that ends with the Mauṣala, and then in that universe the pastimes become unmanifest. One moment of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes becomes manifest in one universe; when the first moment ends and the second begins, the pastime of the first moment becomes manifest in another universe. Thus, in countless, endless universes the pastime of each moment becomes manifest, and in another universe the pastime of that moment rises again. As an example of this, the path of the sun — its movement along the circle of the heavenly bodies (*jyotiś-cakra*) — has been described. In the endless universes Kṛṣṇa's countless pastimes

rise one after another and become unmanifest again. The knowledge of a jīva cannot grasp these endless pastimes. The stream of the Gaṅgā is unbroken, and the whirling of a firebrand wheel (*alāta-cakra*) is continuous and all-encompassing; so too the manifestation of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes in the various universes is perceived as unbroken. Kṛṣṇa's birth, childhood, boyhood, youth and other pastimes take place eternally. Even if the jīvas in some one universe do not experience the eternal manifestation of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, they are still eternal. "*Nitya-līlā*" means the eternal manifestation of all the pastimes at one and the same time; but in the world the pastimes are manifest in sequence. At that time the other pastimes are manifest in other universes, and so in any one universe at one time their eternity is not perceived. In truth the pastimes are eternal: over fourteen *manvantaras*, that is, in the span allotted to a *kalpa*, the circle of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes is repeated in sequence in some one universe; therefore the pastimes are not transient. The eternal pastimes are not visible in other universes, and so the people of this universe cannot perceive them. That is why the Vedas, the Purāṇas and other scriptures speak precisely of the eternal pastimes: the eternal place of Goloka's pastimes is manifested gradually in the universes.

In Vraja Kṛṣṇa reveals Himself as most complete, in Dvārakā and Mathurā as more complete, and in Paravyoma in the form of the complete —

ব্রজে কৃষ্ণ — সর্বৈশ্বর্য্যপ্রকাশে 'পূর্ণতম' ।
পুরীদ্বয়ে, পরব্যোমে — 'পূর্ণতর', 'পূর্ণ' ॥ ৩৯৬ ॥

vraje kṛṣṇa — sarvaiśvarya-prakāśe 'pūrṇatama'
in Vraja Kṛṣṇa by manifesting all majesty most complete
purī-dvaye, paravyome — 'pūrṇatara', 'pūrṇa'
in the two cities in Paravyoma more complete complete

396 In Vraja, where He manifests all His majesty, Kṛṣṇa is most complete (*pūrṇatama*); in the two cities He is more complete (*pūrṇatara*), and in Paravyoma complete (*pūrṇa*).

Anubhāṣya.

In Vraja Kṛṣṇa reveals all His majesty, and so Vrajendranandana is "*pūrṇatama*" (most complete). In the two cities, Dvārakā and Mathurā, Kṛṣṇa reveals all His majesty in lesser measure, and so there He is "*pūrṇatara*" (more complete). And in

Paravyoma, in Vaikuṇṭha, Kṛṣṇa reveals all His majesty in still lesser (slight) measure than in the two cities, and so there He is "*pūrṇa*" (complete).

The words of the Gosvāmī — (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga, Vibhāva-laharī, 221–223)

হরিঃ পূর্ণতমঃ পূর্ণতরঃ পূর্ণ ইতি ত্রিধা ।
শ্রেষ্ঠমধ্যাদিভিঃ শব্দৈর্নাট্যে যঃ পরিকীর্ত্তিতঃ ॥ ৩৯৭ ॥

hariḥ pūrṇatamaḥ pūrṇa-
Hari most complete more
taraḥ pūrṇa iti tridhā
complete complete thus in three ways
śreṣṭha-madhyādibhiḥ śabdair
best middling and the like by the words
nāṭye yaḥ parikīrtitaḥ
in drama who is celebrated

397 "Hari, whom works on drama celebrate with words such as 'best' and 'middling', is described in three ways: most complete, more complete and complete." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.221)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhagavān Hari, who in the *nāṭya-śāstra* is glorified by the words "best," "middling" and so on, is of three kinds: *pūrṇa*, *pūrṇatara* and *pūrṇatama*.

Anubhāṣya.
nāṭye (in the *nāṭya-śāstra*) **śreṣṭha-madhyādibhiḥ śabdaiḥ yaḥ** (glorified — He) **hariḥ pūrṇatamaḥ pūrṇataraḥ pūrṇaḥ iti tridhā parikīrtitaḥ**.

প্রকাশিতাখিলগুণঃ স্মৃতঃ পূর্ণতমো বুধৈঃ ।
অসর্ব্বব্যঞ্জকঃ পূর্ণতরঃ পূর্ণোঽল্পদর্শকঃ ॥ ৩৯৮ ॥

prakāśitākhila-guṇaḥ
with all qualities manifest
smṛtaḥ pūrṇatamo budhaiḥ
is regarded as most complete by the wise
asarva-vyañjakaḥ pūrṇa-
not manifesting all more
taraḥ pūrṇo 'lpa-darśakaḥ
complete complete showing few

398 "The wise regard Him in whom all qualities are manifest as most complete; Him who does not manifest them all as more complete; and Him who shows only a few as complete." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.222)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Hari who displays few qualities is *pūrṇa* (complete); Hari who displays all qualities, but in lesser measure, is *pūrṇatara* (more complete); and Hari in whom all qualities are displayed is *pūrṇatama* (most complete). So the learned glorify Him.

Anubhāṣya.
prakāśitākhila-guṇaḥ (He in whom all qualities are displayed — Hari, all of whose qualities are displayed) — **pūrṇatamaḥ**; **asarva-vyañjakaḥ** (Hari, all of whose qualities are displayed in slight measure) — **pūrṇataraḥ**; **alpa-darśakaḥ** (Hari in whom few qualities are displayed) — **pūrṇaḥ iti budhaiḥ smṛtaḥ**.

কৃষ্ণস্য পূর্ণতমতা ব্যক্তাভূদ্গোকুলান্তরে ।
পূর্ণতা পূর্ণতরতা দ্বারকা-মথুরাদিষু ॥ ৩৯৯ ॥

kṛṣṇasya pūrṇatamatā
Kṛṣṇa's most complete fullness
vyaktābhūd gokulāntare
was manifest in Gokula
pūrṇatā pūrṇataratā
fullness greater fullness
dvārakā-mathurādiṣu
in Dvārakā Mathurā and the rest

399 "In Gokula Kṛṣṇa was revealed as most complete; in Dvārakā, Mathurā and elsewhere, as complete and more complete." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu,

2.1.223)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In Gokula Kṛṣṇa's most complete fullness (*pūrṇatamatā*) was manifest, in Dvārakā and Mathurā His greater fullness (*pūrṇataratā*), and in Paravyoma His fullness (*pūrṇatā*).

Thus ends the twentieth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.
gokulāntare kṛṣṇasya pūrṇatamatā; **dvārakā-mathurādiṣu pūrṇataratā**; **paravyomni pūrṇatā vyaktābhūt**.

এই কৃষ্ণ — ব্রজে 'পূর্ণতম' ভগবান্ ।
আর সব স্বরূপ — 'পূর্ণতর' 'পূর্ণ' নাম ॥ ৪০০ ॥

ei kṛṣṇa — vraje 'pūrṇatama' bhagavān
this Kṛṣṇa in Vraja most complete Bhagavān
āra saba svarūpa — 'pūrṇatara' 'pūrṇa' nāma
other all forms more complete complete are called

400 This Kṛṣṇa in Vraja is Bhagavān most complete; all His other forms are called more complete or complete.

Anubhāṣya.
In Bhagavān Vrajendranandana is the "most complete" (*pūrṇatama*) manifestation, in the Lord of Dvārakā and the Lord of Mathurā the "more complete" (*pūrṇatara*) manifestation, and in the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha the "complete" (*pūrṇa*) manifestation.

The analysis of Kṛṣṇa's true nature is given very briefly: even Śeṣa Himself cannot glorify it fully —

সংক্ষেপে কহিলুঁ কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ-বিচার ।
'অনন্ত' কহিতে নারে ইহার বিস্তার ॥ ৪০১ ॥

saṅkṣepe kahiluṁ kṛṣṇera svarūpa-vicāra
in brief I have told of Kṛṣṇa's forms the analysis
'ananta' kahite nāre ihāra vistāra
Ananta to tell cannot of this the full extent

401 Thus I have briefly analysed Kṛṣṇa's forms (*svarūpa*). Even Ananta cannot tell all of it.

The author's humility; told by the principle of "the moon on the branch" —

অনন্ত স্বরূপ কৃষ্ণের নাহিক গণন ।
শাখা-চন্দ্র-ন্যায়ে করি দিগ্‌দরশন ॥ ৪০২ ॥

ananta svarūpa kṛṣṇera nāhika gaṇana
endless forms Kṛṣṇa's there is no counting
śākhā-candra-nyāye kari dig-daraśana
of the branch and the moon by the maxim I give a glimpse

402 Kṛṣṇa's forms are endless, beyond counting. I have only pointed towards them, as one shows the moon by pointing to a branch (*śākhā-candra-nyāya*)."

Anubhāṣya.
On the principle of "the moon on the branch" (*śākhā-candra-nyāya*), see Madhya 20.248.

By hearing the glorification of Kṛṣṇa's true nature one gains knowledge of the truth, which is revealed within the heart (sphūrti) —

ইহা যেই শুনে, পড়ে, সেই ভাগ্যবান্ ।
কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপতত্ত্বের হয় কিছু জ্ঞান ॥ ৪০৩ ॥

ihā yei śune, paḍe, sei bhāgyavān
this whoever hears reads he fortunate
kṛṣṇera svarūpa-tattvera haya kichu jñāna
of Kṛṣṇa's forms of the truth comes some knowledge

403 Whoever hears or reads this is fortunate: he gains some knowledge of the truth of Kṛṣṇa's forms.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the twentieth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ৪০৪ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

404 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 4.2; translation as there. ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 1.63; translation as there. ↩
3. The same verse as Madhya 19.50; translation as there. Reference as in the edition's heading: *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* 10.91. ↩
4. Reference as in the edition's heading; ↩
5. Reference as in the edition's heading; ↩
6. The same verse as Ādi 7.119; translation as there. ↩
7. The same verse as Madhya 6.155; translation as there. ↩
8. The same verse as Madhya 6.156; translation as there. ↩
9. The same verse as Ādi 7.118; translation as there. ↩
10. The same verse as Ādi 17.76; translation as there. ↩
11. The same verse as Ādi 2.95; translation as there. ↩
12. The same verse as Ādi 2.107; translation as there. ↩
13. The same verse as Ādi 2.67; translation as there. ↩
14. The same verse as Ādi 2.11; translation as there. ↩
15. The same verse as Ādi 2.14; translation as there. ↩
16. The same verse as Ādi 2.20; translation as there. ↩
17. The same verse as Ādi 1.71; translation as there. ↩
18. The same verse as Ādi 4.146, but here the edition reads *sphuratu*, "may it shine forth" (there *sphurati*, "appears"); translation as there with this change. ↩
19. The same verse as Ādi 5.77; translation as there. ↩
20. The same verse as Ādi 5.84; translation as there. ↩
21. The same verse as Ādi 5.83; translation as there. ↩
22. The same verse as Ādi 5.71; translation as there. ↩

23. The same verse as Ādi 5.141; translation as there. ↩
24. The same verse as Ādi 3.36; translation as there. ↩
25. The same verse as Ādi 3.39; translation as there. ↩
26. The same verse as Ādi 3.51; translation as there. ↩
27. The same verse as Madhya 8.265; translation as there. ↩
28. *gītā-ekādaśe* is read here as “in the *Gītā* and in the Eleventh”: the *vibhūtis* are described in *Bhagavad-gītā* 10 and in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.16. ↩
29. The same verse as Ādi 2.20; translation as there. ↩
30. Śrīdhara Svāmī’s commentary *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.1.1 (cf. CC Ādi 2.95). ↩
31. A play on words: *dakṣiṇa* means both “southern” and “the fee given to a priest for a rite.” ↩
32. A play on words: *paścāt*, “behind, with one’s back,” and *paścima*, “west.” ↩
33. In the edition the Bengali text of verse 168 reads বৈভবপ্রকাশ (*vaibhava-prakāśa*), as in this subheading. ↩
34. The form described here is Trivikrama; the name is not given in the quotation. ↩
35. The edition reads পাদ-বচনোক্তরীত্যা; understood as পাদ্ম- (the words of the *Padma Purāṇa*). ↩
36. *Sāṅkhya-kārikā* 25. ↩
37. Cf. Madhya 6.162: “The Lord is the master of māyā, and the jīva is subject to māyā — this is the difference between them.” ↩
38. *Ṛg-veda* 10.90.1 (the *Puruṣa-sūkta*). ↩
39. So in the edition (checked against the scan); this verse (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.1.1) is Madhya 8.265 in our text, where the *Anubhāṣya* on it also stands. ↩
40. So in the edition (checked against the scan); the list of the *manvantara-avatāras* is given in the *Anubhāṣya* on Madhya 20.246, while the note on verse 167 contains no such list. ↩